

HOTWIFE



EROTICA

the man before me

MAX SEBASTIAN

BESTSELLING AUTHOR OF A WIFE FOR WATCHING

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THE MAN BEFORE ME

MAX SEBASTIAN



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CHAPTER 1

‘IS IT WEIRD?’ he said.

‘Maybe a little.’

‘I popped your wife’s cherry.’

‘Someone had to.’

‘I nailed her for almost a whole year.’

‘You’d have been stupid not to.’

‘I fucked her so much, man. Even now, I can close my eyes and picture her naked. Any time I want.’

‘You have a good memory.’

‘Good muscle memory, too, you know that? Close my eyes and... Mmm... it’s like we’re fucking again. I can feel her... so fuckin’ tight...’

The guy was trying to make me feel bad. He was trying to provoke me. Trying to get a rise out of me. Trolling me in person. Maybe even stirring for a fight.

He was getting a rise out of me, for sure. But I don’t think it was the kind of rise he had hoped for.

‘She was the best sex I ever had,’ he said. ‘And the most sex I ever had.’

Cory Fallon. I felt oddly sorry for him. He'd had the best sex of his life in high school, and for him, it was downhill from there ever since. I guess loads of people peak at school and then buy a ticket to Nowheresville. Cory had been captain of the football team, the most popular guy in town, and prom king. And, of course, he'd had a sweet cheerleader on his arm.

His fortunes had gotten stuck in reverse after that.

My trajectory had been just about the opposite. After a high school experience that mainly involved dungeons and dragons and masturbating to posters of Megan Fox, my first real girlfriend had been in college, when I hadn't even lost my virginity until my sophomore year. Then, after graduation, dating became a little easier as my earning ability began to soar.

I looked at Cory—the kind of guy I'd so desperately wanted to be in high school—and felt a powerful sense of victory. Schadenfreude, I guess you'd say. I had triumphed over the forces of jockdom. The ugly, dorky duckling had turned into a swan with a fat wallet and a sizzling-hot wife.

But tonight, during my wife's high school reunion, Cory stood beside me holding a plastic cup of mid-strength beer and saw merely a nerd in an expensive suit.

He couldn't help but try to bully me. Nostalgia could transport you back in time.

This was never my high school, of course. But I would do as a stand-in for the nerds Cory had bullied during his time here. And after an initial inquest into my high school athletic achievements, he concluded that his best chance to needle me was to keep reminding me about his dating history with my wife.

It should have worked, too. But to my utter astonishment, I found it fascinating to meet a man who had been so intimate with Juliette.

As his attempts to goad me persisted, a strange awareness began to bloom within me that hearing about my wife's apparent addiction to another man's dick was not only oddly captivating but also curiously arousing.

Cory had a real way with words. The way he told it, Juliette had guzzled so much of his come as a teenager, he'd basically been her primary protein supply.

And wouldn't you know it, here I was getting a hard-on just listening to him.

'Man, she would wait for me by my truck every night after football practice, and God damn...'

I didn't feel anger toward Cory for his efforts to get under my skin. It would have been like being mad at a dog for sniffing another dog's butt. It's just what they did. Cory was a high school has-been, a once-but-futureless prom king. Biff Tannen without a sports almanac or a time machine to turn his fortunes around.

But why wasn't I jealous, faced with this besmircher of my wife's honor?

My initial guess was that, since Juliette and I had been married for three years and had been together six in all, we were secure enough in our relationship by now that I couldn't feel threatened.

The hard-on, though, was more difficult to explain.

'So how come you two split up?' I asked him — genuinely curious, not vindictive.

He shrugged. 'She went to college. I didn't.'

I asked him questions about her. Had she changed much since he'd dated her? Not a thing. What kinds of things did they do together when they weren't simply fucking? Not much. Had he dated anyone better since they'd call it quits? Not a chance.

I wasn't trying to rub his nose in the fact that I had ended up with Juliette, and he'd ended up with a dead-end job managing the local Wal-Mart. Not even *managing* the Walmart, assistant-managing. I was just interested in his time with Juliette. I wanted to hear her coming-of-age, her first steps into her sexual awakening.

She'd never spoken of her previous boyfriends, although, sure, I'd never asked. That was totally normal within a normal relationship, wasn't it? You didn't ask about your partner's dating history.

Men are supposed to want to believe their girlfriends are pure and unsullied, untouched by human cocks, before they arrive on the scene. Women are assumed to be somewhat allergic to the idea that any other women ever got their dirty mitts on their man before they came along.

But I glanced across the Fairfield High School gymnasium at my sweet wife working the room, and I only wanted to know more about her past exploits seducing alpha high school and college types.

Fucking her way toward eventual stability and commitment before ultimately marrying me.

God, just look at her.

She'd thought it would be somehow ironic to come to this high school reunion dressed in her old cheerleading uniform. But the way all the guys in the room had been gawking at her all night — either subtly if their other halves were present or not so subtly if they were single — had hardly been ironic at all.

She looked stunning in that oh-so-short blue and white pleated skirt and a matching top that clung to her gorgeous curves. The innocent knee-length white socks.

The blue bow and the way she'd styled her long, wavy golden hair made her look like a teenager again.

She'd turned herself into every man's fantasy — at least every man in this place right now — and yet she'd never once thought to wear such an outfit for my personal benefit.

Ah well, I forgave her.

Flashing me a cute little smile across the room as she continued catching up with her old buddies. I felt confident I'd get to peel off that outfit later when we returned to her parents' house at the end of the evening.

Unlike poor Cory, here.

Speaking of, Cory was beginning to get a little down in the dumps. My lack of jealousy, coupled with my increasingly grueling interrogation of him, had the unintended side effect of calling attention to the fact that he was no longer with our Juliette.

It had been years since he'd been free to tear off her cheerleading skirt and have his wicked way with her.

Right now he was beginning to look dejected, washed out. The complete opposite of the brash dog who'd scurried up to us at the start of the evening to let Juliette know he hadn't forgotten a minute of all that time he'd spent feeding her his fat dick.

In front of Juliette, he'd been very polite, of course.

Only when she felt obligated to tear herself away from us to carry out her full reunion duties with old friends and teammates did Cory unleash his full taunting venom on me.

For some reason, Juliette thought it would be okay to leave me alone with her ex so I wouldn't have to face the onslaught of meeting all her giggling, eye-rolling former buddies.

She'd assumed we were both men, so we would have something to talk about. Sports. Cars. Manly health supplements.

How had she not considered the possibility that it would be hilariously awkward between her husband and her first-ever sexual partner?

Admittedly, Juliette could never have predicted how I'd respond to being left with Cory.

'So how come you couldn't just visit her in college? You had to just split up?'

'I had to get a job. I had to pay my way.'

'You know there was probably a Wal-Mart near her college?'

He gave me a truly exasperated look at that one. Well, yeah, my tone might have been a little much. Fair enough. TARS, take the patronizing down to 75%.

'I'm sorry she broke your heart,' I said, a little more soberly, but it probably wasn't much better despite its earnest intent.

There was a flicker of something in his eyes that seemed like anger. 'She didn't break nothing. We both decided to end things. Mutual.'

I nodded. Honestly, I hadn't meant our conversation to go this way, I hadn't wanted to show this guy up. I just wanted to mine all the data he had on Juliette, and the alcohol had loosened my tongue a little too much.

But now he was sad, and I felt guilty about making him that way.

'Well, I guess you had plenty of time with her, anyway.'

Jeez Louise. And now I was trying to cheer him up, for goodness' sake. Find the irony in that.

'I mean... plenty of fish in the sea, and so on.'

I could see in his watery gray eyes that he didn't consider there to be many fish like Juliette to be found in any sea you cared to look into.

But his inner Draco Malfoy pushed him to conceal his sadness by reverting to his pitiful attempts to embarrass me about his intimate experience of the love of my life.

'Man, I can't remember much anything about summer of graduation, apart from all the time we were in bed.'

'You didn't go anywhere nice for a vacation?'

'Fucking — morning, noon and night. Man, she could not get enough of my dick.'

I pictured it. I wished I'd been there to see it. What should have been the stuff of nightmares was so weirdly exhilarating.

Who knew?

'I remember getting to her house when the sun came up, climbing over the garden fence, scaling the wall up to her bedroom window. Even before her folks were away to work, I would be in there, lying between her thighs.'

'You know, she's not such a morning person these days.'

'God, she was beautiful. And always soaking wet whenever I was around.'

'She was on the swim team, I guess.'

‘That summer she’d ride me all day — and then come over to my place for dinner. Well, my dad was never around.’

‘Her parents must have been thrilled.’

‘They thought she was out slurping milkshakes with her girlfriends.’

‘Whereas, in fact, she was out slurping—’

‘Man, she was so fine. You should have seen how she looked when she was full of my dick.’

I’m guessing most other husbands would have started a fight long before this. Or stormed out in a major huff. Or simply run for the hills. Would I have reacted differently to Cory’s attempts at winding me up if I’d been entirely sober? I wonder. I probably wouldn’t have been quite so overtly inquisitive.

I was sitting there with cheap booze warming my veins, a big smile plastered on my face as an aging jock filled my head with pornographic images featuring my dear wife.

It was making me so hard that I had to ensure I was standing with my back to the lights so the bulge would remain in the shadows.

The funny thing was, I’d always thought of my wife as a goody-two-shoes.

When I’d first met her, we’d both been young, ambitious urban professionals keen to present an air of sophistication within our Manhattan-based corporate law firm.

Juliette had always projected an image more like Clarice Starling than Jessica Rabbit.

But tonight, it was clear she’d been hiding a saucy past from me.

When she finally came back over to us after all that glad-handing around the old high school gymnasium, I don’t think Juliette even suspected that my entire image of her had been flip-turned upside down.

Well, she couldn’t know. She couldn’t see I was nursing a semi as she finally wandered back toward us, looking like the dictionary definition of gorgeous with all that blonde hair contrasting nicely with the cobalt blue of her cheerleading uniform.

I glanced over at my new friend and saw him looking at her with outright lust. I'd seen plenty of other men cast such eyes toward my wife, of course, over the years. I guess I'd always taken it as more of an ego boost than a threat — she's gorgeous, and she's with me.

But here was a man who had sampled the goods.

Over and over and over again.

And he wanted her so badly. I couldn't stop thinking about him being with her.

'Aww, look at you guys getting along,' she said, her beaming smile taking in the sight of two men who apparently couldn't take their eyes off her.

Her tone suggested surprise that we hadn't torn each other to jealous shreds while she'd been gone.

But now she was back, after what her ex had been telling me, I felt an oddly rebellious streak.

Without really thinking about what I was saying, I blurted out, 'Cory was just telling me how much sex you guys used to have during senior year.'

There was an icy moment where I heard Juliette catch her breath at what I'd said — and yet I didn't regret it for a moment.

Cory gave me a dark look, as though I'd broken the Bro Code by revealing the truth about our conversation.

After a moment, however, Juliette tried to brush off my awkward indiscretion as some kind of semi-drunken slip, saying brightly, 'Well, everyone did in senior year, didn't they? I mean, you're supposed to prepare for college...'

If I'd been less inebriated, I would have let it all go, moved on, and undoubtedly hoped to win back her forgiveness through a night of dutiful attention.

But I wasn't really being myself. And hey, it was her fault for leaving me to stew with her ex half the night.

I said, ‘Cory was saying how he can close his eyes and—even now—remember practically every inch of you. Inside and out.’

Her jaw dropped at that.

She tilted her head and gave me her sharpest what-is-wrong-with-you expression.

I merely smiled at her. I know, I was being an a-hole. I can’t quite figure out what came over me. Even the alcohol couldn’t explain all of it. I’m usually a very docile drunk.

She said coolly, ‘I’m glad I made such an impression,’ and gave Cory a polite and mildly apologetic smile, even though she clearly wasn’t entirely certain he didn’t also deserve some kind of blame for this situation.

I felt the guilt from making a scene, sure — though in all fairness, only Cory, myself, and Juliette were even aware there was a scene going on. Hey. Juliette dragged me to this reunion even though she would never let me go to one of my reunions.

She wasn’t even going to let me attend my buddy Vince’s wedding next month because there was a chance one of my exes might be there.

We avoided entire neighborhoods in New York because Juliette was aware I’d once lived there with another woman.

It was as though she couldn’t trust me not to cheat on her with one of them — even though there were reasons why they were all exes.

Anyway.

I think in all honesty, I wanted to explore this strange new fascination with Juliette’s sexual past, but my idiot drunk brain couldn’t quite formulate a way to communicate it with her.

So I said stupid things.

‘I mean, isn’t it weird hanging out with two different guys who are both imagining having sex with you right now?’

Juliette blushed profusely. She gave me another dark look. The darkest of looks.

She said to me pointedly, ‘Nick, honey, you need to switch to soda.’

Then she suddenly grabbed Cory’s hand and said, ‘I’m in the mood for dancing,’ in a tone that made it clear she intended to punish me for my petulant rudeness.

Cory gave me a smug look as he was dragged away to the dance floor, almost as though he was under the impression he’d secured some kind of major victory over me.

But I stood back and watched my wife reach the middle of the dance floor, put her arms around another man, and begin to move to the music — and I couldn’t help but feel that the real victory here was mine.

God.

My wife was dancing with her ex.

I should have been horrified. I should have been furious. I should have been so jealous I would forget all human decency and stride out onto the dance floor to beat the living daylights out of the guy.

But I wasn’t.

I was watching them dance and I’d never been so turned on, not since sweet Juliette and I had first gotten together and she had asked me on our first date whether I had a nice cock.

Was there something wrong with me?

CHAPTER 2

THIS HAD NEVER HAPPENED to me before. Nothing remotely like it.

I mean, we'd argued here and there. Nothing serious. Juliette had stomped off a few times — she was fiery. I liked that. But now she was punishing me for making a fool out of her by dancing with her ex right in front of me.

And after I'd been so rude to her, now she was dancing with him, she appeared to be making a point to try to provoke my jealousy.

The funny thing was, I wasn't jealous in the slightest.

She was draped all over him, gazing up into his eyes like she adored him, like she'd missed him intensely in the ten years since she'd last seen him. And I was standing there with a surprisingly massive erection, feeling strangely giddy about the prospect of her being with him.

Not just of *dancing* with him, but of really *being* with him.

My sweet wife in the arms of an old flame. An old flame who had fucked her multiple times each day for nearly 12 whole months.

I fucked her so much, man. Even now, I can close my eyes and picture her naked.

I wasn't jealous. I was wondering if I could do something else that might provoke her so much she'd let this guy fuck her again.

What on Earth was going on with me?

We'd never had any problems in the bedroom, Juliette and I.

Sure, sex hadn't been quite the priority for us recently, not like it used to be before we started the whole ring-buying phase of our relationship. But that was just part of settling down into long-term commitment, right?

I don't feel like I'd ever taken Juliette for granted. I'd always felt somewhat fortunate that she'd wanted to date me — and later, that she'd wanted to spend the rest of her life with me.

And yet, watching her dancing with another man like this made me *more* attracted to her than I felt I'd ever been before.

She was a hot little spitfire, which helped. Five foot two of real spice topped off with a dazzling smile, and the most dreamy blue eyes ever gazed into your soul. And a natural blonde, if you cared about that kind of thing.

Honestly, I'd never even looked at another woman since we'd been married.

But tonight, as she held another man in her arms and gazed at him longingly — even if her performance was a little exaggerated for dramatic purposes — I felt such a renewed burst of desire for Juliette that I was a little overwhelmed by it.

Jeez Louise. I just wanted to drag her off to our hotel room and tear off that ridiculously sexy cheerleader outfit.

Actually, check that. I didn't need to tear off the cheerleader outfit at all. There was a reason every guy in this entire reunion had been spending all evening trying to steal subtle glimpses at Juliette, and it wasn't because of her impressive legal career.

It was an ego boost to know that so many guys wanted to bang my wife. I could understand that much of my tangle of feelings. All the attention on her made her seem more valuable in my Neanderthal eyes and, therefore, more desirable. The fact that Cory still wanted her so badly made me want her more myself.

But that didn't explain the strange hope I was fostering — along with this monumental hard-on — that somehow Juliette might let Cory sleep with her one more time.

Of course, I didn't think it would happen. Not realistically. Juliette was a sophisticated 28-year-old woman who was fast becoming a highly respected New York City corporate lawyer. Why would she do something as unthinking as falling into bed with an old high school boyfriend, even if her husband had been an idiot?

And yet, the stiffness throbbing away in my smart casual pants was apparently optimistic.

Juliette was trying really hard to make me jealous. There was that. Though she didn't want to display it publicly, she had to be seriously pissed at how I'd acted earlier. And now she really wanted to wreak her revenge. Look at her, smiling at him, giggling at something stoopid he'd said.

Flirting with him.

Once or twice, she glanced over to see what kind of an impact her performance was having on me, and I think there was an ounce or two of frustration in her eyes that I hadn't already swooped out onto the dance floor to tear her away from her empty-headed ex.

But after a while, she seemed to forget about me and got more into the dancing itself. She began to relax and start actually enjoying herself. And that, for me, was extra sexy.

I just kind of melted into the crowd around the bar — never losing sight of her, but doing my best to let her direct all her attention towards Cory. I liked that she was having a good time with him, that there was still clear chemistry between them. I'd always been crap at dancing, so at least with Cory she had a decent dance partner.

'Hey, was I ever in a class with you? You seem familiar.'

I turned to find a short, dark-haired guy wearing a California tuxedo who looked like a former dork like me. Perhaps one who had become a car dealer instead of a lawyer.

'Uh, no. Not my school,' I said.

‘Dragged here with the girlfriend, huh?’ he grinned.

‘Wife,’ I corrected him.

He nodded. ‘I had one of those. Two, actually. One of them ran off with a French guy. The other one... well... there was an unfortunate incident involving her Chihuahua... and a lawnmower...’

He seemed to have been drinking even more than me. I was all in favor.

He said, ‘Man, you see that girl in the cheerleader outfit?’

I glanced back to the dance floor to check her out. Man. Her legs looked phenomenal in that short skirt.

‘She’s quite something, isn’t she?’ I grinned.

‘That’s Juliette Parker. Man, I had the biggest crush on her all through school. Well, everybody did, I guess.’

‘I guess I can see why.’

‘God, she hasn’t aged a day. She married, now, of course. Man, can you imagine being married to her? I would feel like I died and gone to Heaven every time I woke up next to her...’

Brian Rhodes. He was a talker. I didn’t mind. I hung out with him, listened to him wax on lyrically about my wife, and responded with suitably vague encouragement without revealing that Juliette was married to me.

He seemed annoyed that she was back dancing with Cory Fallon tonight.

‘Didn’t he get enough of her when he was fucking her all through senior year?’ he said.

‘He was fucking her all through senior year?’

I couldn’t help myself.

Brian said, ‘Well, had to be. Cory could have had any girl he wanted. He didn’t look at anybody else. Not senior year, anyway. Nobody was in any doubt she was giving it to him, noon and night.’

I enjoyed hearing the guy confirming my wife’s early sexual history.

We laughed a little at what Juliette's sap of a husband must be doing, letting her out of his sight like this so she could dance at her reunion with her high school fuck buddy.

We commiserated on both being complete dweebs when we'd been at high school. Brian, though, had basically held the line for ever after, poor fellow. He was pleasant company, though, while I let Juliette work off a little steam on the dance floor.

I didn't mind lurking there in the shadows with him, staring at the hot blonde in the cheerleader's outfit as she swayed and wiggled her hips with her first love.

Of course, there was a somewhat awkward moment when Juliette finally gave in to her sense of marital duty and parted from Cory to wander back to her husband. But Brian's surprise that I turned out to be her husband was quickly forgotten as I introduced him to her, and she held a brief but smiley conversation with him asking how he'd been since high school.

Brian just seemed ecstatic at the chance to talk to his high school crush for the first time ever. It felt like I was married to a Hollywood star as a besotted fan had approached her for an autograph.

She gave him a few minutes, at least.

While she tried to break away from Brian's fawning conversation, Juliette actually looked like she wanted to say something to me — from the odd, nervous look in her eyes, I wondered if she was actually afraid that she'd gone too far in dancing with her ex-boyfriend for so long. I mean, most husbands would probably have been livid.

But she clearly didn't want to say anything in front of Brian — and then moments later, all her high school buddies were swarming around, en route to the dance floor themselves, and Juliette couldn't swim against that tide.

I let her go. She liked to dance. I didn't. Couldn't say fairer than that.

I stood back and watched her some more. I really did enjoy seeing her having fun. To be honest, though, there wasn't quite the hint of suspense in the air as there had been when I was watching her dance with Cory.

Kind of disappointing. Where was he? I kind of wanted her to dance with him some more, not all these giggly, semi-inebriated women.

I glanced around and saw Cory taking up position back at the bar.

Round Two, I thought.

‘Are you guys going through something?’ he asked me as I ordered myself a drink and found myself a perch beside him at the bar.

‘Everyone’s going through something,’ I said, logically enough.

Cory was a big guy. He’d towered over Juliette on the dance floor. He didn’t seem so impressive slumped at the bar, though.

‘You’re a real douche,’ he said.

That made me laugh for some reason — proper belly-aching laugh, too.

Once I’d calmed down a little, I couldn’t think of much of a response except, ‘I am a real douche.’

My self-deprecation took him by surprise. Perhaps, though, it was the first signs of a thawing of relations between us.

He said, ‘How did she ever end up with you?’

I shrugged. ‘I have a huge cock.’ It wasn’t true, particularly. But the line came to me and amused me as I said it. Then I turned his question back on him. ‘How did she ever end up with you?’

He shrugged. ‘Same.’

Don’t ask me why, but it made us both crack up. It did seem a little ridiculous that Juliette would fall for two men who looked so completely different. He was huge — and still very much in shape. I was diminutive with a Peewee Herman physique. I suppose after they leave school and move on from college, some women just don’t prioritize the same things in a romantic partner they once had.

The bartender handed me another beer in a plastic cup, and Cory said dryly, ‘You don’t want to switch to soda?’

I grinned at that. ‘Hey, if I can’t get it up tonight, she’s got you here, right?’ I joked, but my resurgent erection wasn’t laughing.

Cory took it in jest.

Drinks in hand, we both turned to watch Juliette dancing with her old girlfriends. We chatted. It seemed easier than before. Cory still wanted to talk about his time with my wife, but I think even he sensed that I didn't mind and that I was happy to hear about it. The booze probably helped.

I even asked him questions about what it had been like dating her. What had it been like sleeping with her? What kinds of sex things had she been into back then?

Dick, apparently. Lots of dick.

She couldn't get enough of Cory's massive tool. Strangely, though, I couldn't get enough of hearing about her exploits with Cory's massive tool.

'She really liked to fuck in weird places.'

'Like the back of a Volkswagen?'

'Like at the movies. And if the theater was too packed to get away with fucking, she would get on her knees and try blowing me.'

'Jeez.'

'And if the place was too crowded for that, then she'd give me a handjob.'

'Multi-talented,' I nodded, as we watched my sweet beloved dancing to a nostalgic-laden Galantis track.

Cory told me about fucking her in the school library, in the middle of the high school stadium at night. In bathrooms and janitorial closets. At parties. In her girlfriends' bedrooms.

'Seriously?'

'She wanted to fuck everywhere. She told me once she liked to see a place and be able to remember fucking there.'

'It's a wonder you guys ever got any work done.'

Though he certainly loved to reminisce, it was hard to get away from a central note of sadness in Cory. Though it had obviously been amazing to

date someone like Juliette in high school, I got the impression he'd been through some dark times since then.

I asked him if he'd ever been out with anyone like her after Juliette went to college, and he wrinkled his nose like he was trying not to cry.

'Other girls just aren't like her, are they?' he said candidly. 'Most of them just lie there, you know? They're like, just give me your big dick, and that'll be good. And as long as you come, they think they've done everything you could've wanted.'

I nodded. 'You mean you like a little conversation after sex? So what's your view on Proust's final novel, my dear?'

He shrugged. 'Juliette knew what she wanted, you know? She wasn't just a hole.'

Aww. Underneath it all, in his own way, Cory was a sensitive man. With a huge cock.

Anyway, it was at this opportune moment that our fair Juliette returned from her latest bout of disco antics, all smiles and flushed from her exertions — and apparently surprised to find me there, hanging out with her ex some more.

'You two?' she asked, a little breathless.

I grinned. 'Turns out, we have something in common.'

She gave me a brief look of uncertain disapproval, as though she suspected our conversation could have strayed into somewhat intrusive territory, but it was quickly overcome by her overall cheerfulness that Cory and I had apparently buried the hatchet.

'I need a drink,' she said, before promptly stealing mine and draining the cup. Easy come, easy go.

At that point, we heard the booming bass of some Calvin Harris number begin to shake the ground like the T-Rex in Jurassic Park, and Juliette's girlfriends were clamoring for her to return to the fray. I was happy enough for her to go dance some more. Let her get it out of her system. I wanted no part of it — other than to watch her, of course.

But, as Juliette looked at me apologetically for being compelled to leave me yet again, an idea suddenly sprang to my mind.

I pulled her to me and jammed my mouth against her ear to suggest, ‘Dance with Cory some more — I think he really needs cheering up.’

That little suggestion came as quite a shock to her. She’d already danced with her ex tonight, and that had been to punish me for being a dick. But now I was asking her to dance with him again.

She stared at me for a long moment, examining my face for signs that I was trying to be funny, or sarcastic, or downright caustic. I offered her an expression of full, earnest innocence, and as she finally seemed to accept that I was being genuine, her outright shock melted away. She even looked touched that I would be so selfless.

I gave her a little shrug to suggest it was nothing. That it was mainly because I’d never been one for dancing, unlike Cory here.

We were married. We could communicate like that without words, with a single look.

The look she gave me in reply said, ‘Well, it’s impressive, nevertheless, and I love you.’

Then she cheerfully grabbed Cory’s hand again, yanking him out toward the dance floor like a handler at the Westminster Dog Show leading a Labrador retriever out into the arena to perform for the crowd.

Cory didn’t seem to object to the fact that she hadn’t even asked him.

I felt a little shiver of pleasure shimmy through my body at watching them go. My gorgeous wife taking her infatuated ex out onto the dance floor again, clinging to him as they began to move to the music.

They were even more affectionate together than before — well, I’d told her he needed cheering up. And now that I’d become more friendly with Cory, he’d been made aware I had absolutely no problem with him dancing with my wife.

Juliette’s friends didn’t seem to question that she was dancing with someone who was not her husband. In fact, I wondered if they even remembered I existed. I hadn’t spent much time with them tonight. They appeared highly approving of Juliette dancing with her old flame — as though it was all part of the nostalgia.

I watched her dancing with him, and they really were like a couple.

Was that his hand on her delectable rear?

Was she pressing herself against him, so she might be able to tell whether he was hard?

I could hardly breathe, it was so thrilling to watch them.

The way they held each other, the way they looked at each other. The occasional touches that might have seemed inappropriate, but were apparently being dismissed by them both as accidental.

They were both aroused — you could tell.

He wanted her, desperately. But also, she wanted him.

I could hardly believe how exhilarating it was to watch.

What if she let him slip a hand up her skirt? What if she started grinding up against his huge great dick? I thought I might just about come in my pants without even touching myself.

Juliette wasn't even looking over to me anymore. She was getting lost in the music, lost in the nostalgia, lost in the desire for her first love.

What if the two of them forgot about being on their best behavior because her husband was watching?

CHAPTER 3

MY WIFE WAS DANCING with her ex again.

This time, she wasn't trying to punish me. It didn't feel quite as dangerous — though there was still an odd hopeful note throughout my being that something dangerous might still happen nevertheless.

That was my new kink shining through.

It was a strange experience, discovering a new kink like that. It had happened so quickly, I hardly had time to get used to it.

I watched my wife dancing with her old boyfriend and told myself it was just that I'd been drinking, and that she was wearing a sexy cheerleader outfit because it was her high school reunion and she'd felt like being ironic. Or something.

But really, deep down, I knew it was more significant than that. Sometimes you can tell when your life has completely changed, even when the change appears subtle to everyone else. When you finally get your driver's license. When you no longer have to go to class ever again. When you can hang out with your buddies in a bar and you don't need that fake ID anymore. When you date someone you can actually introduce to other people as your 'girlfriend'. When some agrees to be your wife.

Juliette thought I was being nice, telling her to dance with Cory. Because he'd started getting depressed. I liked that she thought I was being nice.

I liked more that she was now trying to make a joke of it by pretending to flirt with him outrageously.

She knew I was watching. She knew how a husband was supposed to feel about his wife paying that kind of attention to another man. And because I'd told her to dance with him, she was teasing me by dancing close with him, putting her arms around him, running her hands all over him, gazing into his eyes longingly.

She signaled to me that she was teasing me by occasionally glancing over at me, flashing me a big, wide, bright grin. Giggling at her own mischievous mood.

I smiled back at her, reassuring her everything was all right. Letting her know I trusted her. Letting her assume I believed nothing could possibly happen between her and her first real boyfriend.

But underneath the surface I was imagining how it had been between those two a decade previously. I was turning back the clock in my head, picturing them like this only tearing off each other's clothes. Falling into bed together. Tangling in a sweaty mass of teenage lust.

My filthy mind extrapolated their movements from the polite, chaste dancing into something carnal, sweaty, uncontrolled.

I watched them and raised my glass in a silent toast to them when Juliette glanced my way to laugh about how silly we all were, and I hoped that maybe my sweet wife would get lulled into accidentally doing something naughty with her ex.

She might get carried away, not realizing what was happening until it was too late. Then she would try to apologize to me, and I would let her know it was okay — that I wanted her to have fun with him.

By then, we'd be in an easier place for me to admit to my new kink, whatever it was.

I like seeing you with him, my love. It turns me on to think you used to sleep with him. That maybe you might want to again.

Ah well, a guy can fantasize.

But you know, it wasn't just fantasizing at this stage. My wife was dancing with another guy. She might have been teasing me, but she was

still basically flirting with him — and he was flirting right back. She might be doing it in a way she could later walk back with a disclaimer that she was joking, but she was still obviously happy to see Cory again — and delighted that she was allowed to dance with him.

It was more than she'd ever allow me to do with an ex.

They were pretending to go wild, to dance with a hint of wickedness — but they were actually touching each other, brushing hands against skin, bodies pressing against bodies. They were giving each other little flirty glances that expressed real attraction. You couldn't fake that.

They were both on their best behavior — sadly — but I could still drawn some enjoyment from it.

I was still hard as a rock as I watched them together.

The Machiavelli inside me was searching for ideas on how to relight the fire between them. I'd even wondered if the key would be to get her angry at me again. It had worked a treat when she'd felt like dancing with Cory in order to punish me for my rudeness.

But we were past that now.

A new song came on. Juliette looked over in my direction to see if I was gesturing at her to stop. When she spotted me in exactly the same place I'd been before, by the bar, I gave her a big thumbs up to encourage her to keep going.

I even blew her exaggerated kisses to praise her for their dancing, like some drunken opera fan demanding an encore.

It made her giggle, and it made her relax. It showed her that I was fully on board with their dance partnership, that there was another man to do the honors, because I preferred not to. But there was still a wicked gleam of mischief in her eyes. She wanted to provoke me, somehow.

I liked that.

She was leaning into him, murmuring something into his ear with a real conspiratorial look in her expression. As though she was plotting something. Let's make my husband insanely jealous, she seemed to be suggesting to Cory. And Cory nodded like a Labrador retriever being offered a treat.

This was a good sign.

Now as they danced, I sensed a new kind of seriousness between them. They gazed in each other's eyes like they couldn't get away from each other, they held hands, they pulled each other closer than ever. They were doing little twirls, swivels, dips like they were at a salsa dancing class.

She even had him put his hands on her prim little butt.

This was sexy dancing, not playful dancing. I felt like my insides were melting with the heat. The arousal.

The chemistry between them was phenomenal. Like any moment they could slip and accidentally start making out.

Juliette kept glancing over at me, though it was more subtle now. She wanted to check if I was getting anxious, if I was getting angry, if they had finally crossed a line. Only whenever our eyes connected, I was continuing to smile at her, to give her the thumbs up or a silent toast to encourage her to continue.

I wonder if I disappointed her, but not getting jealous.

She was having fun, though, so much fun. And her friends were all around. They seemed to think it was entirely natural that she was dancing with Cory. That there was no husband in the picture. Maybe some of them had even forgotten she was married to some other guy.

I could not get away from the thought of her fucking Cory. It was the biggest turn-on ever.

Had he fucked her in that cheerleader outfit?

Of course he had. Loads of times. At the end of football games — football practices — he'd taken her in his truck. He'd gone with her back home to change. He'd banged her in that little skirt in her bedroom.

She was the best sex I ever had. And the most sex.

Another song came to a close, and still I signaled for them to continue. Now they seemed entirely at ease with each other, and with me watching — and they had accepted the challenge to push my limits to breaking point.

What they didn't know is that maybe I didn't have a breaking point.

As a slow number began, they jokingly held hands and then, as the joke persisted, put arms around each other to dance like they were a couple.

And they did seem like a couple.

It made me ripple all over with arousal. Arousal and anxiety. Excitement and fear. Why was it such an enthralling mixture of emotions? Like riding a rollercoaster.

Had they danced together at Prom? Of course they had. Then later, they'd torn off each other's clothes, and had gone at it like wild animals.

Cory's own words whirled around my head.

I fucked her so much, man. Even now, I can close my eyes and picture her naked. Any time I want.

Juliette was so smiley and flushed and a little damp with sweat. She looked just breathtakingly beautiful. I watched them cling to each other and felt an immensely strong desire for my wife — the strongest desire I'd felt for her in a long time. Perhaps even since before we were married. Only... it wasn't just desire for her.

It was desire to watch her fucking Cory.

They came off the dance floor and I supplied them with fresh drinks like they were athletes the the middle of a long distance race.

Was I trying to get them drunk so they might lose their inhibitions?

I was a bad, bad man.

In my defense, they did seem thirsty. And everyone was having fun. It was all consensual, Your Honor. Then they were somewhat surprised I was encouraging them to get back out onto the dance floor for some more dancing. Juliette was thinking maybe I'd had too much to drink, I had to persuade her that I was thinking rationally — that it was simply that I preferred not to dance myself, while recognizing that she was having a lot of fun dancing with Cory.

They had one more drink before I managed to persuade them everything was all right.

Now, though, they weren't dancing to tease me. I guess that hadn't worked anyway. I'd told them I wanted them to dance together, I wanted them to enjoy it — so now they were. They seemed to focus more on each other, while beginning to forget that I was there.

It was even more intensely thrilling for me, I can tell you. Me and my deviant new kink.

Now they weren't trying to get a rise out of me — they were trying to impress each other. Maybe the alcohol was acting on them, but I sensed that they were getting more accustomed to each other, getting back to the comfortable familiarity they had with each other way back when. A decade ago.

As the music continued on and on, they seemed to accept that Juliette's husband was not going to object to them enjoying the dancing together fully. They seemed to relax into it, embracing their chemistry, enjoying the attraction that still clearly existed between them.

I was on the edge of my seat, watching them.

Juliette was so taken by the dancing. I suppose it wasn't something we did much of within our relationship. And she was so familiar with Cory, she felt so safe with him. It was easy just to let go and forget the outside world. She would rest her head on his shoulder, or nuzzle his neck a little, as though they were in love.

For a long moment, it looked like she was about to kiss him.

I was on edge, enthralled by what I was seeing.

Maybe the alcohol was getting to me. I really didn't feel threatened. I felt enlightened. I felt empowered. I wanted my wife to be wicked.

God, she was so close to kissing him.

And then the music changed. Here was Beyonce to stir things up, to tell us she could do whatever she wanted, she could be bad if she wanted, she could do wrong if she wanted, she was a grown woman.

Juliette was startled out of her nostalgic daze, reminded that she was not married to the man with whom she'd just been dancing. There as a sudden note of panic on her face, and she was glancing around, searching

for me, horrified that she'd gone too far, that her jokey attempt to make me jealous had crossed a line.

Before she located me, she almost seemed terrified that I'd just stormed off.

But here I was, stepping into a pool of light to aid in her search. Looking like the very antithesis of a wronged husband.

She bolted from the dance floor, dashing toward me like it was the final scene in a Hollywood rom-com.

She kissed me, just briefly on the lips, as though to reassure me that what I'd seen her doing with Cory meant nothing. She tugged on my hand, as though urging me to come dance with her in place of Cory. That all she'd really wanted was to dance with me.

But I held firm. I pulled her to me, kissed her like I was some kind of alpha claiming her as my possession. She responded to it, melting into the kiss, moaning so that I could feel the vibrations of her moan, even though I couldn't hear much over the music.

She pressed herself against me and I know she could feel how hard I was. It surprised her for a moment — and then I felt her hands grabbing at it, confirming it for herself. Her eyes were wide, her pupils like huge pits of black, startled but thrilled by my hardness right in the middle of that public place.

Joyous that I wasn't angry at her for going too far with Cory.

I wasn't done surprising her, though.

'Dance with him,' I ordered her in no uncertain terms. Her expression turned quizzical as she continued to gaze into my eyes.

I put my hand over hers, clamping it to the bulge in my pants. 'I like watching you dance with him,' I said, and the way I pressed her hand against my hard-on made it clear what I meant by that.

Her jaw dropped.

How on Earth could I be so bold? This didn't feel like the normal me. Alcohol-assisted, I suppose. But it wasn't just that I was a little tipsy — the drinking gave me something to blame my behavior on if things didn't turn out well.

She raised an eyebrow, silently asking me, are you serious?

I stood my ground. No jokey smile now.

She caught her breath. I wasn't telling her to sleep with him, but I was telling her it turned me on to see her dancing with him. This was something wholly new for us. And I could tell it intrigued her. Maybe the thought of it turned her on, too. There was no innocent giggling. No teasing smile.

She kissed me again, deeply, intensely. It was full of meaning — she was telling me that she loved me, that she loved that I wanted her to have fun, she loved that it turned me on to watch her with Cory. She was excited that there was something new between us, some undiscovered secret she never knew about me.

In the darkness, she squeezed my cock through my pants. Celebrating its hardness, jubilant about its apparent cause.

Then she stepped away from me, one last question imprinted on her beautiful face: *are you sure about this?*

I gave her a solemn nod, then watched her turn and walk over to the other man again, to drape her arms over his shoulders and pull him to her.

And now Juliette and Cory began to dance with a new sense of purpose.

CHAPTER 4

JULIETTE WAS SO beautiful when she was happy. She was so beautiful when she was dancing. The two things were connected.

Had she missed out on happiness because I never took her dancing?

Had she missed out on good times because she'd married me, and dedicated herself to only one man?

I was besotted as I watched her move so gracefully on the dance floor, her golden hair so bright under the lights, the sweetness of her face accentuated by her joyful smile.

The fact she was wearing a cheerleader's outfit seemed a little wrong. Yet it wasn't the fact she was pretending to be a high school cheerleader that truly got me going. She was dancing with her ex-boyfriend.

She was really, truly enjoying herself. Going wild on the dance floor, laughing it up with her friends around her — and her former lover opposite her. I felt the pressure of being unable to offer this to her — because I was useless at dancing — lifted from my shoulders.

I also got to experience the strange thrill of Juliette dancing with another man after I'd told her out and out that I enjoyed watching her dancing with him.

Emboldened by this unexpected disclosure from her husband — and the alcohol cushioning her system — Juliette was taking her dancing with

Cory to a whole new level. Her flirting with her ex had gone from gentle playfulness to out-and-out seductive provocation.

The lustful glances were no longer jokey or ironic. The brief touches of hands on flesh were no longer accidental or purely to facilitate the mechanics of the dancing. The obvious attraction that still burned so bright between them was not a mere reminder of what had once been.

Juliette had been stunned by my revealing that I enjoyed watching her dancing with Cory — and now she was keen to test the limits of my enjoyment.

It was a new game for her, to make me jealous when I apparently was anything but.

As the song moved through the verses and a chorus or two, and into an instrumental section, I caught my breath at the sensual touching, the straying hands, the occasional inappropriate groping.

It wasn't always easy to fully appreciate everything happening between Juliette and her old flame, because so many other people clustered around them on the dance floor. We were getting to that stage in the evening where the alcohol was properly kicking in, and anybody left on their feet was getting pulled in by the music.

I had to move around to get the best views. I sometimes had to infiltrate the swaying masses to get the answers I needed.

Where was his hand?

Did she just grab his butt?

Had he shoved up her skirt?

I couldn't explain the strange compulsion I had to see my beautiful wife being wicked with this man, this doofus who had been her first real lover. I realized most husbands were not supposed to act this way. Silently celebrating every time this other guy took another liberty with my sweet Juliette.

Getting hard when they held each other tight, and I knew he was rubbing up against her to the point that she couldn't fail to tell he was hard for her.

Why was it such a thrill for me, knowing what was happening? Letting my wife touch him like that, allowing their carnal desire to run free.

There was a lot about my new kink I had to learn.

At the end of the song, Juliette excused herself from Cory again to return to me, and I could see she required a fresh dose of reassurance that everything was fine.

God, she looked amazing. Sweaty, glowing with excitement and arousal, she seemed so alive, so buzzed, and horny as could be. When she came over to me, she jammed her face in mine and kissed me hard. Testing me, making sure I still loved her. Boy did I. I tasted the salt on her lips, smelled the gentle mustiness of exercise on her body, and as my hand curled around her waist, I felt the searing heat of her body, since her cheerleading uniform left her midriff bare.

‘What’re you doing?’ she asked me, breathless as our kiss ended. I felt her hot breath on my ear. The music was so loud that you could only be heard with your lips up against the other person’s ear.

‘Watching you,’ I replied. ‘Go dance with him.’

Her hand moved over my thighs and up to my crotch — exploring my hardness, making sure it was still there. Her eyes flashed.

‘Why do you want me to dance with him?’ she asked.

‘Because you’re having fun,’ I said.

She wrinkled up her oh-so-pretty face to suggest that my reasoning did not compute.

I leaned in toward her ear again and said, ‘Because it turns me on.’

She gave me another of those *seriously?* expressions, which were mostly in the eyebrows. She peered into my eyes, trying to work me out. Trying to see if I was completely drunk, or perhaps mad, or maybe both.

I felt her hand at my crotch again, rubbing up against my hard cock through my pants.

I could have told her we should leave, find our hotel. She would have readily gone with me. I could have bent her over the bed to take her in that cheerleader outfit. The signals she was giving me were plain. But I

still wanted more. I felt like there was an opportunity here. If I wasted it, there might not be another.

‘Dance with him,’ I ordered her. ‘Go on — you’re having a great time.’

‘The event ends soon,’ she said, turning on her heels and heading back toward the dance floor without questioning my demand.

I watched her go to him, I watched her grab him. I watched her move with him. She wasn’t trying to punish me now; she wasn’t trying to make me jealous. She was trying to seduce me through Cory. She wanted to get me so heated up that I dragged her from the dance floor, stuffed her in a taxi, and took her straight back to the hotel for a little horizontal one-on-one.

Her dancing with Cory had ramped up into an R-rated performance. There weren’t many limits on the touching now, although clothes still remained in place. I wondered if he’d had his fingers inside her. I watched her press her cheek up against his as they danced, and the way they were moving made it look like they were having sex standing up.

It took my breath away.

I could picture how they must have been when they were both in their final year of high school.

Cory knew I was watching, but he didn’t seem to care. She was granting him the kind of access he’d dreamed about for an entire decade since they’d split up.

I concealed a shiver of excitement when I saw her move his hands to her breasts, granting him full permission to stroke her there, through her dress.

I held my breath when I saw her put a hand between his legs and caress his manhood through his pants.

I gasped as I saw her slide his hand under her dress.

This was intense. I’d never seen my wife so much as look at another man in all the time we’d been together, and now here was someone touching her bare flesh.

I’d never seen anything so hot.

To give Cory his dues, he was letting her take the lead on the crossing of boundaries. He wasn't taking anything that wasn't offered. Was his hand on her pussy? Was his finger inside her?

I was so hard watching them. I could hardly believe that my beautiful, loyal wife had gone this far with another man right in front of me. It was so wicked, it was so sexy.

But then the music stopped — and the house lights went on. The dancing stopped. The temperature in the high school gymnasium seemed to drop a few degrees in the blink of an eye. It was all over. The moment was gone.

People were chatting, milling around, slowly vacating the dance floor.

I was disappointed. Things had been going so well.

I saw Juliette talking with some of her old friends. Were they all saying goodbye? Damn it. If things had gone on for just one more song...

At last, my sweet wife came back toward me, dragging her ex-boyfriend behind her. Well, at least she looked happy. Bright-eyed and bushy-tailed. Glistening with perspiration and rosy-red from the dancing.

Looking immensely fuckable, I might add.

'Everybody's going on to a club,' she said, no longer having to bellow directly into my ear.

I felt my heart leap.

'We should go, too,' I said, though as soon as I said it, I guessed she'd already decided to do that anyway.

She smiled sweetly, pleased I was on board.

Then I nodded toward Cory and said, 'Is he coming, too?'

There was a question on her face. There was a moment before I realized she wanted this to be my decision.

I said, 'Bring him. It'll be fun.'

More surprise broke out on her face. It suited her. It emphasized her cuteness.

Then her friends were all around her, pulling her along in their tidal wave of fun-seeking inebriation. She gave me a smirk and an amused little shrug, as though to say what're you gonna do? And she allowed herself to be dragged off toward the exit — reaching out to take hold of Cory's hand and drag him with her.

I followed along, buzzing with hopeful anticipation that the night would continue, that we might find our mojo again and return to the sexy groove.

Outside on the street, the party was continuing while people found taxis. Juliette was chatting with her friends cheerfully, and she was hanging off Cory like she was so distracted by conversation she'd forgotten they were no longer the couple. With her friends all around her, everyone was just buzzing, like they'd been given a chance to time-travel back to their glory days.

I got a little separated from them because a few inebriated people were falling toward waiting taxis, and I was barred by the current from following my wife into a car.

I ended up in another vehicle with a bunch of people I didn't know. I didn't care — everyone was going to the same place.

In the darkness, I didn't really listen to the conversation. And then I heard my wife's name on some other girl's lips, so my focus was drawn to her words as she said, 'Did you see her with Cory? They're so sweet.' One of the other girls in the taxi saying, 'They're so lucky to have each other.'

Like they'd forgotten she was married to someone else. Or maybe they didn't know.

I didn't mind. I was kind of amused by it. Turned on by it.

Then we were there, piling out of the taxi, stumbling into the club. There wasn't any kind of line. No bouncers checking names on a list. This wasn't a Big City place, this was my wife's college town.

Inside, it was dark, the place lit with neon colors here and there, but shadows running riot. I needed another drink. I wanted to stay in the moment and maintain the comforting haze of semi-inebriation. I went to order a bourbon on the rocks. Downed it.

It wasn't difficult to find everyone again. There they were, in the middle of the dance floor.

Juliette hanging onto Cory like he was a superhero who had just rescued her from a terrifying fall. God. Their chemistry just took my breath away. And yet I still wasn't jealous. I loved the fact that my wife was obviously so elated. It was just beautiful to watch. And such a thrill.

She had seemed to forget herself a little, like her friends.

She was so into him. And then they were making out, and I was hard as steel watching them.

What a kiss.

It was like a Hollywood movie kiss, the romantic leads find each other again at the end of a turbulent third act.

They were making out and it was so frantic, so raw, so steamy, so viciously sexy. Sucking face like they were in a private room, shielded from any scrutiny.

And I just wanted them to go on and on.

They were really going for it. Hands all over each other, groping. Mouths all over each other, sucking on lips, tongues in full tango.

I saw his hands on her hips. On her butt.

Sliding up under her dress.

Weirdly, I didn't feel threatened. If anything, I felt oddly protected from bad vibes. I think maybe it was a married guy kind of thing. As far as I was concerned, I couldn't conceivably be seen as the one in the wrong here. There was zero chance that I would get in trouble with my wife — because she was the one doing this. That gave me a curious sense of serenity.

And at the same time, watching her with him was just plain hot. My insides were melting.

My pants were too tight, I was so hard.

Our marriage was fine; there wasn't anything wrong with our relationship. All of this could be blamed on alcohol, so what was the problem if it went a little far?

'Your wife is making out with some other guy.'

The voice snapped me out of my daze. Oddly, it came from below me. I looked downward and to my right, and there was the guy I'd briefly met at the reunion. Brian. The short guy in a blazer and khaki chinos who'd confessed to having had a major crush on Juliette when they'd been at high school.

I looked down at him and shrugged. 'Yeah, she is.'

I didn't really care about what Brian might think of me. And yet, it turned out that talking to another human being about what Juliette was doing with Cory only felt like confirming it was happening. And in a weird way, that only enhanced the arousal I felt about what I was watching.

Brian didn't seem too shocked at my nonchalant response.

He said, 'You're into it.'

I didn't reply to that. I just stood there watching Cory Fallon going at my wife in the middle of the darkened club. Just doing that seemed to give Brian the answer he needed. I vaguely wondered if Brian was going to make fun of me, call me a pussy or something, because I wasn't fighting for my wife.

But he said, 'I would be too, if I were you.'

That caught me a little by surprise. I glanced down at him.

'My second wife...' he said, and hesitated, unsure whether I would listen to him. I made it clear I was listening to him, and he continued, 'She liked this guy at work... I said she should just have some fun with him if she wanted...'

It seemed fascinating that someone like Brian would have had at least two wives in his back catalog. Let alone that he would allow one of them to 'have fun' with a guy from her work, whatever that had entailed.

'What happened?' I asked him.

He smiled. 'It was pretty hot at first. She was pretty excited about the guy at work. Happy I would let her see him.'

Something in his tone indicated there was no happy ending to this particular tale.

'She dated the other guy?' I prompted.

Brian said, 'For a while. And it was so incredible... she would come back to me after seeing him... and feel like rewarding me for letting her have fun with him...'

'What happened?'

He shrugged. 'After a while, the other guy wanted her to himself.'

'She stopped seeing him?'

'She stopped seeing me.'

Poor guy.

'I'm sorry,' I said, and he gave me a little smile to appreciate my empathy.

'If you love someone, set them free,' he said, and he didn't sound sad, which was a surprise.

'But she didn't come back to you?' I asked him.

He shook his head. 'I guess it wasn't meant to be.'

I watched Juliette laughing with Cory. They really were acting like a couple in love right now. They couldn't take their hands off each other. It was so weird to see, after all the time I'd had her to myself. All the time we'd been married and a lifelong monogamy was assumed.

Brian's story was pretty awful. And yet, while it did give me pause for thought, a warning I felt I ought to at least take on board, at the same time, the danger it clarified also seemed to make the thrill of watching

my wife groping and making out with another guy that much more intense.

‘You regret letting her date that guy?’ I asked Brian.

To my surprise, he shook his head again. ‘It’s who I am,’ he said. ‘I know that now. If I could only find the right woman... it’s what I want.’

‘The seeing other guys part,’ I clarified. ‘Not the leaving you part.’

He grinned. ‘I know there’s someone out there who’ll want what I can give her.’

His confidence was encouraging. But the way he explained himself — it’s who I am — that part was the most encouraging of all. It felt unexpectedly empowering. I looked into his eyes and felt like he understood where I was coming from. He got me. I was like him — and that coincidence made me feel that in all likelihood, that meant there were probably plenty of other guys out there like us.

It was oddly comforting to imagine that I was not alone in these new feelings I was having about my wife.

I said to him, ‘If your wife came back to you now, said she’d made a mistake...’

He smiled, ‘She might, you know. She still might.’

‘You’d take her back?’

‘Of course.’ I think that was the moment I recognized that I liked Brian. He was a nice guy. He said, ‘It’s difficult for people who aren’t like us to really understand where we’re coming from.’

Brian’s words seemed important to me.

When my focus returned to Juliette, I realized that she was no longer dancing with Cory. The two of them were just standing there now, sucking face.

Kind of shocking. Kind of exciting.

Weirdly beautiful to watch.

Was it that I wished I was in Cory's place? That Juliette would feel so buzzed to kiss me like that? Not really. I didn't envy Cory. I wanted him to do wicked things with Juliette, but I didn't wish I was him in wanting that. I wanted my wife to have the thrill of sexual contact with somebody different, somebody she wasn't obligated to spend all her time with.

I wanted to appreciate the grace and beauty of my wife having sex with someone who was not me.

I glanced down to see what Brian thought of what Juliette was doing with Cory now, but the little guy was gone.

Jeez. Juliette and Cory were really going at it.

I couldn't believe it. I almost wondered if I should quietly leave so they would feel they had the space to do what they really wanted to. But then Juliette might have mistakenly believed I'd stormed off, horrified that she'd gone so far with her ex-boyfriend. I didn't want her to be afraid of doing this. I wanted her to feel supported.

But now the song ended, and I saw my wife snap out of her dreamlike state and seem to realize what she'd been lulled into.

After being transported back in time to when she and Cory had been an item by the music, the magic spell was broken when it stopped. It left her aware of what she'd been doing with him even though she was married to someone else.

She came up for air gasping for oxygen, flushed, exhilarated, glistening with sweat like she'd already fucked him. But she was looking about herself with fear and uncertainty.

She was afraid she'd gone way too far with all this.

I could see her searching around, peering through the darkness, gripped by panic. I realized she couldn't see me because I was standing in the shadows while she was under the stronger lights over the dance floor.

She was terrified I'd left her.

I stepped into the nearest pool of light and saw some relief suddenly spark in her pretty face as she spotted me, though her fear wasn't altogether dispelled.

She came running. She dashed through the crowd, ignoring her friends as they asked her what the matter was. As she approached me, she was babbling, distraught, sobbing even. Saying something about making a huge mistake.

I laughed. Asked her what was wrong.

I pulled her to me, kissed her just beneath the ear. Put my mouth close so she could hear me say, 'You guys are so hot together.'

She looked at me, startled.

'Invite him back to our hotel,' I said, and for a moment wondered if I'd gone too far with this.

She jerked her head back, a big question on her face as she gazed into my eyes. I wondered if I'd crossed the line. If I was now the one in trouble. Did she think I was some kind of pervert for wanting this?

I was preparing an apology. Preparing to blame the drink. Thinking to myself that all of this had gone too far after all. Maybe I needed to be more careful with this.

Brian's words came back to me. It's difficult for people who aren't like us to really understand where we're coming from.

Juliette was astonished at what I'd suggested. Maybe she'd think I was confessing to being bisexual or gay. That I wanted her to bring Cory back to our hotel so that I could seduce him myself. I'd have to persuade her that, no, I really wasn't interested in being with a man myself. I wanted to see her enjoy him.

Overhead, the next song finally got going, and it seemed to soften the ice between us.

I could see Juliette shaking a little, her eyes locked on mine. But she didn't appear disapproving of what I'd suggested. She seemed intrigued. Silently, she assessed me once again, checking for signs of inebriation.

She said, 'Are you serious?'

The way she said it offered an opportunity. If I was too nervous, I felt I could have cracked a smile right then and turned all this into a joke. She would have apologized for taking things too far with Cory, and I would have said I let it go on too long. That I'd only wanted her to have fun

dancing, and not feel constrained because she was married to someone who didn't like to dance.

But this was also an opportunity to take a step into the thrilling adventure of the unknown.

I thought about Brian and how he'd been. Poor guy seemed devastated by the loss of his wife, and yet he didn't seem to regret what he'd offered her.

It's who I am.

I leaned against Juliette, my mouth jammed against her ear so there could be no doubt she would hear me over all this music.

I said, 'I want to watch you fuck him.'

She gasped. But she didn't look outraged or horrified. She looked like she was trying to keep calm in the circumstances. Quivering, like her petite frame couldn't quite contain the intense, horny energy flowing through her.

I had never seen her so turned on.

She stepped back, shock still imprinted on her face. And then, slowly, she went over to her ex-boyfriend to offer herself to him.

CHAPTER 5

THE STREET OUTSIDE was cool and relatively calm. We were all trembling a little, and not only because of the chill compared to the hot, humid club we'd just left.

Juliette and I had never done anything remotely like this before. Taking a guy home with us. Even if it was her ex — someone she knew well, better than almost any other person except for me — it was strange.

I could see my sweet wife wrap her arm around his waist as we waited for a taxi, and it just seemed wrong. She was mine, yet there was a real familiarity in how she held him, a comfort level that shouldn't have been there with someone else.

Cory glanced over at me and gave a polite little nod.

He'd enjoyed dancing with her so far this evening. I could tell he didn't quite understand what I was doing here — that if Juliette was so intent on having fun with him, her husband should have long since stormed off.

But he wasn't objecting to my being there. He wanted all this to continue, in whatever fashion possible. He made me think of a character in an action movie facing certain death, looking for any possible way to delay his doom, to scratch out more time to figure out an escape.

Cory wasn't looking for an escape, he was looking for a way into Juliette's panties. And weirdly, it thrilled me that we intended to give him that opportunity.

Here was the taxi.

Shivering, I watched my wife climbing it after Cory, her hand clutching his like they were a real couple.

I ducked inside myself, closing the door as I wedged in beside my wife and her ex. Breathing in the thick smell of sweat and sex as I sealed us inside the warm, close confines of the car.

Before we'd even pulled away from the curb, she was all over him again, the two of them making out like they'd just discovered it. This time, though, while she sucked on Cory's face, I felt her hand move over my crotch, her fingers seeking out the bulge between my thighs.

I felt a pleasant surge of hormones as her fingers closed on my hard cock, clawing at it through my pants. Feeling how hard I was for her — for them — only spurred her on with Cory.

I caught the gaze of the driver in his mirror.

He gave me a little eye roll — commiserating with me, assuming I was probably annoyed that my friends were sucking face right beside me, leaving me as the third wheel. I smiled back at him, shrugged, like, *what're you gonna do?*

It wasn't long before we were pulling up in front of the hotel.

I paid for the cab and followed them into the lobby.

Cory recognized me as I stepped into the elevator after them, and he seemed suddenly disappointed — devastated, in fact. Like he hadn't realized I was there with them in the club, and in the taxi. That I had been watching Juliette fool around with him and approved of all of it. Like he thought I was here now, so it was all over.

Hadn't he seen me on the dance floor with them? In the taxi, wedged up against Juliette on her other side?

He said, 'Dude, I didn't...'

As though he really thought he could lie his way out of accusations of cheating.

I grinned, said, 'Dude, you're okay. All's good.'

He furrowed his brow.

Then Juliette giggled, and pulled him into another French kiss, right in front of me. I could see he was startled by it, confused. But then she kept it going, and I wasn't objecting, so he seemed to settle, easing into their kiss.

As the elevator continued to slowly climb, and Juliette continued to make out with her ex, she reached for me. She took hold of my hand, guiding it between her humid thighs, under her dress.

She pressed my hand to her soaking wet panties, including me in their moment.

While she sucked on Cory's tongue, she moaned as my middle finger found its way between her slippery folds, dipping into her molten sex.

She almost purred as I stirred her pussy.

Then the elevator slowed. We all disengaged like we were worried we'd be caught by the School Principal.

Then we were stumbling along the hallway, Juliette pulling out her key card.

Three of us falling into our own private space.

In the room, a moment of reality seemed to kick in.

I had to admit, I hadn't been expecting this, but as it happened it seemed both predictable and entirely rational. Now the three of us were sealed in our own private den with the potential that actual sex could happen, it felt like the significance of the possibility sobered us all up completely.

Up to now, there had been a lot of teasing, plenty of groping and making out, but now it seemed like all joking was done. We were isolated from the party, just the three of us, and the purpose of our being there was for Juliette to have sex — apparently with Cory.

It was a fairly shocking proposition.

The two of them might be highly familiar with each other, but Juliette was now a married woman — and married to me.

I suppose if I hadn't been there, they might have quietly forgotten about me, and it might have been easier for them to fall back into the mindset of their high school selves, perhaps tumble straight into bed before tearing off each other's clothes in a fever of lust.

But the husband was here.

Everyone suddenly felt a bit self-conscious.

I wondered if we were going to chicken out at this final stage of a highly erotically charged night. Cory would duck out, or perhaps suggest crashing on the armchair in the corner. We would quietly make ourselves comfortable on the bed for some disappointing sleep.

'There's a minibar,' I said, feeling like I sounded a bit stupid.

Juliette's face brightened, but like she was forcing it, and she said, 'Great!'

I fought my way through the awkwardness and ducked down to open the refrigerated minibar.

'Vodka? Bourbon? Beer?' I said, eyes flicking over the bottles.

Cory rubbed his jaw casually. 'I'll take a beer.'

Juliette said, 'Vodka.'

I dished out the booze to the others, and then took a travel-sized bottle of bourbon for myself, trying not to shake as I poured a tiny bottle of whiskey into a glass and drained it.

We all stood around looking at each other as we sipped our courage potion — or necked it, in Juliette's case. Smiling like we were willing the party to continue, but not quite feeling it.

I could see Juliette trembling a little with nerves. She was still giving Cory the kind of glances that suggested she hoped something was going to happen, but the anxiety was palpable.

What were we doing in there? Were we crazy thinking this could happen? This wasn't what normal married people did. I was shaking, too.

Cory glanced at me like an actor on set, waiting for direction.

‘You guys ever do it in a hotel room?’ I said. It seemed completely unsophisticated, uncouth, as it left my mouth — but I was flailing a little here.

Thankfully, it made the others grin.

Looking around us, apparently admiring the three-star opulence of our environs, Cory said, ‘Nope, we never did it in a hotel. Would’ve been nice, maybe.’

Juliette giggled nervously. ‘Would have been nice to be in our own hotel room,’ she said, her arms loosely folded as she hovered nervously.

Cory leaned back on the dresser by the TV, running his eyes all over Juliette, who still looked incredible in her blue-and-white cheerleader outfit. I got the sense he was plucking up the courage to do something. He realized things were stalling a little, and that if he really wanted the chance to do something hot with Juliette again, hopes could soon fade.

‘I remember wanting to take you to that Motel-6 sometime,’ Cory said.

Juliette giggled. ‘Really?’

Cory shrugged. ‘Your birthday was coming up... if we’d have stayed together until the end of summer, we would have done it.’

‘Wow,’ Juliette laughed, turning to see how I was responding to it all. ‘That would have been wild.’

I laughed with her. I said, ‘Well, we’re in our own room now...’

My sweet wife was looking at me like, are you really serious about this?

I handed out some more booze. We all felt far too sober. I suppose nobody had been drinking during a lot of the dancing — except perhaps me. I was a little unsteady on my feet, but I still needed another teeny-tiny bottle of bourbon.

‘You guys look so good together,’ I said, my words sounding a touch slurred.

‘Yeah?’ Cory said, suddenly pulling himself up to his feet to stand beside Juliette like they were about to pose for a photograph.

I said, 'Yeah, I can totally picture you as king and queen of the prom.'

Juliette stood against her old flame, brushing her long, golden hair with a hand, her eyes a touch glazed as though she was remembering past glories.

'We were king and queen,' she smirked. 'Everyone thought we'd stay in town forever, get married.'

'How about a picture?' I said, pulling out my phone.

They seemed happy to pose for it, though the backdrop of a cheap hotel room gave the scene a tawdry note that meant it would hardly be the kind of picture you pulled out to show other people.

Juliette's expression was one of gentle surprise, like she couldn't quite fathom why we were still doing this.

I felt frustration slipping in. Embarrassment.

I feared this was going to turn out to be one of those cringeworthy moments I'd spend the rest of my life unable to shed from my memory, forever shamed by the sheer awkwardness of it all.

'Come on,' I said, as though pleading with them. 'Let's have some fun, huh? Nobody knows we're here. We don't ever have to say anything to anyone...'

Juliette seemed to relax, her smile even becoming a little more genuine, as though my reminder had settled her down some.

Cory grinned and said, 'Yeah, we're just having fun.' He was standing like he was trying to project manliness. He had to prove his alpha credentials.

I realized they really were performers waiting for the director to call the shots.

I said to Juliette, 'If you were single, and you'd never met him before, you'd still go for him?'

She laughed and turned to check out her ex. 'I guess he'd do...' she said, amused at this whole question. She put a hand on his chest as though assessing the quality of his muscles — as though she was contemplating purchasing him at some kind of meat market.

Cory smiled, obviously proud of his efforts in the gym. ‘You’d totally go for me,’ he said.

Juliette laughed at his complete lack of modesty.

‘When we first got together, I was so nervous,’ she said. ‘You were this football god, and I was, like, nobody...’

Cory said, ‘You were so beautiful.’ Then a moment later, he figured he needed to add, ‘Still are...’

His self-correction amused Juliette.

She said, ‘I kept seeing you around... and I never thought you’d even look at me... my friends and I would go to football practice to watch you...’

‘Perverts,’ I joked.

She giggled. ‘Totally. I joined the cheer squad just so I had an excuse to see him.’

More booze. It felt like we were warming up a little.

‘I saw you on the sidelines,’ he told her. ‘I couldn’t miss noticing you.’

Juliette cooed, ‘God, you would take off your shirt after practice, and all the girls in the squad would just melt...’

For some strange reason I got a real buzz listening to my wife talk about her crush on this guy. It was like watching a sweet rom-com with two likable actors with great chemistry — and you really want them to get together. In fact, you kind of want to see them get naughty together.

‘How did you actually get together?’ I prompted them.

Juliette looked to Cory, turned to him. ‘It was at that party,’ she said. ‘At... Sarah’s...’

‘Yeah,’ Cory nodded.

Juliette giggled, ‘There were grown-ups present. But there was this huge bowl of punch...’

‘It was a bucket,’ Cory noted.

‘And someone tipped a bottle of vodka into it,’ Juliette continued. ‘And that was the first time I ever had anything like that to drink... and I just wandered through the crowd, walked straight up to him and said, hey, I’m Juliette.’

Cory grinned. ‘Man.’

Juliette stood in front of him like they were recreating the scene. I loved how she was looking at him — with clear desire. The way they were both gazing into each other’s eyes, harking back to a sweet meet-cute during their teenage years.

She said to him, ‘You said to me ‘I know who you are,’ and I nearly melted into an actual puddle...’

I said quietly, ‘Then what happened?’

Total fanboy.

Cory leaned toward her, looming over her, and she seemed delighted. I got the sense that, at this point in the story, they might have kissed for the first time.

Eyes locked on him, Juliette said softly, ‘I was hoping he’d kiss me... but he didn’t. Not yet.’

‘I wanted to,’ Cory grinned.

Juliette said, ‘I went home and felt like I was just on fire... just because you knew who I was...’

I didn’t want to point out the logical flaw in the story — that this couldn’t be how they’d actually gotten together, because they didn’t actually get together... However, hearing them tell the story, watching them remember together, it seemed that in their minds that was the moment they connected.

Juliette said, ‘After that, whenever I was at football practice, you would come up to me and say ‘hey.’ And I was just a mess every time...’

Cory smirked. ‘You were not a mess.’

‘And my friend Becky was like, he is totally into you, and I was like, no, he’s just nice, and we said ‘hey’ at that party...’

Jeez, I was melting just hearing them tell the story to each other.

She'd told me countless tales of her growing up, of her family and friends. I knew nothing of her erotic history before my time with her began. And now I was discovering it all in spectacular high-definition color.

I wanted to know everything.

The tension in the air was incredible — and my urge for something to happen between them. This was like watching Lois Lane with Clark Kent in the moment after she realizes he's actually Superman. I swear, my wife was gazing at this stud beside her, willing him to get naked, and I just wanted her to tear off his clothes and have her wicked way with him.

But the stars of this picture needed a director.

I said, 'So when did you first kiss?'

Juliette stepped nearer to him still. 'It was the last game of the season, just before we officially became Seniors...'

Cory nodded solemnly. 'Montgomery. That was a hard game.'

Juliette said, 'They lost by, like, two points. And they all came off the field looking so dejected... but I wasn't thinking about them losing... I went up to him, and he was so handsome in his uniform...'

'Sweaty,' Cory joked.

'And I just went up to him and, like, totally lost control...'

I said, 'You kissed him?'

Cory said, 'Uh-huh...'

God... they were really getting lost in the moment. Juliette eased into him — remembering, picturing herself during that point in time. The two of them were nostalgic, and it drew them together at the lips.

And then they were kissing, right in front of me. Replaying their first time, heads slightly tilted, eyes closed, lips pressed tenderly together.

I took a step back, just enchanted. I was watching a sweet, romantic movie at the theater, hoping the R-rating would deliver me some nudity.

They seemed to forget where they were, her fingers lightly touching his elbow, guiding him to put his hand onto her waist as they continued to gently kiss. I was only watching, but somehow I could tell how sweet and warm their kiss must feel; I could experience the thrilling moment of first love again for myself, through them.

I wonder if a life of watching movies had enabled me to live vicariously through the performance of others when it was done so authentically.

I heard Juliette quietly moan as they kissed, and felt a shiver of arousal sweep through my body.

God. The power of the experience was just unbelievable. This was first love, all over again. This was the energy of fresh attraction in a new couple who realized they were crazy about each other, and were now free to explore those feelings.

And it was like I was experiencing it through them.

I could hardly breathe, watching them together.

When their kiss came to an end, I felt disappointment briefly set in — but the sequel was hot on its heels. Now they pressed their mouths together for a deeper kiss. Juliette lifted up on tip-toes, stretching to drape her arms around his shoulders, while Cory's hands naturally fell to her peach of a behind, which he exposed to me by lifting her pleated blue-and-white skirt.

Boy, they were really getting into it. Losing themselves in the moment. Both of them quietly moaning as they made-out like lust-crazed teens.

I didn't feel self-conscious watching them. It was the most erotic thing I'd ever seen, but it also felt oddly natural.

It seemed like I'd been trained in voyeurism by a lifetime sitting in front of a screen.

And yet, the two lovers in front of me were not trained in performing for an audience. After a long, oh-so-sweet clinch between them, their nostalgic daze suddenly burst, and the realization of where they were came back into sharp focus.

Still gazing into each other's eyes, they smiled, laughed, and Juliette gently blushed.

Maybe if I hadn't been there, they would simply have continued. Part of me even regretted my presence.

Without even really thinking about it, I said, 'You guys are so good together...'

I didn't mean anything in particular by saying that, it was just a kind of natural emotional response to what I'd seen, but my words seemed to reassure Juliette, even though I could tell she was still a little taken aback at what had happened — and that it had happened in front of her husband.

My pretty wife smiled at Cory, who still seemed a little dazed by their kiss. She joked, 'I guess it's like riding a bike...'

I was still holding my phone. I could see from the little preview box in the corner of the screen that I'd taken at least one picture of the two of them making out.

I felt a flash of embarrassment and allowed my hands to fall to my side. It was one thing to take a picture of two people posing, but one of your wife kissing another man...

I don't think Juliette or Cory noticed.

As though to distract, I said, 'So when did you guys first... you know...'

Juliette giggled, and I saw that Cory was pulling up her skirt again — this time high enough to see her panties. She'd worn a plain blue satin pair that either matched her cheerleading outfit because it was part of the uniform, or because she'd chosen it to match.

She wasn't exactly stopping him from stealing a glance at her underwear — she seemed delighted that he was still so taken with her. She also glanced at me like she wanted to tease me by flashing him.

I was happy that the awkwardness between us all seemed to be thawing.

'That summer, we were both camp counselors...' Juliette said dreamily.

Cory grinned. 'I kept taking my group over so we were near hers,' he said. 'So... you know... I could see more of her.'

Juliette said to him, 'I was jealous of the kids who got to be in your group.'

Cory shrugged. 'I spent most of the summer checking you out in that camp counselor swimsuit.'

My wife seemed to like him saying that — and rewarded him by peeling off her top to reveal a blue satin bra that could also have been part of the uniform, or else something she owned that matched. If it was something she'd owned since she was a teenager, it still seemed to fit her perfectly.

Cory said, 'You were so hot in that swimsuit. Every guy in the place was checking you out.'

Juliette beamed, enjoying that he was checking her out now she'd removed her top. She said, 'When camp was done for the day, we used to go get ice cream together with the other counselors...'

'Only we'd end up sneaking away,' Cory finished her sentence.

'I felt like the luckiest girl in the world, getting to sneak away with you,' Juliette said to him, and to my surprise she reached behind herself to slip the catch on her skirt, and allowed it to fall to the floor leaving her standing there in only her bra and panties.

I guess we were done being awkward.

Cory couldn't take his eyes off her. I don't blame him — Juliette looked absolutely stunning standing there in only her underwear. I got the sense she liked having two men gawping at her like that with unbridled lust.

I took a quiet step back, as though I might lull them into the belief it was just the two of them, that I wasn't really there — so that they would feel more comfortable just doing what they wanted with each other.

Cory reached out to put a hand on her bare waist, openly admiring her. 'One night, we went back to the Y and went to the lake where all the swim events were held during the day.'

Juliette giggled, loving how he was looking at her. 'It felt so naughty, going back there,' she said. 'This place where we were all being such wholesome good girls and boys during the day, helping the little kids with their fun activities...'

I quietly took a seat in the armchair, and neither of them seemed to notice. It wasn't a large room, so I was still close to them.

Cory said, ‘We got to the lake, and you said we should go skinny-dipping.’

Juliette laughed, ‘*I* said we should go for a swim. *You* said we should go skinny-dipping.’

Amused by his reshaping of the story, she went up on tip-toes again to steal a kiss from her old flame, and once again their sweet chemistry just took my breath away. I really was watching the most erotically charged romantic movie unfolding before me. It just happened that one of the stars was my own wife.

Cory broke their kiss, and now reached behind his neck to grab hold of his shirt. Juliette helped him peel it up his chest, gawping at his buff physique as she revealed his bare skin. Man — the way she was dreamily looking at him made me so hard. It was strange, because I wasn’t envying that she was checking him out, I was appreciating how excited she was to see this man stripping off in front of her.

As though worried they’d get too distracted to finish their story, I quietly prompted, ‘So what happened?’

I guess I was still their fanboy, eager to avoid missing anything in this particular movie.

Juliette turned her head to me, amused that I was so gripped by their reminiscence — and perhaps that I was still so approving of them stripping off in front of me like this.

I smiled back, sharing her amusement at the strangeness of this whole affair.

Okay, maybe I did envy Cory for his toned abs and bulging pecs, the way Juliette ran her hands over his muscles like she was still that teenage girl granted her every dream by being allowed to have her football star crush for her very own.

Cory said, ‘She took her clothes off... and then she took mine off...’

I could so easily picture them stripping off for the first time in each other’s presence by the lake at the Y.

And now, from what I could gather, they appeared to be giving me a play-by-play replay of what had happened that evening in this hotel room

for my benefit.

I held my breath as I watched them slowly peeling off each other's clothing in between making out, giggling at the extravagant wickedness of all this, and pausing for various fumbling, groping explorations of each other's sensational beauty.

The only difference was that back then, they weren't supposed to have sex because they were unmarried teenagers. Now they weren't supposed to have sex because Juliette was married to another man.

It seemed to me that the sense of the forbidden added a huge boost of excitement to the coupling of these two.

The question was how far they would go with this re-enactment of theirs.

CHAPTER 6

I WAS SO TURNED on as I watched my sweet wife kiss her ex-boyfriend right in front of me. They were so tender together; they were so beautiful.

Standing there in only her bra and panties, I could believe Cory's claim that Juliette looked just as she had in high school. She was so trim, so tight in all the right places, her skin so soft, her hair bright golden blonde, her excitement bubbling up in just the way it had when she had first gotten together with this guy as a teenage virgin.

And thanks to a boyish face — the kind a Hollywood actor might kill for — you might have had trouble working out his age. He might appear too advanced for a high schooler by now, but I could imagine him as a college-age student.

My wife seemed to have regressed during her high school reunion and was now behaving like her high school self.

I wasn't complaining. It was so hot to watch her re-enacting her first time with her first-ever boyfriend — in the privacy of our hotel room.

Juliette was so smiley, it warmed me up several degrees inside. And the way they looked at each other — such excitement in their eyes at taking in their breathtaking beauty — was just phenomenally arousing.

'So, did you make it into the lake?' I asked quietly, the primary purpose of my question to remind them that I was also in the room — in case

they had genuinely lost track of where they were, and that they were not alone.

They broke apart from their kiss, and I wondered if one or other — or both — of them was a little startled being reminded that Juliette's husband was here, calmly watching them from the vantage point of an armchair very close by.

But they didn't recoil from each other. We were far beyond that stage. They knew they were allowed to touch each other. To have their wicked way with each other.

They didn't even take their eyes off each other. Juliette ran her hands delicately over the contours of Cory's buff bare chest, quite bewitched by his athletic frame, no doubt remembering him as he had been, the high school's star quarterback.

'Sure, we swam a little,' Juliette said softly, as if trapped within a dream.

Gazing into her eyes, Cory said, 'You couldn't take your hands off me.'

She smiled sweetly. 'I'd never seen a guy naked before.'

She was fumbling with his belt now. I was impressed at her confidence — she wasn't looking to me for reassurance now. She was taking what she wanted. And she wanted Cory. It was such a thrill to me. I was beyond questioning why I felt this way. I just did, so I was going to enjoy this.

I caught my breath as Cory just stood there, leaning back against the dresser as Juliette unfastened his fly and then just shoved his pants and his undershorts down his thighs, exposing everything — including his rather sizable cock.

I felt my heart skip a few beats as I watched my wife take another man's hard cock in her hands.

She peered at it momentarily, gently stroking it, reminding herself of its size and physicality. She seemed a little stunned — she'd never expected to touch another man like this, not after we were married three years ago.

She said to him, 'You swam over to the dock, and climbed out, all dripping wet. And then you just sat there and let me look.'

As she ran her hands all over his chest again, gaze still fixed on his sizable manhood, Cory said, ‘You stood there for ages, just staring. I thought maybe you got scared — that you might suddenly turn tail and run away.’

Juliette leaned into him, gently touching her face to his chest, her mouth, her nose against his entirely shaven — or waxed — skin. At first, she only pressed herself against him, breathing him in, taking in the strange wonder of being able to touch him.

Then she gently kissed him between the pectorals, and said in barely more than a whisper, ‘I’d never seen anything so incredible in all my life. I couldn’t move at first.’

She smiled up at him. ‘Then I realized he was probably thinking I’d gone crazy, so I swam over to him.’

Cory smiled as she kissed her way down his chest.

Man, his hard cock was right there, inches away from her face.

It was startling — shocking, even. And not only because it was my wife handling this naked man in front of me. I guess I’d never been in the presence of a naked guy. Like Juliette had been that night they’d been at the lake, when they’d both been camp counselors for the summer at the Y.

Cory gazed down at her as she planted kisses either side of his gigantic dick, and he said, ‘You swam over to me and looked up at me, and then you took my dick in your mouth...’

In front of me, Juliette brushed her long, blonde hair out of her face, and then seemed to obey the apparent requirement to re-enact everything that had happened the night she’d lost her virginity.

I held my breath, clung to my chair, and watched as my gorgeous wife took another man’s cock in her mouth, her lips stretching around his impressive girth and then the muscles of her face working to accommodate such a beast.

God, I couldn’t believe how gorgeous they were together. Neither of them had aged a day since they had graduated high school ten years before.

Juliette with those phenomenal curves.

Cory with the kind of muscular definition any man would be happy to show off.

This guy I'd never met before this evening leaned back, both hands planted on the dresser on either side of him, gazing down at my stunning wife slowly pleasuring him with her mouth.

I just sat and watched, holding my breath as though scared they would notice me there in the corner and start getting self-conscious again. Such a curious cocktail of feelings and emotions as I watched my sweet Juliette sucking another man's cock. But the overwhelming winner among the feelings I was experiencing was definitely arousal.

And still, there wasn't an ounce of jealousy in my entire body.

I guess my bizarre new kink was confirmed.

I asked Cory, 'Was she this good that first time, at the lake?'

He smiled, though I caught the hint in his voice that he was beginning to wish that I wasn't there. He said, 'She was amazing.'

Juliette paused in her oral exploration of his manhood for a moment to smile up at him, responding to his compliment. Then she went right back to working on his dick, her head gently bobbing, her shoulders gently rocking back and forth as she pleased him with her mouth.

I watched him stroking her pretty face as she sucked on him, perhaps guiding her rhythm a little. I wondered whether they would keep it to a straightforward blowjob and be done. Cory might not be fully satisfied, but Juliette might be able to state that she'd never cheated on me if she ever got cold feet.

Was she going to let him come in her mouth?

But she was pacing herself. Holding his giant wand with both hands, she withdrew from it when she needed to and returned to it when she sensed the danger receding.

I felt burning optimism inside that they meant to go further.

And sure enough, after a while, Cory stood up, pulling himself away from the edge of the dresser, and placed a hand on Juliette's elbow to

urge her up from the floor.

‘God, you’re so beautiful,’ he said, and she liked that. But her smile seemed stolen by a solemn expression suggesting she was reaching a crossroads.

Big things were happening. A wife was stepping outside the boundaries of her marriage for the first time. Never mind that her doofus of a husband was right there in the corner.

I watched her stand and kiss him. Then he put his hands on her waist and lifted her, twirling like they were a pair of ballet dancers, so that he could place her on the dresser.

I wanted to ask if this was what happened that night at the lake, but it seemed obvious. The dresser stood in for the dock where Cory had been sitting that night. After Juliette had gotten to grips with using her mouth on him for the first time, he had changed places with her, slipping down into the water before lifting her up onto the dock instead.

They were replaying precisely what had happened — whether for my benefit or for their own nostalgia.

I was mesmerized by the sense that I was sneaking a glimpse of my wife’s first time.

Perched on the dresser, Juliette lifted her hips briefly to allow this Greek god of a naked man in front of her to remove her panties.

I was finding it hard to breathe.

More and more, I was feeling like a third wheel in that tiny hotel room. There were fewer and fewer glances from Juliette acknowledging my presence, while Cory was beginning to actively ignore me.

Did they think I was drunk, that I didn’t really care what happened at this stage?

And yet I wasn’t offended by this — my desperate hopes of watching this guy actually fuck my wife was too strong.

Would they go that far? Would they re-enact the moment Cory had taken Juliette’s virginity?

I felt an odd flicker of worry that they would get to the moment, and then one or other of them would get scared. Probably Juliette. Cory looked like he had every intent to slide that huge cock of his inside her the first chance he got.

Was my presence hindering their progress? I wondered whether I was personally getting in the way of my powerful new fantasy being made real. If given the choice between it happening and me having to leave them to do it without me, I would have quickly decided to let them have their privacy.

More than anything, at that point, I wanted Juliette to fuck this guy. I wanted her to embrace the dark glory of infidelity.

But while privacy might lend them a sense of adventure, it might also have the opposite effect, making Juliette worry she was actually cheating on me. I didn't want to risk scaring her away from this.

I leaned back in the armchair as though a few extra inches of distance between us might make the difference, and the idea came to me that perhaps I could remain where I was while also giving them a greater sense of privacy.

As Cory and Juliette made out, and I believed he was preparing himself to take the next step and fuck her, I experimented with emphasizing my inebriation. Pretending to be drunker than I was.

I slumped in my seat, I rested my head on my hands. I made myself seem very tired, very sleepy.

Cory turned to look at me, and I swear I saw relief on his face; he was pleased I was apparently drunk as a skunk and rapidly heading toward the Land of Nod.

I assumed he was about to place his massive tool between her legs and slide it right in, but to my surprise, he tucked his hands under her knees and crouched down, one knee going to the floor, his head dropping between her thighs.

He was going down on her.

This really did seem like a personal moment between them. As he ate her sweet pussy, he was quietly tugging on his own cock. She moaned, her

hand pawing at his head to encourage him. Had he done this with her that night at the lake?

He was really giving her a hearty seeing to with his tongue. I sensed he was emboldened by believing I was now unconscious. I part-closed my eyes to facilitate the illusion, and it affected my view to some degree. But my bigger priority was letting them feel comfortable going all the way.

I could hear them — his moans, the wet sounds as he ate her out, her soft sighs. I could smell Juliette's arousal, thick in the air — along with Cory's cologne. I pretended to be asleep and watched what I could of another man licking my sweet wife's pussy.

Maybe I was tired, anyway. It was easier to pretend to be passed out than to engage with them during such an intimate moment.

Of course, I had questions about what I was seeing, but I stifled them.

I didn't ask him if he made her come that night. Whether going down on her now was just as he remembered it to be back then. Whether he'd improved his technique since.

I didn't ask Juliette whether she'd been frightened of being discovered that night, or whether the two of them had felt safe and free enough to just let go and give in to their wild impulses.

I just sat back in the armchair, peering out from between my eyelashes, watching him going to town on her pussy with his mouth.

The time for storytelling was over.

I was sure that my wife was about to let another man fuck her.

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We were all silent as the significance of the moment hit hard.

Cory helped Juliette down from the dresser, and they moved to the bed. I held my breath, not for the first time, as I sat captivated by the sheer drama of knowing what was coming.

I watched another man kneel between my wife's parted thighs, lining himself up to fuck her.

I was so hard; it was a challenge to resist stroking myself while I watched him enter her, then slowly begin to move, that enormous thing stirring inside her. But somehow it didn't feel appropriate to expose myself at that point.

The focus was on the lovers on the bed.

I loved how she was looking at him, how he was looking at her. It might have been ten years since they'd split up, but they were still fiercely attracted to each other. The desire coursed through their veins as they ran their hands all over each other's spectacular bodies, their muscles flexing, chests flushed, their smooth skin glowing with excitement.

This wasn't like any movie I'd seen. This wasn't like any pornography I'd glimpsed.

Their chemistry was still off the charts. I was completely taken aback by it, shocked, overwhelmed, and unbelievably turned on all at once.

I felt my stomach churning, my heart thumping so hard I started to worry I'd suffer permanent damage. And yet my cock was brutally hard, throbbing like crazy inside my pants, and the arousal led my confused brain to believe that this was all just wonderful.

Oh God, I could hardly believe this was happening.

I got up, headed to the minibar for an extra dose of courage as I heard the wet sounds of another man's hard cock repeatedly thrusting into my sweet wife. Her moans of pure ecstasy seemed to tear me up inside — and yet, as I reached for another pixie-size bottle of bourbon, my engorged manhood was telling me I was thrilled by it all. I'd never felt such a confusing mix of feelings.

A quick swig of liquid fire, and I turned to see Cory's muscular frame dominating her on the bed, his powerful body like a fine machine moving in a perfectly engineered slow rhythm as he violated her wedding vows over and over again there in front of me.

I felt the floor move under my feet — tilting this way and that like we were navigating the high seas on an ocean cruise.

The alcohol was getting to me, I guess. Maybe the shock.

My gorgeous wife was cheating on me, and I had set it all up. She was lying there, making such sweet-sounding sighs and moans as another man pleased her by squeezing his enormous dick inside her soaking wet pussy.

I felt my world reeling, the whole room swaying around me.

Part of him was inside my wife. And not just any part — his cock. His manhood. The center of his masculinity.

I stumbled and nearly fell, and for a moment, the fear and horror suddenly overtook my underlying arousal and excitement. I was panicking. I don't even remember having specific thoughts — I wasn't contemplating actual reasons for the sudden terror, it was just a bizarre emotional response to what was happening on the bed in front of me.

I guess my body had suddenly woken up to the fact that my wife was having sex, and it wasn't with me. My hormone system was finally rebelling against the logical part of my brain that had led us here.

I reached the armchair by the bed and performed an odd sort of dive for it, like a man on the banks of a river leaping for a boat that was starting to drift away in the current.

Fortunately, nobody saw my drunken antics.

As I found my place in the armchair, I saw Cory pounding his massive cock into my sweet beloved over and over again, as though oblivious to whether there was anyone else here in the room with them.

I tried to calm myself, to suppress my fears, and recognize the erotic thrill of what I was witnessing.

It wasn't easy to get back into stable territory. Somehow, I hadn't expected this part of the experience. The weirdness of everything going on around me was catching up with me. I'd never really seen a naked man in real life before — and I'd never expected to. And here I was, seeing one from the most extreme angle.

Was I intimidated by his presence? I probably wouldn't admit to it. But it was something I had to get my head around. The strangeness of his presence, you might say.

My social development — my sexual development — had not prepared me to be in a room with another man in such an intimate way. His sounds, his smell, his raw physicality shocked me.

And the fact that my wife just lay on the bed and accepted it all, allowing him to cover her like that, to drape himself all over her, to penetrate her most private place with his obscene manhood — it was shocking to me, utterly astonishing.

I felt so close to throwing in the towel, abandoning ship.

And yet, as though I'd leaped off a tall building, I had the awful feeling that there was now no way back; there was nothing I could do to save myself.

I could have told them to stop, but it wouldn't change the fact that he had penetrated her, he had been inside her, he had fucked her.

I could have quietly slipped out of the room, leaving them to it, and they probably wouldn't even see me go. But that felt like an even worse option than ordering him to stop — I'd be leaving her with him, and my every sense suggested that doing that might be the most dangerous thing of all.

If I left them alone, I might lose her completely.

I took a few deep breaths and tried to get myself together.

I'd wanted this. I'd watched her dancing with him, thrilled by the danger of their proximity, the rekindling attraction between them, the growing connection as they continued to gaze at each other, hold each other, move to the music together.

I'd wanted my sweet, loyal wife to break out of her conventional mold and go wild. I wanted my gorgeous Juliette to be naughty, wicked, so very sexy.

I wanted her to be promiscuous, to crave sex with another man.

I wanted to see her transgress our monogamy, breach the confines of our marital pledge.

I wanted to see another man covet her, and I wanted to see him utterly thrilled by getting to have her.

I wanted to see his monstrous dick get so hard because, for one brief night, he would be able to take what was mine.

And here he was, pounding that monstrous beast into my wife's dripping-wet pussy over and over again, just a few feet away from me as I perched so tensely on the edge of that armchair.

I could see her wetness coating his shaft every time his cock withdrew from her.

She was so wet, her juices were trickling down from her pussy.

Slowly, I began to get my head around this strange concept of my wife being fucked right in front of my eyes. My softened manhood began to swell again, the cold sweat that felt so icy on my skin started to warm, and my heart rate settled into a more regular — though still rapid — pace.

I began to breathe again, instead of panting.

I settled in the armchair and once again began to notice the beauty in what I was seeing. Perhaps it helped that the lovers on the bed changed position, which altered my perspective a little.

I watched Juliette turn onto her side, and it meant that from my direction, I could now see more of her beyond merely her upturned ass and her newly adulterous sex.

He knelt up and clutched her peach of a behind, kneading her cheeks like he was preparing dough to make bread. His penetration was slower, less frantic, more sensual. Juliette was so beautiful; it just took my breath away. The curves of her back, her arms, the luscious roundness of her buttocks.

I caught sight of her reaching for him, her hand gripping his forearm as he continued to slide his massive tool into her. It seemed too affectionate, both agonizing to me and yet also intensely erotic.

I reminded myself that they'd done this before, countless times. I couldn't feel jealous because this was nothing new.

I reminded myself that she was mine, that this was only happening because I had allowed it. I didn't believe in anything as awful as ownership of one person by another, even through fully consensual

marriage. Yet, the Neanderthal inside me responded favorably to the thought that she was mine, that she was not his, that he would be gone at the end of the night, and she would be with me until the end of days.

What was happening in this room was so primal, it needed me to adopt a more primal attitude.

I could only cope by feeling empowered. This was my wife. I was her husband. I was sitting in the armchair as they performed for me.

And God, what a performance.

They moved with such grace and beauty, dancers who knew the routine so very well. They'd practiced countless times before. I watched them disengage, Juliette pushing herself up onto all fours, presenting herself for her partner like a willing doe.

He placed one hand on her waist and slid his massive cock inside her from behind, and she eased back onto him. Then he put both hands on her lower back, and they continued their dance in perfect rhythm. Everything about them was just scintillating, and it was absolutely exquisite to see.

Her moans made me melt inside. The musty, musky scent of their raw sex made me buzz all over. The sight of his buff muscles working as he thrust into her again and again.

I got the sense that this was how it had been between them when they were a couple. Their expertise was apparent. Their touches and positioning well-designed. They were highly familiar with each other, even if they'd taken a ten-year break.

Along with my renewed sense of enjoyment, I actually felt fortunate to be here, to witness their performance.

It wouldn't be many husbands who got the chance to see their beloved wives show them in intimate detail how they had begun their sexual development.

Not that Juliette had kicked off her development with a performance like this. I imagined her first time with this man had been a less sure-footed display of such perfection. Cory Fallon may have been with other girls before her, but Juliette hadn't even been touched before he had come along.

I watched, riveted, as my wife pulled away from him, urged him down onto the bed, and then straddled him, and as she began to ride him, I couldn't be anything other than how she could do this.

Did she move like this when she was with me? It felt almost as though I'd been only making love to her in the dark these past few years.

I'd taken her for granted. I'd lost my focus. I must have rushed through things too much.

The simple fact was you couldn't truly appreciate the incredible beauty of a woman when you were busy focusing on your own performance. Sure, you were there to enjoy her, to ravish her, to take your fill of her softness, her warmth, her sweetness, the intense glory of her femininity — but in the rush, you couldn't stop and appreciate all the finer points, the detail.

From this outside perspective, I wondered at the stiffness of her pink nipples on her small but perfectly formed breasts. The sheen of perspiration on her skin, glistening as the muscles of her smooth thighs worked while she rode him.

The way her drenched pussy lips clung to his shaft as she rose and fell on his manhood.

I stayed immobile and just took in the countless details, and even with my hands clinging to the arms of the chair, I could feel the sexual response building inside my loins as though I was also having the best sex of my life.

Honestly, I would never have thought it would be physically possible for me to come like that — without anyone, including me, touching my hard cock.

And yet I did.

I sat as the arousal inside me rose to fever pitch, so burning hot between my thighs. The pressure inside my body as I watched my gorgeous bride bouncing on another man like that was just phenomenal.

And then, like water finding its way through a crack in the dam, I reached the point of no return.

I felt a flush of heat and energy detonate between my legs, before an explosion of sexual bliss erupted inside my chinos.

My whole body shuddered and jerked as I felt my hardness pulse and throb and release my thick cream in jet after jet after jet.

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It felt good, oh-so-good. One of the best orgasms I ever experienced — until it was over, the energy dissipated, and the heat subsided.

But then Juliette went on riding her ex-boyfriend in front of me, and I was left on the sidelines, embarrassment setting in as the sexual haze lifted, and the come I had ejected began to cool.

Man.

My sweet wife really wasn't stopping. They were still really going for it. I felt foolish for having made a mess in my pants. I wanted to get up and go to the bathroom to clear up — but at the same time, the embarrassment kept me nailed to my seat, trying to act like I was still enjoying the show.

They weren't looking at me. I wonder if they even noticed I was still there. I probably would have gotten away with slipping away to sort myself out.

But I didn't want to risk disrupting such an incredible display.

Plus, the endorphins released into my system by my unfortunate premature ejaculation now really hit me. As the adrenaline wore off, I suddenly became very, very tired.

It was the alcohol, too, of course.

It all came together in the perfect storm. While I sat there worrying about the mess in my chinos — and perhaps also getting a little unnerved by how Juliette and Cory seemed able to just go on and on and on together like Energizer bunnies — I just seemed to lose time.

I didn't even feel the moment I blacked out.

One moment, I was pondering how to get from the chair to the bathroom in the least conspicuous manner possible, while my wife continued to fuck her old flame, and then next moment I jolted awake and the lights

were all off, there was no movement around me whatsoever, and the eerie, darkened room was utterly silent.

Jeez.

I felt a sudden stab of panic and alarm at the suddenness of it all. It was like I'd lost time. I'd closed my eyes for a split second, and when I opened them again, the world had moved on a few hours.

I was still in the chair, fully dressed, yet not only had Cory and Juliette finished their endless love parade, but I could see that Cory had disappeared entirely, and my wife was now curled up fast asleep on the bed.

How long had she been sleeping? How long had I been out?

The red glowing digits on the cheap clock radio on the bedside table said 3.28am.

Someone — I'm guessing my wife — had draped a blanket over me while I slept in the armchair.

I felt the ice-cold, sticky wetness in my lap from my little accident.

Juliette looked so unbelievably alluring in the half-light, lying peacefully there on the mattress.

I was breathless with desire for her. I don't think I'd felt such a strong attraction toward her since before we were married. Maybe even since we had first started dating. Something about watching another man want her so badly — and then another man take her right in front of me — somehow made my body respond in such a way as to see her in a fresh new light.

Seeing another man have sex with her made her seem so sensationally beautiful in my eyes, so incredibly valuable somehow.

Now that she lay there, freshly fucked, she seemed so unbelievably sexy. I craved her like I'd never craved her before, and yet, seeing her sleeping like that, I felt I couldn't wake her. I got the sense she would be angry to be awoken now.

And despite the fresh burst of sexual arousal inside me from seeing Juliette like this, knowing she'd just been well fucked by another man, it really hit me to wake up like that, having blacked out for hours.

I felt that panicky feeling setting in again.

How long had that man been fucking my wife while I was asleep? What had the two of them got up to while I had not been there to see it?

The air in the room was still thick with the scent of bodily exertions and sexual arousal. The two of them had been so energetic in their copulation, their gym fitness paying off by giving them the stamina to go on and on, the most incredible sexual performance.

I had to think they'd continued for a long while after I'd passed out.

What must Juliette have thought of me, so drunk I'd been unable to make it to the end of the night?

The fear was getting the best of me again.

I sat for a long moment, trying to find my way back to more positive thoughts. This whole experience had been such an emotional rollercoaster; I really hadn't been prepared for any of it. Such extreme ups and downs.

I breathed. I meditated. I thought about how incredible it had been to watch my sexy wife on top of her ex-lover, riding him, so wicked. How sensational she had looked.

The fears subsided in a few moments, and I was rock-hard again.

Seriously hard. So hard I had to move from the chair.

God, this new sexual fantasy of mine was so potent. I guess you couldn't even call it a *fantasy* anymore — since my gorgeous wife was lying there in front of me, having been fucked by another guy in real life.

Jesus, I wanted her so badly.

And yet, I was sure I could not afford to wake her.

I stood, quiet as a cat burglar, and eased myself out of the chair. Then, I took a few steps before checking to see if Juliette had noticed me move.

She seemed out for the count.

I crept to the bathroom and closed the door without making a sound, then set about cleaning myself up as quietly as I could. It was a relief to sort

that out, but with my clothes drying, I had to leave the bathroom without anything except my shirt.

Thankfully, Juliette was still sound asleep when I opened the bathroom door and returned to the room.

Still hard as a rock, I couldn't help but quietly stroke myself as I saw her there. Well, Cory wasn't there to catch me. The room was still humming with their recent sex, and it was such a turn-on knowing what had happened there between my wife and her first love.

They were so incredible together. I had heart palpitations just thinking about it.

I wanted so badly to wake her, to tell her how amazing it had been to watch her with him. To kiss her and taste her and slide my own rock-hard cock inside her. But she was sleeping so peacefully. She was so serene and so beautiful that to disturb her would have been like painting over a masterpiece with whitewash.

Her clothes were still on the floor by the dresser, where they'd fallen when she and Cory had started stripping off.

I stooped to snatch up the tiny scrap of blue satin, Juliette's panties. I felt like I was handling an important relic. They were so infused with the memory of what had happened. I remembered in intimate detail the sight of him peeling them off her before kneeling to suck on her soaking-wet pussy.

Her panties were still slightly damp. They smelled of her irresistible pussy, her intense arousal.

I sat there in the moonlight, breathing in her spice as I gently stroked my hard cock, gazing down upon her exquisite slumbering form.

My God, I'd never wanted anyone more than her. It seemed insane that watching another man make love to her could strengthen my love for her like this. But it had. And along with the powerful love I felt for her in that moment, came an almost equally powerful fear.

What if she felt offended that I'd fallen asleep while they were having sex?

If she'd felt unsupported, somehow.

What if she'd spent the next few hours while I was asleep fucking Cory Fallon to the point that she fell for him all over again? What if she woke up in the morning and walked out on me?

My mind was racing — provoked by the potent cocktail of hormones and emotions. I came again, this time into Juliette's panties, and despite how pleasurable it was, the orgasm only set my paranoia free.

I lay beside my wife on the bed but could not sleep for a while. All I could do was ride the wave of emotions and try to cling to the more positive feelings there.

It had been amazing to watch my wife with Cory. I'd never been so turned on. As my mind reeled, the new fear came into the mix that it would never happen again. Oh God, I really hoped it would, though. Had it not been a good experience for her, too? She'd been on fire with him, reliving the sweetness of their first time, the erotic scene of that time by the lake.

I felt a strong urge to see more of her with Cory, to really set her free to explore whatever sexual desire she still harbored for him.

I only hoped her rekindled desire for him didn't translate into an urge to be with him more permanently.

CHAPTER 7

IN THE MORNING, Juliette was still sleeping when I woke.

I couldn't help but spend a little more time appreciating the sight of her there, set out like supreme art, in the scene of her debauchery with her ex. But then hunger was clawing at my stomach, and I had to go fetch some breakfast.

I left her sleeping as I went out to source some coffee and croissants from the nearest Starbucks. She was still passed out when I returned, so I ended up eating my share on my own.

She was exhausted, I guess, after such a vigorous workout with her ex-boyfriend. I couldn't stop reliving it. It turned me on so much, simply seeing her lying there after what had happened. I wasn't the kind of guy to wake her up just for my own sexual gratification, though.

God, it all seemed like a dream. The most erotic wet dream you ever had.

Juliette's abandoned clothing, that musty scent in the air, the empty bottles from the minibar were all testament to the fact that it had really happened, though. It hadn't just been a figment of my deranged imagination.

My wife had slept with another man. I never thought that would happen. I never thought I'd be there to see such a thing. That I'd so desperately want such a thing to happen.

Man, I felt like a different person than I had been yesterday, before the reunion.

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Later, when she did wake up, I was glad I'd let her sleep. She was hungover beyond anything I'd ever seen before.

Had she really had that much to drink the previous night? I guess she had.

It was not a good morning for her. I held her hair out of her face as she threw up in the toilet. I fetched her painkillers from the nearest pharmacy. I had to phone reception asking for a late check-out.

We did not talk about Cory or anything to do with what had happened between him and us. Discussing good things — our wonderful evening — seemed like it would be inappropriate, given how awful she was feeling.

In fact, I was getting the vibe that she didn't want to think about what had happened the previous night, let alone talk about it.

Honestly, the way she looked at me, I started to suspect she didn't remember a whole lot of it. That was kind of scary. I'd honestly believed she was sober enough to make fully rational decisions when Cory had come back with us to the hotel.

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Eventually, I drove us home and gave her space to chill out, rest, and recover from a wild weekend in time for work the next day.

That night, we still didn't talk about anything that had happened.

In the morning, Juliette seemed better, heading into work like it was a typical Monday. I decided it would be best to leave all reference to our weekend to her. She would talk about it when she was ready.

For a few days, she seemed seriously depressed. I'd never seen her like this; she was usually so bright and bubbly about everything. I wondered if she was sad about coming back down to reality after such a wild night.

I was also nervous that she missed Cory, and now she was back to the normality of daily life with me, she regretted marrying me.

That maybe her brief fling with her ex had damaged us.

Generally, if she was feeling low like this, she really did not want to talk about it. I'd found that it was better just to give her space, let her come to me if she needed. There was no sex; in fact, as I respected her space, Juliette seemed to draw away from me, giving me the cold shoulder.

It made me afraid, but I couldn't find the words or the courage to get through the coldness that existed between us.

For a while — I'm not sure how long it was — I catered to my own needs. I tended to my own urges. I would jack off in the shower remembering how it had been to watch Juliette with Cory. I would vent steam with a quick tug in the bathroom, thinking about my wife violating our wedding vows.

Juliette and I became like roommates — roommates who cautiously shared a bed, making sure nothing wicked happened between us.

I tried talking to her about safe subjects and trivial matters, but she quickly seemed to avoid conversation and step away from me. She was so uncommunicative. A couple of times, I tried to initiate something that might lead to sex — a gentle offer of a back rub, even just an attempt at a hug — and she rapidly shut it down.

It started seeming evident that the subject of Cory Fallon was closed. That Juliette clearly regretted what had happened. That she wasn't comfortable bringing any of it up.

I started feeling guilty about what had happened with her ex.

Had I pushed her too much to do things she wasn't prepared for? Had she been too drunk, and I hadn't noticed because I had also been too drunk? And yet, I had been so sure she wasn't that tipsy. I knew how my wife was when she'd had too much to drink.

But the hangover she'd suffered the morning after bore witness to the possibility that she really had had too much to drink.

*

I had trouble sleeping because it was all on my mind. I felt so awful that Juliette might have felt pressured into fooling around with Cory like that.

Dancing with him because she liked dancing.

Fucking him because the dancing had made her horny, and the alcohol had removed her inhibitions.

At the same time, I couldn't let go of how it had made me feel to watch her with another man. During the small hours of my insomnia, I Googled the whole topic about guys who get turned on by watching their wives sleep with other men. It turned out it was relatively common — or at least, the fantasy of it was. Lots of guys fantasized about their wives fucking other people, but only a select portion of them actually went through with it.

There were even words for it. Hotwives — wives who were allowed to date or just sleep with men who were not their husbands. Cuckolds — husbands who got off on their wives doing so. Was I a cuckold?

Not all men who enjoyed their wives' promiscuity embraced that term. Some referred to themselves as 'stags' instead. It was unclear to me if there was a difference, although I suspected the term 'cuckold' was closer to the classical meaning of that word, a man whose wife cheated on him or who chose to sleep with other men regardless of his overt approval.

Whatever I was, knowing that there were plenty of other men out there like me made me feel less like a freak, though I felt nervous about letting out my secret in the wide world.

People laughed at 'cucks.' The word was a not-uncommon insult used in politics and business — I knew that much. I'd heard guys at our law firm use it in a derogatory fashion.

Was Juliette embarrassed that I might be one? She had to have heard the word before. Did she have in her mind that what had happened with Cory somehow meant she'd married someone who was less than a man? That our relationship was sullied, shamed?

*

One afternoon, I was flicking through Facebook during a break at work, and none other than Brian Rhodes came up as a friend recommendation — the funny short guy I'd met during the reunion.

I clicked the button to invite him to be my Facebook buddy because — why not? At that moment in my life, I felt like I needed as many friends

as I could get. Brian accepted the invitation later that afternoon. He even sent me a message asking how things were between Juliette and me after the reunion.

I told him everything.

He wasn't a close enough friend to be a risk letting sensitive details slip to other people I knew, and at this point I needed some sort of support.

Brian seemed perfectly open to me letting it all out and didn't judge me at all for what had happened. My sense about him was that even if I'd made a pig's ear out of the night, he was still somehow impressed at me simply for having married Juliette. Even if I was apparently a cuck.

He advised waiting and letting Juliette talk about things when she was ready.

When I expressed my conflicted feelings — my regret for how Juliette had taken things and my fervent hopes that somehow the strange adventure with Cory could be repeated — Brian seemed to really get where I was coming from.

But he was adamant I needed to give her space and time to move forward from what had happened.

Brian was a great help during those dark times. And as we gelled, it became clear that his empathy for my conflicted feelings had a very sound basis: he had had the same cuckolding fantasy. For years, in fact.

It had even affected his marriages.

Now that he was currently in between marriages, he was determined to find himself a woman who might be open to a hotwife relationship.

I guess we had plenty in common. It was good to have someone to talk to about it — I definitely was not going to open up to any of my friends at work about my cuckolding kink.

Brian worked in the city, too, so it was pretty convenient. It turned out he was in advertising, not car dealerships as I had suspected from his dress sense at the reunion. His firm had an office over in Brooklyn.

I even met up with him for drinks after work a couple of times.

Meanwhile, I let things lie with Juliette.

Would we ever return to normal? I wasn't sure. I tried to prepare myself mentally for the possibility that she would want to end things. That we were now forever broken. Brian tried to encourage me by suggesting that because she hadn't left me yet, it was a good sign.

I started clinging to that possibility. I held onto the hope that maybe we could somehow forget what happened, move on.

Of course, it didn't help that I continued to be fixated on the fantasy of sharing my wife. The more I read about it as a sexual kink, the more it seemed like a part of me that was unavoidable, that was simply a permanent part of who I was.

It would just have to become a dark secret.

*

One evening, some days after the reunion, I came home one evening to find Juliette angry at me.

She said Cory Fallon had been in touch via Facebook. He was looking for a new job in the city and wanted to see if he could stay with us while he attended interviews.

When she said that, I felt a flutter of excitement inside my chest as she mentioned him, as she revealed his plan to relocate to our city. I felt that welcome buzz of sexual arousal warming my loins at the thought of Cory camping out on our couch while he visited New York for job interviews.

Cory taking advantage of a little closeness with my wife.

But I kept my emotions to myself because Juliette's body language was so icy it could have given me frostbite.

When I said something vague and noncommittal like, 'That's great. Good for him,' et cetera, et cetera — she nearly tore me a new one.

She said, 'He wants to know if we can have some *fun* when he's in town. He said that since *you let him fuck me* during the reunion...'

I nearly gasped at that.

The way she said it — her horrified tone — suggested she had absolutely no memory whatsoever of Cory fucking her that night.

How could she remember absolutely nothing about what had happened? She had it in her mind that whatever Cory was talking about had been my fault. That I'd engineered it all, manipulating her because she'd been drunk.

Man.

Seriously? I could hardly believe it. She definitely did not seem drunk to me that night. She'd been sharp, energetic, and absolutely on fire.

Anyway.

So we had a blazing argument right then and there. No matter what I said, I received the lion's share of blame for what had happened. She would not accept any other alternative — and Juliette was a stubborn so-and-so. It was why she was a great lawyer, I suspected.

Jeez. I felt like my whole world was being shaken. I had been so secure in our marriage, and suddenly we were fighting like we'd never fought before.

One thing I noticed was that she didn't actually ask me what had happened that night. I felt like if she honestly had no memory of any of it, she'd want all the information she could get about what had gone on, and from more than just Cory's perspective. She didn't even ask me why I'd felt the need to 'manipulate' her into sleeping with her ex.

But being suspicious of her didn't seem appropriate. She was really upset, and it was agonizing for me. She was in tears, apparently believing I'd taken advantage of her. I was horrified. I insisted that I'd genuinely had the impression she'd been fully capable of consenting to what had happened.

She relented only in the matter of agreeing that I hadn't committed some kind of awful sex crime. She agreed that it was possible I could have misinterpreted her actions that night as being tantamount to wanting sex with Cory Fallon.

But she still accused me of manipulating her. She accused me of trying to trick her into agreeing to some kind of open marriage. That I was seeking some kind of loophole in our relationship to cheat on her guilt-free.

She wouldn't listen to my insistence that the last thing on Earth that I wanted was another woman.

It wasn't an easy argument to prove. I ended up blurting out the fact that I had fantasies of sharing her. I might even have used the word 'cuckold,' but I don't think she knew what it meant, so I didn't refer to it again, and she didn't bring it up.

But none of it was easy for an out-and-out beginner like me to explain. My tongue tripped up on itself. I think I ended up confusing her more than clarifying anything.

I just had to drop it. I just had to concede the argument.

I apologized, said I bitterly regretted making her do anything she did not feel she had wanted to do. I urged her to try and put it all behind us.

But I wasn't sure she was going to accept my apology.

Maybe our marriage was broken.

*

I slept on the couch that night and for many nights thereafter.

Stuck sleeping on the couch, thinking about all the friends and family I'd have to reveal the awful news to — that Juliette and I were getting divorced.

Jeez.

On the plus side, Juliette did not have the drive to continue shouting at me. After that awful first barrage of fire, our conflict rapidly evolved into more of a Cold War.

Juliette built a Berlin Wall right through the middle of our relationship.

If we'd been acting like roommates before, now Juliette was acting like someone who truly despised her roommate — yet could not get out of the lease agreement. We didn't talk, we didn't spend time together, we didn't sleep together, we didn't eat together. I cooked meals and ate alone, and later she would make herself noodles, or a toastie, or eggs. She'd eat on her own while I watched TV.

Juliette avoided me at work — it was easy for her to do so. We worked in different departments, the company had kept us separate ever since we'd revealed our relationship, which we'd done by the book since we were

both lawyers. Nevertheless, I still found myself fearing that I would run into her in a hallway and that colleagues would notice the awkwardness between us.

I wondered if it might be a good idea to look for a new job myself.

Meanwhile, I'd come home from work and if I happened to bump into her, I'd see her eyes were red like she'd been crying. I wasn't totally heartless — I tried talking to her. She only ignored me.

Sheesh.

Brian advised me to hold my fire and respect her territorial boundaries. So I bit my tongue and stifled my sense of injustice. I became a sullen citizen of an East Germany of a marriage.

'She hasn't demanded a divorce yet,' my new friend from Juliette's high school kept reminding me — but I thought the demand would come any day now.

'It's only a matter of time,' I said gloomily in response.

*

I started hanging out with Brian fairly regularly because of what had happened with Juliette. I'd been frozen out of the usual social circles I shared with my wife.

Hey, it didn't matter anymore if I stayed out too late at a bar — Juliette and I were not talking anyway.

Brian was having almost as much luck with women as I was, trying to explore this crazy kink of ours.

'It should not be this difficult to find a woman who wants an adoring partner who will allow her to sleep with whoever she feels like,' I said over a mid-strength beer at a bar in the Village after Brian had divulged the details of another failed date.

'That's the thing,' he said. 'They think it's a trap. That you want them to sleep around so that the moment you get tired of them, you can accuse them of cheating on you and walk away, guilt-free.'

'But the point is we won't get tired of them if they do something as exciting as sleep around,' I said.

‘It’s difficult to understand if you don’t actually have the fantasy yourself,’ Brian opined.

‘I should write Juliette a letter,’ I declared. ‘I should explain in extensive detail why I feel this way and why it means there is absolutely no chance I would ever want to leave her for another woman.’

But Brian shook his head. ‘I wouldn’t.’

‘Why not? If she understood...’

‘Look, maybe she does know what a cuckold is,’ he said. ‘I mean, she’s a lawyer in Manhattan, just like you, right? Those guys are always calling people cucks behind their backs.’

‘But she doesn’t understand the nuance...’

‘Fuck the nuance. You told her you were a cuckold, right? When you guys had that first fight. She didn’t seem to understand, you said. Well, maybe she did. Maybe it embarrassed her.’

I felt my insides burn with horror and — yes — embarrassment.

‘Why should it be so embarrassing?’ I said. ‘Nobody else needs to know. I just want her to know I’d be okay if she ever wanted to... you know... go dancing with somebody else. Maybe end up in bed with them if she liked them... she doesn’t have to tell anybody else.’

‘No, she doesn’t. But she doesn’t see it that way.’

‘If a woman told her husband — or partner, whatever — that she liked the idea of him occasionally having a little fun with somebody else, I bet most guys would not get upset with her. And plenty would take her up on her offer.’

‘Yes, but it doesn’t work the other way around,’ Brian said. ‘Most guys are not comfortable with their wives being free to sleep with whoever they like. So society has deemed such a thing to be a serious taboo.’

‘Well, that’s not fair.’

‘Welcome to the patriarchy, buddy.’

Brian said that if Juliette ever decided to talk about things again, maybe by trying counseling or something like that as a final step to attempt to

salvage our marriage, I was best off denying that I was a cuckold — or that I had never meant to say such a thing.

‘But she *heard* me say the word,’ I insisted.

‘Say you were mistaken,’ he suggested. ‘You didn’t know what the word really meant. You just blurted it out in the heat of the moment.’

‘But the point is, she’s accusing me of letting her ex-boyfriend sleep with her. And I can hardly deny that I did — ‘

Brian had to think about it. He sipped his mid-strength beer for a few moments, and tapped a finger on his nose.

‘Okay,’ he said after a while. ‘Here’s what you say. You say that you liked the fact that she was having a good time dancing with her ex, because you can’t stand dancing yourself.’

‘That was true enough,’ I pointed out.

He continued, ‘And when Juliette showed signs of still being attracted to Cory, you didn’t see a problem in letting her do whatever she wanted — because she’d already been with him before.’

‘That’s also kinda true,’ I said.

Brian flashed his eyes, emphasizing this point. ‘But this is it, right? She’s already fucked him so many times. What difference does it make if she wants to do it one more time? The guy said to you himself, they fucked so many times he can close his eyes and imagine he’s fucking her right now.’

‘So I just happened to let her fuck him because... you know, no big deal, he’s done it before,’ I said, practicing the words in case my wife ever got round to asking me about all this ever again. ‘And if she asks why it turned me on to watch him fuck her...?’

He shrugged. ‘You were drunk. You got caught up in the excitement. You saw a naked guy fucking a naked girl — of course it turned you on. And anyway, you were asleep for most of it, weren’t you?’

I didn’t like being reminded of all that time I’d missed that particular night. What Cory might have done with my wife while I hadn’t been conscious to see.

But how many times had they fucked before, when I couldn't see that either? Countless times.

‘Well, I guess it could work,’ I said with a sigh.

I wasn't optimistic, but my pessimism figured maybe I'd need to explain myself to a counselor someday — or if worst came to the worst, a divorce court.

*

One day, I was on my way out of our office building seeking a quick bite for lunch when I noticed Juliette's best friend, Jessica, on her way in.

I hadn't seen her for a while. I had no idea how she felt about me in the wake of my little Cold War with Juliette. Still, it seemed natural enough to flash her a friendly smile and a wave in greeting as we noticed each other.

I assumed she was heading in to meet up with Juliette for lunch.

To my surprise, as I headed out onto the street, Juliette remained in the revolving door and did a complete 360 before coming back out where I was.

‘Hey Jessie, how's tricks?’ I said, suddenly wary in case I was about to receive a torrent of scorn for my actions on reunion night.

‘What's going on between you two?’ she asked me point blank.

‘What's going on...?’ I said, scratching for time to decide on a response strategy.

She said sharply, ‘You haven't been seen together for weeks. Juliette doesn't talk about you ever. And a few times I've been with her, and she burst into tears.’

Well, the tears part was a surprise. As was the fact that Juliette apparently had not shared every single ugly detail of what had happened the night of the reunion with her BFF.

I felt my stomach drop with dread.

‘We... had an argument...’ I said, glancing around us in fear that people who knew me would catch me talking to my wife's BFF behind her back.

‘Well, that much is obvious. What about?’ Jessie demanded, then added pointedly, ‘What did you do?’

Sigh.

I said, ‘She’s been a little... depressed recently...’

Always on the ball, Jessie wasn’t buying it for a second. I resorted to an old East German trick, murmuring, ‘I can’t talk about it.’

She narrowed her eyes at my refusal to play ball.’ She’s not just a little depressed,’ she insisted.

As she glanced around to also check we were not in danger of being seen by Juliette or any of her co-workers, it hit me that Jessie had come here in search of me, not Juliette. She was desperate for insight into what was going on with her BFF.

‘You are going to buy me lunch,’ she said through gritted teeth. ‘And we are going to sort this all out — one way or the other.’

CHAPTER 8

I WAS ALREADY in trouble with my wife, I didn't need her to know that I'd met up with her best friend, Jessie, behind her back. After the massive argument we'd had over what had happened with Cory, I could only imagine Juliette would accuse me of trying to manipulate her by secretly meeting with her BFF.

But what choice did I have?

Somehow I needed my side of the story to filter through to her.

Jessie, who had been besties with Juliette since their college days at NYU, also appeared to be under the impression that meeting with me was not officially sanctioned. After grabbing me and dragging me quickly away from our office building, she led me to the nearest subway for a ride across town so we could have lunch together without risk of discovery.

Despite her guilt at going behind her friend's back, Jessie was insistent that she should do what was best for Juliette. And that meant talking to the enemy — i.e. me.

She also felt a vague responsibility to help save our marriage because she had been Maid of Honor at the ceremony three years ago.

'So. About the only thing I've been able to learn from Juliette is that you somehow got drunk and made a complete ass of yourself,' she said when

we were finally seated at a table toward the rear of a very low profile deli in the East Village.

I sighed. ‘Okay, look, I wasn’t exactly *drunk*...’

‘So what on Earth happened to make her so upset?’

Jessie was a blonde just like Juliette, and during their time they’d occasionally been mistaken for sisters — or even twins, when the observers had been drunk. Now she folded her arms in a demanding fashion that made her seem just like me wife.

“Look, we were having a lot of fun at the reunion... meeting old friends, you know how it is... and then we ran into this guy, Cory, who — ‘

‘Cory *Fallon*?’ Jessie interjected. I guess she’d heard of him.

‘Uh-huh,’ I nodded.

Her frosty temperature thawed a little. She clearly knew who Cory Fallon was, and understanding that we had run into my wife’s first boyfriend at the Reunion seemed to soften her judgement of me.

‘Okay, *that* must have been pretty awkward,’ she said, sounding as though she might even be willing to offer me the benefit of the doubt in such circumstances. ‘Did you boys get into some kind of fight?’

‘No, nothing like that,’ I insisted.

‘Did you embarrass yourself in front of the whole high school reunion?’

‘No. Really. Look, Juliette wanted to dance with him...’

Jessie groaned. ‘I’ll bet she did.’ Her negative tone surprised me a little — it made me instantly realize I must have underestimated Juliette’s feelings for Cory. Like maybe it had been more dangerous than I’d been led to believe.

‘I don’t know... I didn’t think it was such a problem...’

Jessie’s fair eyebrows shot up and her jaw dropped. ‘You let her?’ she said, as though she couldn’t quite believe what she’d heard me say.

I guess most husbands wouldn’t have been as supportive as I had been of their wives dancing with an ex, let alone dance with the guy who had taken their cherry.

I said, 'It didn't seem such a big deal.'

Jessie's eyes widened. 'Not such a big deal? You know she's been obsessed with him ever since they split up?'

'Obsessed?'

'Well, he was the first guy she ever kissed, the first guy she ever slept with, the first guy she ever fell for. And she fell for him pretty hard.'

Gulp. Maybe I had been a little careless. Juliette hadn't told me about the love part. Well, now I felt a little silly encouraging her to sleep with him.

Sigh. Well that little nugget of information explained a little more why Juliette had been so upset when morning had arrived.

'Look, you know how bad at dancing I am, and Cory seemed to know what he was doing on the dance floor...'

One of her eyebrows rose up in a rather cutting critique of my actions on the night of the reunion. She said, 'So what happened when the song was over?'

'Uh...' I said, feeling my cheeks burning with embarrassment. 'I guess she danced with him some more...'

'And how long, exactly, were they dancing together?'

'Most of the night?'

That got me a full jaw drop.

'And you just let that happen?' she said, icily.

I shrugged, trying to act all nonchalant. Maybe I knew Cory better than she did. Maybe she'd misjudged him. Jessie wasn't at Juliette's high school, after all. They'd met in college.

'It was okay... honestly. She was having a great time — they both were. We all were. I suppose everyone'd had a few drinks...'

'That *does* surprise me.'

'So... she got upset because you pulled her away from Cory at the end of the night?'

‘Well, no...’ This wasn’t easy. I said, ‘After the reunion thing ended... we all went to this night club...’

‘And they were dancing some more?’

I got the sense that Jessie thought I was an idiot. It was only going to get worse.

‘Everyone was having such a good time,’ I insisted, in the face of Jessie’s growing astonishment. ‘And those two were so sweet together...’

I could see in her eyes that she was waiting for the penny to drop and for me to reveal some act of extreme violence that had erupted from the storm of rage and jealousy that all that dancing had led to.

She gave me the folded arm treatment again, waiting for me to continue my explanation and get to the key details.

I said, ‘Anyway... we all ended up back at the hotel, you know... having fun... a few drinks from the minibar... and those guys were getting a little cozy together...’

Jessie’s expressive eyebrows shot up once again.

‘Well,’ I shrugged again. ‘I mean, it wasn’t anything that hadn’t happened between the two of them loads of times before.’

Jaw drop numero 2.

‘What did he do to her?’

‘It wasn’t so much *to* her, but *with* her...’

Cue the stunned silence.

I didn’t think Jessie’s eyebrows could get much higher on her face. I guess we could definitively rule out any use of botox.

‘He *slept* with her?’

I could sense the need to defuse the tension between us.

‘I told you, didn’t you? It wasn’t anything they haven’t done a million times before.’

‘Yeah, when they were *going out*.’

‘I’m telling you, it wasn’t a big deal. They were together so long before I came along, how’s one more time going to make a difference?’

‘Uh... because she’s married to someone else now? You. And speaking of, where were you when this was happening?’

‘I’ve told you, I was there with them. We were just... you know... *partying...*’

She sat there frozen for a while, her brow firmly furrowed. That brow was getting a real workout tonight. I was regretting the lack of strong drink with our lunch — and I was getting the idea that perhaps I was losing Juliette’s friend as well as Juliette herself.

I took a few bites of my sandwich, and it seemed suddenly so dry, very difficult to eat. All the saliva inside my mouth had just evaporated.

As well as being Juliette’s BFF, Jessie was one of the lynchpins of the social circle my wife and I hung out with whenever we were socializing as a couple. Now I was burning that particular bridge, and the flames were so hot, I could tell the fire would easily spread to other bridges nearby.

Eventually, Jessie said slowly, ‘So... by your logic... it wouldn’t be a big deal if she wanted to sleep with any of her exes?’

I remembered Brian’s advice. I tried to use his words to explain it all to Jessie: ‘What difference does it make if she’s slept with him before?’

This seemed pretty surprising to Jessie.

She said, ‘Seriously? You wouldn’t care if she says to you she wants to sleep with someone else she once dated?’

I shrugged.

Deep down, that dark part of me that reveled in the thought of Juliette having sex with other men rejoiced in the message Jessie was getting from me. But maybe I needed to suppress those particular urges. Maybe they hadn’t done me much good so far in my relationships with women.

Jessie was silent, as though she didn’t know what to say.

I babbled some more words that attempted to add clarity to my point, but I think they only added volume. Something like, ‘They’ve already had

sex with her, they already know what it's like, it's nothing new to them, they can probably remember it in extensive detail anyway, what difference does it make if it happens one more time...?'

Honestly, I was sitting there expecting my wife's BFF to get up and storm out of that deli in absolute disgust any moment.

But to my surprise, Jessie didn't seem outraged. She didn't even seem angry.

She seemed to calm down.

She said quietly, 'Wow.'

I wondered if she was already putting two and two together and deciding I was a cuckold. That as well as being an awful husband, I was also a perverted deviant, there was something lacking in my masculinity, and all the other slurs that word encompassed.

Maybe she was waiting to walk out on our lunch meeting only so long as she could think of something to shout at me before storming out.

There was a moment of uncertain silence between us.

I could see a few people hovering around the deli counter peering through the gloom at us, trying to figure out if we were about to vacate our table, since we were clearly not actively eating our food anymore, and apparently our conversation was done.

Sitting there, dread slowly filling my entire body with hot acid, it was like I could feel my marriage withering and dying right there in front of me like a sapling in a drought-stricken desert.

Panic was setting in.

More words started tumbling out of my mouth. 'Juliette seemed like she was really having fun that night... and really, I just wanted her to have a good time...'

Jessie said quietly, 'You just wanted her to have a good time.'

She sounded like she was in some kind of trance state, mindlessly repeating some of the words she'd heard from me.

I continued babbling, ‘I think after a while, I fell asleep... and then when I woke up, Cory was gone. Then... in the morning, she just really didn’t seem to want to talk about it... and then... when she did... she got really upset...’

This was what seemed to snap her out of her daze.

She said, ‘So... why do you think she’s so upset with you — for letting her sleep with her ex?’

I said, ‘I mean, I’m kind of surprised she hasn’t told you everything about what happened already...’

Jessie took another bite of her sandwich. I could sense hostility from across the deli as the other customers sensed that we were not ready to give up our table after all.

‘She’s been really pissed at you,’ Jessie said. ‘I thought you might have... I don’t know... *attacked* her or something.’

I shook my head. ‘Really. I honestly thought we’d wake up in the morning and she would be all bright-eyed and bushy tailed about what an incredible night we had. But... yeah, she got upset. Eventually when she decided to say something about it... well, we had a huge fight.’

To my surprise, Jessie seemed almost sympathetic to my plight.

‘What did she say about it?’ she asked me.

‘That somehow I’d manipulated her into sleeping with her ex so that I could force her into accepting an open marriage. You know — so I can go out and sleep with other women, guilt-free.’

My wife’s BFF gazed into my eyes. I think she was trying to suss me out, to determine whether I did, indeed, want an open marriage.

‘I don’t want an open marriage,’ I insisted. ‘I don’t want to sleep with anyone else — I have Juliette. I mean, look at her. She’s incredible.’

I spoke from the heart, although part of me found it difficult to bestow compliments on Juliette because of how terrible things had been between us recently. ’

Jessie said dryly, ‘You wouldn’t feel like you’d be justified sleeping with one of your exes? I mean... because you’ve slept with them before?’

I couldn't help but chuckle at that. 'Have you ever met any of my exes?'

The implication actually made her smile. She said, 'No, actually, I haven't.'

I nodded. 'Let's just say if you saw any of them, you wouldn't be worried about me wanting to see any of them again. Even if I hadn't burned all those particular bridges...'

She nodded. 'I can see that she would wonder why you'd just let her sleep with another guy, though,' she said. 'It seems logical to think you'd want some kind of reciprocal arrangement.'

I shook my head. 'Really. I just wanted her to have a good time. The way she looked when she was dancing with him... and even when she was sleeping with him... I loved how happy she was. How *excited* she was.'

'And so if she wanted to do it again...? Maybe with some other gorgeous ex-boyfriend?'

I shrugged. 'Why not? As long as she still loves me. As long as she comes back to me when she's done, and it doesn't make her regret marrying me. I trust her, if she tells me she just feels like a little... you know... no-strings fun.'

Jessie seemed to be drifting off into that strange trance state again.

She almost chanted, 'If she tells you she just feels like a little no-strings fun...'

This time, however, it was an alarm on her phone that snapped her out of her daze. I actually thought it was somebody calling her, but she pulled out her cell and switched off the alarm, saying, 'I'm sorry, I have to get back to the office.'

'Fair enough,' I gave her a grateful smile. I wasn't sure how much help she'd be in winning over Juliette, but I did get the impression that Jessie at least understood my side of things.

We chatted about a few mutual friends as we both left the deli and headed back to the subway. On the platform, we separated to head back to our respective offices, and Jessie even gave me a friendly little peck on the cheek as a farewell.

'I'll try to talk to her,' she said with a sympathetic smile.

‘Thanks,’ I said, genuinely appreciative.

‘Give me some time. Eventually she might open up, and I can try to persuade her that maybe your intentions were bad, not like she assumed.’

I nodded. It was all I could hope for.

Neither Juliette nor Jessie said anything to me about having a Big Talk together, but at some point over the next few days, they must have had a fairly deep conversation.

It didn’t lead to an instant resolution of the discord between us, but I noticed a softening of the tension she projected when we were in the apartment at the same time, and that seemed like a huge relief.

A few days after I’d met with Jessie for lunch, Juliette quietly started eating dinner with me again in the evenings. She would sit with me while we watched TV.

She even began to talk to me again — about trivial things, small-talk, work stuff and so on.

I did not make any comments directly acknowledging the resumption of diplomatic relations between us, or seek to inquire into this change of her mood. I certainly didn’t pry into whether she’d had a change of heart regarding our particular disagreement, and whether Jessie’s intervention had helped.

I kept calm, maintained a positive attitude, tried not to make any sudden movements.

It was like trying not to scare away a nervous deer I was observing in the wild.

At night, I was allowed back into the marital bed. We didn’t have sex, but at least I didn’t have to sleep on the couch. My quality of sleep improved dramatically.

I kept my depraved fantasies to myself and hoped we were finally getting past the whole Cory issue.

Eventually, a kind of nervous, cautious normality resumed.

Juliette began to brighten up considerably, and even occasionally smile in my presence. She would actually snuggle up with me on the sofa while watching TV in the evening. She complimented me on my cooking at dinner time.

We still avoided the whole subject of sex, and I wasn't going to bring anything up, so to speak, until she was ready.

We settled into a much more amicable arrangement, and I was simply relieved to have made as much progress toward reconciliation as we had.

Juliette was now comfortable to change clothes in front of me, or wear nothing much around the apartment while I was there. That wasn't always easy for me to deal with, since we weren't having sex. But I would enjoy the sight of her wincingly hot body when she wore a tight little t-shirt and panties just to eat breakfast or watch TV, or when she would strip off entirely in order to change into her nightwear.

Things were warming up between us.

Our social life even resumed, and we both started going out for drinks together, with the usual bunch of friends.

Our friends tried not to act like we'd been away for weeks — it seemed almost as though Jessie had given them a stern talking to, warning them not to raise any potentially uncomfortable subjects. They were as cautious with us as I had been with Juliette. Jessie gave me knowing smiles, and when there was a quiet opportunity to thank her, I did so.

'Everything going well?' she asked me, while Juliette was in the restroom, and we had both escaped the table to fetch a fresh round of drinks.

'I think so,' I said, flashing her a grateful smile. 'I think she might have forgiven me.'

Jessie nodded, and whispered, 'She's trying to. I think maybe... I helped her to understand your point of view, even without admitting we met up behind her back.'

'Did she say anything else about what upset her?'

The blonde flashed her eyes sideways, checking for danger. Then she said, 'Well, like you said, she thought you wanted an open relationship.'

Or that you wanted to sleep with one of your exes. I said that didn't sound like you. That you've only ever wanted her. That you've always been completely loopy about her.'

'Thanks,' I said. 'It must have helped... otherwise I probably wouldn't be here.'

Jessie nodded. 'I told her that from everything she'd said about what happened, it sounded like you just wanted her to have fun — even if that meant sleeping with her ex. And that meant you had to be one of the best husbands on the planet.'

I chuckled. 'I like that.'

But now we noticed Juliette emerge from the restroom.

Jessie flashed me a warning glance in case I'd missed it. Then she said quickly under her breath, 'There was one more thing she said to me that I don't think you figured out.'

'Yeah?' I prompted her while we both tried to look outwardly as though we were chatting about perfectly trivial things while waiting for our drinks at the bar.

'Maybe even what most upset her—she felt like you didn't love her anymore because you didn't care if another guy fucked her.'

'*Huh?*' I said, feeling the tension rising as Juliette approached us through the crowded bar.

'Sometimes we like it when our man is jealous,' Jessie explained. 'It means he loves us so much, he hates the idea that someone else would get to have us instead.'

With time running out, I insisted, 'It's not that I don't *love* her. I love her like *crazy*. I love her so much I want her to have as much fun as possible, even if it's with some other guy...'

Jessie gave me a funny look at that, but I didn't quite know why at the time.

But then Juliette was back with us, and so all conversation regarding Cory and the fateful Reunion Night was done for now.

I felt a little better, though — feeling that I understood Juliette's perspective, and hopefully Jessie could help Juliette to understand mine.

A few days later, the climate between Juliette and I continued to warm up, which I hoped meant Jessie had helped to further clarify things in my wife's mind.

Then one night when we were getting ready for bed as usual, my fair Juliette came out of the bathroom to quietly peel off her clothes — and she did not immediately put on her nightwear in place of them.

Instead, she slipped silently into bed with me, naked as a jaybird, and leaned in to kiss me quite tenderly, her hand drifting down my chest to seek out the inevitable hard-on down below.

She didn't seem surprised that I was massively turned on by her actions. She gently tugged down my sweatpants and took hold of my stiff shaft, slowly pumping it as we made out.

I honestly tried not to recall images of her having sex with Cory. I tried not to think about my fantasy of watching her with any guy she felt like fucking. I thought it better to move on completely. Perhaps I needed to suppress my secret fantasy altogether.

I focused on how stunningly beautiful she was — those big, blue eyes, all that soft, bright golden hair. Her incredible petite body as she pulled back the sheets and climbed onto me. Her pink nipples so hard as she took my cock inside her for the first time in a very long time.

God, it felt amazing. She was so gloriously wet. Neither of us lasted very long, but thankfully her climax came just ahead of mine.

It truly felt like the sun had finally come out after a long period of darkness.

As we drifted off to sleep spooned together, I resolved never to mention the whole cuckolding thing again. Never to even hint that I'd love to see her enjoy another man.

It just wasn't worth the risk. Things were settling so nicely between us.

But then not long after that, I discovered — on Facebook of all places — that Juliette had met up with Cory Fallon without telling me. *The* Cory Fallon. The one and only.

It seemed that they had met for lunch right here in New York City while he'd been in town for his interview, at a place I did not recognize.

It looked to me like she'd purposefully met him in secret.

What the hell?

CHAPTER 9

I HAD another of those slightly creepy friend suggestions from Facebook's slightly creepy algorithm. This time, the AI gods thought I might want Cory Fallon as my online buddy.

When the email came in inviting me to befriend a guy who had caused so much trouble in my marriage, I was at work, sipping Starbucks at my desk. It amused me enough to go on Facebook to see if they were recommending anyone else from Juliette's high school reunion to be my digital pal.

Anyway, you know how it is with Facebook. With social media. It's easy to get sucked down the rabbit hole.

My curiosity led me through various profiles of Juliette's high school friends, and eventually, I caught little comments about Cory Fallon interviewing for a job in NYC and meeting with Juliette while he'd been in town.

There was even a photograph I found confirming a sighting of Juliette at lunch with Becky and Cory, and a few others.

Damn.

It wasn't so much that she was having lunch with Cory that bothered me. I mean, I'd made it clear enough, via Jessie, that it was okay by me if Juliette wanted to do something fun with an ex-boyfriend. But I never said anything about doing it behind my back.

And it seemed weird that she would do that, given the grief the whole thing with Cory had caused our relationship since the reunion. She'd even been careful to keep any mention of the recent lunch meeting off her Facebook profile—and she was the type of person who did everything on Facebook, talked about everything she did, everyone she saw, everyone she practically thought about.

If I'd generally made it clear I wouldn't be upset if she wanted to see Cory again, why would she keep it such a secret?

I guess even though I wasn't a jealous guy, I could be as paranoid as anybody else. I felt a flush of ugly heat sweep through my entire body at the notion that Juliette would want to do something behind my back.

I sent a quick WTF message to my friend Brian, and then also one to Jessie, since I figured she might offer insight on Juliette's motivations even though Jessie wasn't part of Juliette's high school crowd.

Brian, who was rapidly becoming my volunteer therapist, came back to me with suitably calming suggestions.

Talking over FaceTime as we both chomped on our lunch on different sides of the East River, Brian said Juliette had probably been dragged out to that lunch by the rest of her old high school friends and that they might have thought it weird if she'd declined.

'She was probably just being polite—I mean, Cory probably doesn't know how much trouble he caused you guys on that reunion night. As far as he knows, you all just had a fun night, and he got to bang the hottest chick in town. That was it.'

I sighed. 'Yeah, I guess so.'

'Or maybe she went there to try to persuade him not to relocate to New York just to be closer to her.'

I nodded. I liked that idea. And I hated it.

'I guess that's possible.'

'And she wouldn't want to complicate things by telling you she met him again. She might have hoped he would just quietly go away.'

The idea was attractive in its simplicity. Why bother telling me if she only saw him to say to him she didn't want anything to happen between

them? It was strangely disappointing to think she would close off the door to her ex-boyfriend like that, though.

But, I had always been one for Occam's Razor—the simplest explanation is usually the right one.

It did make me feel a little better, supposing that Juliette had only met Cory to tell him not to pursue her.

*

However, when I got home that evening, the little devil on my shoulder had been whispering into my ear all afternoon. I was determined to investigate Juliette's meeting with Cory further.

I'd stared at that one photograph of the lunch meeting all afternoon—and I was sure that Juliette looked far too cheerful talking to Cory to be telling him to stop chasing her.

An afternoon of stewing over the fact that Juliette had met her old flame behind my back made me paranoid that after three years of marriage, she regretted dropping Cory in favor of a college degree. That maybe now she was practically self-sufficient financially, her law career really going places, it was time to drop the dork and return to her high school Prom King.

Meanwhile, the kinky side of me was hoping she'd just been tempted back into some really filthy sex with an ex, and had failed to tell her husband because she had never been all that comfortable talking about sex.

This was such a weird fantasy.

Anyway, I got home and started feverishly searching the apartment for evidence that Juliette might have enjoyed a second, more clandestine rendezvous with Cory after the family-friendly lunch meeting documented by Facebook.

Could she have stolen time away from the office for a quick visit to Cory's hotel? She would have had nearly two hours to see him if she'd left work around 5pm instead of the usual 7pm.

I don't know what kind of evidence I thought I'd uncover. I must have looked like an idiot scurrying around the apartment, searching the

bathroom, the laundry, and even the trash for clues. I still felt disappointed not to find anything suspicious. There weren't any telltale stains in her panties to betray unusual sexual activities.

Well, that was kind of disappointing, and/or a relief—depending on which conflicting part of me I was paying attention to. I figured if they'd met at Cory's hotel, though, there might not be any evidence for me to find.

I ended up collapsing on the couch, trying to determine whether Juliette had been acting differently any of the days Cory had been in town. I don't think she had.

And that was when the buzzer on our door sounded.

'Nick? It's me. Let me up.'

It was Jessie. What was *she* doing here? I buzzed her in, of course. But while I was waiting for her, my paranoia was formulating theories about what kind of urgent news she had come over to give me that could not wait and was far too sensitive to be simply shared by text.

Was Juliette leaving me?

'What's going on?' was the first thing I said as soon as I opened the front door for my wife's best friend.

'Nothing much,' she smiled, looking completely relaxed and unflustered. 'And how are you doing?'

She reached for a courtesy peck on the cheek, and I did so as usual, trying to respond to her calm by settling down myself.

'Juliette invited me over for dinner—isn't that nice?' she beamed.

She didn't seem at all rushed or nervous, like she wasn't supposed to be meeting me—not like last time. I didn't doubt that Juliette had invited her over. In fact, it was a relief Jessie seemed so relaxed—it didn't seem to me like she was about to tell me her BFF was walking out on our marriage.

I glanced at the clock on my phone. It was nearly six o'clock.

'Juliette's not usually home until past seven on a weeknight—what time did she say to come over?'

‘Sixish?’

Hmm. ‘And she didn’t text me or anything to let me know you’d be coming over...’

‘Oh, I must have got it wrong,’ Jessie said, putting on a ditzy voice which definitely wasn’t her. Jessie might have gone into the advertising business while her BFF had gone to law school, but she was every bit as sharp as Juliette.

‘You wanted to tell me about that lunch meeting Juliette had with Cory?’ I asked her, trying not to sound like the paranoid fool I was as I wandered into the kitchen to fetch us both a glass of chilled white vino.

I glanced back at her to see her calmly hanging her coat on the hook by the door.

‘And which lunch meeting would that be?’ she said dryly.

‘The one I texted you about? The one on Facebook?’

Jessie grinned. ‘I’m not supposed to talk to you about that.’

‘So what are you doing here an hour before you know Juliette will be home from work?’

My suspicions were raised, my appetite whetted. I honestly believed she was here to give me juicy information about Juliette.

Taking her time, she strolled over to accept a glass of wine from me.

‘Here’s the thing,’ she said. ‘Juliette wants to tell you everything that’s going on... but she’s not supposed to.’

‘Not supposed to? What, has she signed an NDA or something?’

My heart was suddenly thumping hard inside my chest at her use of the words ‘everything that’s going on’. It was like definitive proof that my theory was sound about the lunch with Cory being something other than purely innocent.

Jessie sighed as though frustrated, though at the same time, I could tell she was loving this. She loved bearing news, juicy gossip, scandalous details.

‘So, here’s the thing,’ she said, sipping her wine as we hovered by the counter in the middle of the small but open-plan kitchen-living room. ‘After I persuaded Jessie that you allowing her to dance—and fuck—an ex-boyfriend was more likely a sign that you loved her like crazy and trusted her not to leave you, she has kind of changed her view on the whole Cory thing.’

‘Changed her view?’

‘When she met Cory for lunch... she walked him back to his hotel afterward...’

I nearly had a seizure right there and then. I was sure Jessie was about to reveal that Juliette had fucked Cory again, just as I had feared and/or desperately hoped for.

But Jessie read my mind and added quickly, ‘They didn’t do anything; she didn’t go up to his room with him...’

So she told you, I thought to myself.

‘But she was sounding him out about... you know... seeing him more regularly now he’s planning to move to the city.’

I was feeling a little out of breath—and I was doing nothing but standing there clutching a glass of wine.

‘Okay...’ I said, trying to sound cool and collected as I subtly found myself a seat on the couch while avoiding looking as though my legs were going all wobbly.

‘The thing is... if he’s going to start seeing her... he doesn’t want you knowing about it.’

‘Oh.’ My head was spinning a little. What did they put in that wine? ‘He didn’t seem to have a problem with me knowing about it at that high school reunion.’

‘That was just a one-off. He just wanted any chance to get close to Juliette,’ Jessie explained. ‘And what he remembers of that night is that you were drunk as a skunk, and as soon as anything serious started happening between him and Juliette, you were passed out in an armchair.’

Hmm. I was beginning to feel like an unreliable narrator.

Trying to focus on the positive—that perhaps my sweet Juliette did want to do something scandalously wicked with another man—I said, ‘So... anyway, she does want to start seeing him...?’

Jessie said, ‘Well... I mean... you did seem okay with it happening when you had that fight with her. And from what you told me when we had lunch.’

‘But I’m not supposed to have told you anything at all,’ I pointed out. ‘And she’s not supposed to know we had lunch.’

‘No. But I told her I knew guys who were okay about turning a blind eye to their wives seeing other people if they wanted. And it definitely didn’t mean they don’t love their wives.’

‘And do you know guys who are okay with their wives seeing other people?’

‘I know you, don’t I? And what better guide do I have when it comes to how my best friend’s husband might feel about it?’

The logic seemed impeccable, if a little twisted.

I said, ‘So wait... she wants to have an affair with her ex-boyfriend, and for this to happen, she’s not allowed to tell me anything at all. How is that *not* cheating?’

‘Because she knows you’re all right with it,’ Jessie said patiently.

‘But—’ I said, unsure what to say to such a circular argument.

‘You are okay with it, aren’t you? I mean... you said it to me, you want her to see him.’

My mind was reeling. The feelings and emotions whirling around my system really weren’t helping. On paper, I probably seemed like a simple village idiot who really should have been able to just say what he wanted and set out a course of action for how he wanted it to go. But I was a mess. My wife was thinking about sleeping with another guy. I was horrified-slash-thrilled* [* delete as applicable].

I had to simplify my thought process.

‘I am okay with it...’ I began.

‘Great!’ Jessie jumped in like the whole deal had been resolved.

‘Wait, that’s not it,’ I insisted.

‘Oh. Well, I thought it wouldn’t be as easy as that.’

‘Don’t you get it?’ I said, feeling like the reason she hadn’t gotten it was probably because I hadn’t explained the whole thing fully.

Maybe I just had to bite the bullet and tell her I was a cuckold.

‘Look,’ I sighed and picked myself up to fetch more badly needed alcohol. ‘I want her to start seeing him—but I’m not exactly happy about her doing it behind my back.’

‘Okay, but Cory said—‘

‘I know what Cory said. And I get that he might be uncomfortable trying to steal my wife if I happen to know everything that’s going on...’

‘He’s not trying to steal—‘ Jessie said, and then suddenly interrupted herself, ‘He is trying to steal your wife. Didn’t I warn you about him? But Juliette made it pretty clear to me she just wants a little fun on the side, maybe some dancing... she has no intention of leaving you.’

It was fascinating to me that in laying out Juliette’s motivations, Jessie was emphasizing that my wife just wanted a little extra sex on the side of our marriage, if I was okay with that. I liked that about my wife.

‘She feels safe with Cory; she feels she can deal with him if he starts getting overly possessive.’

I nodded. ‘But you were the one who seemed to think I’d made a mistake letting her spend time with him for one night,’ I pointed out. ‘You said she’s been obsessed with him ever since they split up.’

Now, it seemed I was arguing against my wife seeing another man while Jessie was in favor.

Jessie shrugged. ‘Well, not so much since you’ve been married. But I think she’s in a good place... she feels good about being married to you... she can just have a little fun on the side. And a big cock...’

Now, it was my turn to raise my eyebrows and look at her all wide-eyed.

‘What?’ Jessie grinned. ‘I told you—she tells me everything. She has done since college.’

Eyebrows down. Way down.

‘She tell you everything about me, too?’ I asked warily.

‘Of course,’ she shrugged. ‘You know, you have nothing to be embarrassed about.’

I was willing to overlook the brutal invasion of my privacy given the bigger issues I was facing—and the fact that having Jessie as Juliette’s dedicated confidante could prove helpful if I was going to be kept in the dark about her affair with Cory.

‘So... Juliette can’t say anything about what she does with Cory to me... but she tells you everything...’ I pointed out.

Jessie smiled. ‘Cory didn’t say anything about not telling me anything.’

‘And if he does?’

‘He doesn’t even know I exist.’

‘And long may it continue,’ I chuckled.

‘If she’s out dancing with him late at night, she’ll check in with me,’ Jessie said. ‘So then we’ll know she’s safe. And if she’s getting too... dependent on him, I’ll be able to tell.’

‘So I’ll be able to rely on you to make sure she’s happy and safe, and not ruining our marriage?’

‘I’m very reliable.’

‘It’ll be like putting my investments in a blind trust because I’ve been elected President.’

‘I don’t think Presidents do that anymore,’ she said. ‘But yeah... something like that. I will be there for you, keeping you safe. Your own personal guardian angel.’

‘Thing is...’ I took a somewhat sizable gulp of wine and said, ‘It’s not just... safety that’s the issue.’

Jessie peered at me, waiting for the big reveal.

I said cautiously, 'Look, the thing is, I want her to see him... but it's not that I want to turn a blind eye to it.'

One of her eyebrows shot up—but she waited for me to go on. Sigh.

Tensing up, prepared for her to judge me—and damn me—I said cautiously, 'Wanting Juliette to see Cory... it's not *entirely* a selfless act. It's not *purely* because I want her to have fun and for her to be happy and fulfilled and living her best life.'

'What is it you do want?'

Her dry tone and the way she looked at me suggested she was expecting me to suddenly unveil the small print—and the focus she seemed to be giving me made me wonder if she wasn't readying herself for me to read the small print ridiculously quickly like those pharmaceutical ads on TV.

I said, 'If this is going to happen, and I'm going to let her do whatever she wants with him, I'm going to need you to share as many details with me as possible.'

So far, so not perverted.

She kept quiet, sitting in rapt attention as she let me continue.

'I need to know when she's going to see him. I need to know where she is at all times. I need to know as much as you know about what she does with him when she's with him.'

'Okay...' Jessie said cautiously.

'I mean... you say she tells you everything. Well, I want to know *everything*.'

'*Everything*?'

'*Everything*.' I could see her mulling over the legal definition of that word. I felt myself trying to close loopholes in our agreement, even though our agreement was only verbal, and honor-based. I said, 'I want to know all the gritty details—I want to know how she feels, I want to know what she does, I want to know what he does, I want to know how long, how I want to know how many times, I want to know what it looks like, I want to know how good it was...'

As the words tumbled out of my mouth, I saw Jessie's jaw drop lower and lower, her eyes get wider and wider.

Eventually, she seemed to snap, and interrupted me by whispering loudly, 'I knew it.'

I stopped babbling.

Sounding astonished, despite her claimed foresight, she said, 'You're kinky as fuck.'

Well, I guess the cat was out of the bag.

I felt dread filling my stomach like thick, black crude oil. Did she understand that I was admitting to a cuckolding fantasy? I expected her to start hurling abuse at me any second.

'You knew it?' I asked her.

She gave me a satisfied grin. 'When we had lunch—right at the end when you were telling me how much you love her. And you said you love her so much you wanted her to have as much fun as possible, even if it's with another guy... not just Cory, or one of her ex-boyfriends because they've already done everything with her under the sun...'

'Seriously?'

'Maybe it was your tone or something. Made it sound like you just wanted Juliette to go out and bang whoever she wanted, ex or not. Because, for God's sake, you like it. You get off on it., you God damn filthy so-and-so.'

Here it was. She was going to denounce me. Excommunicate me. Urge Juliette to leave me, and run off with Cory.

My mouth rapidly drying up, I said, 'What are you going to say to Juliette?'

For a few moments, she seemed aghast, unable to quite put her feelings into words.

Then she said, 'I'm going to tell Juliette that she should go out and have an absolutely amazing time dancing the night away with Cory Fallon whenever she likes because he's a fantastic dancer. And that when they're done dancing, she should take him back to wherever and ride that

humongous cock of his until she can't walk... *But* that when her ex-boyfriend rolls over and goes to sleep, she should go right back to her husband and make sure she makes him as satisfied as any man can be. Even if she can't say a word about what just happened in another man's bed. Because he's the most wonderful husband any woman could have...'

I don't know; I may have misremembered exactly what she said. Might have forgotten a few other flattering things she mentioned. But then, I *am* an unreliable narrator.

Anyway. I was a little stunned by how much praise Jessie was suddenly pouring my way. I genuinely hadn't been expecting that.

I said something like, 'Oh. Uh... great.'

Then Jessie said something like, 'You know, she probably won't be able to hide much from you anyway. I mean... at the end of the day, this is a pretty small apartment. And you guys see a lot of each other.'

'I guess so.'

'What is she going to do, tell you she's going out for a few drinks with the girls, and then come home at 3am freshly showered?'

'Maybe she'll wait until I'm out of town for the weekend. Visiting clients in London or Tokyo or Hamburg or somewhere...' I said. I didn't travel a huge amount for work, but it did happen occasionally. I swear, I had to go to London just to do some photocopying once, and the client paid me to go First Class all the way. Corporate law had its perks.

Jessie said, 'Sure, she could wait until you really can't find out. But she's not gonna want to wait.'

'I'm guessing.'

'And pretty soon, she's going to figure out that you're into it,' Jessie said, smiling like the Cheshire Cat. 'She's going to know that when she's out pressing herself up against another man... sucking his dick... squeezing that huge great cock into her tight little kitty... you're turned on like crazy. And when she comes back to you afterward, you'll be so into her, it isn't even funny.'

‘I would guess so,’ I said, slightly stunned at Jessie’s dirty mouth. But hey, we were getting fairly personal here.

She said, ‘Pretty soon, our Juliette’s going to be hiding less and less... and letting slip more and more... and you won’t need me to tell you exactly what’s going on every time she’s out banging another guy.’

I nodded, crossing my legs like a mildly interested academic, just to hide the enormous bulge in my pants.

‘To start with, though,’ I said, ‘You have to tell me everything she tells you.’

‘Oh, I will, buddy.’

‘And you have to tip me off if she’s planning something with him. You know... so I’m not out of town at the time...’

Jessie was looking at me like I’d cured cancer.

She said with regret, ‘How come there aren’t more guys out there like you?’

I smiled. ‘Oh, there are. It’s actually quite a common male fantasy.’

Cue more astonishment.

‘Jesus,’ she said. ‘I am going to google the fuck out of this when I get home.’

It felt cathartic to open up about how I really felt. But how would Juliette react when Jessie told her all about it? I was still nervous.

CHAPTER 10

WHEN JULIETTE FINALLY CAME HOME, Jessie and I were already well-stuck in the wine. I was busy fixing a nice chicken alfredo for our dinner.

‘Hey,’ she said, clinking together the two extra bottles of white she’d brought to the party. ‘Sorry, I’m late.’

It was going to be a heavy night for a weeknight, huh.

‘Oh, you’re not late,’ Jessie said while offering her a welcome hug, as though she was merely being polite. But I felt like there might have been a little teasing in there, because Juliette had purposefully asked her BFF to arrive an hour early for dinner to encourage her to discuss a particular sensitive subject with me before her arrival.

‘Smells amazing,’ my sweet wife said, sniffing the air as I sprinkled the final few herbs over the bubbling pot.

‘How was work?’ I asked her as she approached me for a customary greeting kiss.

‘Oh, you know,’ she said, her tone suggesting it was boring talking about work while we had guests.

I couldn’t help but kiss her on the lips, even though she had presented me with her cheek for a simple peck of salutation. She did look exceptionally gorgeous. I don’t think it was because she’d paused on her

way home to re-apply her makeup, or that she had increased her usual twice-a-week gym schedule.

It was because before she'd arrived, Jessie and I had been discussing what would happen when my wife started sleeping with another guy. And with that at the forefront of my mind, to me Juliette seemed like the most beautiful woman who ever lived.

Would I continue feeling this way when she actually started seeing another man?

Would I feel this crazy about her after she started actually sleeping with her ex-boyfriend, Cody?

How would it feel when I knew she couldn't say anything about it?

We always seemed to drink a lot whenever Jessie was around, and we had a decent supply of wine that evening.

But despite the fun we appeared to be having on the surface, I did notice a slight tension in Juliette. An anxiety. My sweet wife was nervous about something, and it didn't take a genius to work out what.

She didn't know what I had agreed with Jessie.

She didn't know what I had said about her hopes to start dating her ex-boyfriend again. And that strange requirement she had — that she couldn't talk to me about what she was doing with Cory — meant I couldn't come right out and mention it to her directly.

She would have to wait to see from Jessie what my view was on her plan to be unfaithful to me.

It meant that for much of the night, she seemed like she was quietly waiting for important test results.

I tried to act affectionately toward her all evening, as though to reassure her that now I had spoken with Jessie, I was good with everything. I even ducked out to go to the restroom a couple of times — and took my time using the facilities — to give her time for a discreet chat with her BFF.

Eventually, she seemed to relax a little more. I think Jessie might have said something to her. I hoped she had.

Anyway. We drank loads, we chatted about everything other than Cory, and Jessie didn't go home until pretty late — especially late for a weeknight.

Once Jessie was gone, I set to clearing up things from dinner, since we didn't have space in our tiny kitchen to leave dirty dishes lying around for long.

Juliette seemed to be texting someone — Jessie? Cory?

I had hopes for either one.

My best guess was that it was Jessie. She wouldn't be able to hold back from texting Juliette the moment she left the apartment to let her best friend know what we'd talked about before she'd arrived. To let her know how I stood on the secret plan for Juliette to have an affair.

I didn't rush cleaning up in the kitchen to purposefully give Juliette as much time as she wanted to text whoever it was.

After a short while in front of the TV, she went into the bedroom, and when I casually strolled past the bedroom door, I could see she was lying in bed, still texting away.

I went back to loading the dishwasher and ended up scrubbing the pot I'd used to make the pasta. Then, I had to take out the trash and finish various other menial tasks. I didn't think it would take me that long, but when I was done and went into the bedroom, hopeful of a little quality time with my sweetness, she was already asleep.

Ah, well, it was late. And as I said, we'd had a good few portions of wine.

Anyway, we both had to get up in the morning and go to work. I conceded the point and got some sleep myself.

When I woke, it was not yet daylight outside.

I was confused at first because this did not feel like the usual time I woke in the morning. And, as I emerged a little more from my slumber, I realized the bed was slightly shaking.

A rare East Coast earthquake?

But the gentle movement of our bed continued way beyond what you might expect for a minor seismic event.

I lay completely still, my ears pricked. Above the quiet hum of nocturnal New York traffic, which was ever present in our apartment, I could hear a soft sighing sound. It took me a few moments to work out what it was.

Juliette was touching herself in the darkness. God. I couldn't believe it.

I was lying on my side, my back toward her. I didn't want to move; I didn't want her to stop. I got the sense she was lying on her back, sheets pulled to the side, one hand moving as subtly as she could manage against her pussy.

I could hear the silky sounds of her labored breathing as she touched herself, the little staccato disruptions of small gasps and moans as she responded to the pleasure she was invoking in her sex with skilled fingers.

I breathed deeply and could detect the subtle scent of her arousal in the air.

Wow. I was stunned. As far as I knew, she'd never done anything like this before. I never even knew she masturbated, even though we'd been together six years. I suppose I always *assumed* she did, on occasion — everybody does, don't they? But I guess I just thought she did it in the shower, sometimes, somewhere I wasn't there to catch her.

Boy, it was so sexy, listening to her. Gauging the fact that she was obviously so horny she couldn't wait for release.

Yet if she was so horny, why didn't she slip out to the bathroom or camp out on the living room couch to take care of her needs? Why risk doing it right beside me on the bed?

I'd always been a fairly heavy sleeper. I could imagine she assumed she could keep things relatively quiet and I wouldn't wake. Earlier in our relationship, I'd slept through three fire alarms in our building, so I suppose she had reason to feel confident. But ever since our argument and all that time I'd spent sleeping on the couch, my sleep had been lighter and easier to disrupt.

Right now, I heard the mattress quietly creak and felt Juliette stirring in the bed — then there was the unmistakable sound of material brushing against her skin as she took off her panties.

Now, her movement was a little more pronounced, her breathing a little louder as she touched herself without the hindrance of underwear. She must have felt reasonably confident I was solidly asleep.

I was so hard as I lay there, but I couldn't touch it. The frustration ran deep — as did the temptation to pretend to wake up and catch her and then join her in her little nocturnal sexual escapade.

I didn't want her to stop. I wanted to listen to her doing it.

I guess I was a voyeur at heart — and I had never had this experience with my wife before. I could have sex with her another time, but now I just wanted to appreciate the thrill of listening in on her private moment. The scent of her arousal was more pungent in the air now as she played without panties. I just adored it. I could hear the wet sounds of her fingers moving against her soaking pussy.

What had made her this horny?

What got her so hot under the collar that she couldn't even wait for release until her usual morning shower?

As I listened to her fingers moving so frantically over her clit, it was difficult not to connect this development to the conversation I'd had with Jessie before dinner the previous night. If Jessie had subsequently let Juliette know I was in favor of her dating Cory, that might have wound her up.

Was she thinking about fucking Cory again?

Man, it was crazy hot to have such a horny wife. I lay there breathing in her intimate spice, trying not to touch the swollen beast lurking between my thighs. I didn't want her to think I was awake. I didn't want her to get all self-conscious and embarrassed.

I just wanted to listen to her masturbate.

It seemed a while before her efforts were rewarded with a period of quiet panting, some sustained moans she attempted to stifle by clamping a

pillow to her face, and a short moment of irregular shudders of her entire petite frame.

But I enjoyed every moment.

It made me even more resolved to support the idea of her embarking on an affair with her old flame, even if she had to try to keep it secret from me.

Happy spouse, happy house, right?

With Jessie available as a go-between, and as a safety mechanism, it would be okay, wouldn't it?

Anyway. After a long, long while, Juliette's shaking subsided, her moans ceased, and her breathing settled back into a more regular and sustainable pattern. It was easy to tell she'd come — hard — and was now satisfied.

She got up from the bed and went to the bathroom via a brief stop at her dresser to fetch some new underwear.

I was tempted to 'wake up' when she came back to bed, and engineer some kind of explanation for a late-night hard-on, to see if she might help me do something about my predicament. But after making herself come like she had, I guessed she would be tired and no longer in the mood to enjoy such a predicament fully.

I let her return from the bathroom without interference.

I waited long enough for her to fall asleep again, and slipped out to the bathroom — picking up her abandoned panties on my way. She'd gotten them seriously wet before she'd taken them off.

It didn't take me long to deal with my predicament.

'So she's really going to do it?'

'I think so. I mean, Jessie's supposed to be making it clear I'm in favor of her hypothetically cheating on me so long as there are safety mechanisms in place and that I pretty much know it's happening.'

Brian sighed. 'You are living the dream.'

We were watching a midweek game at the Mets at their stadium out by LaGuardia. I wasn't a huge baseball fan, but Brian had supported the Mets since he was a kid, and when he offered me a ticket, I thought it might be a chance to let Juliette have a bit of breathing space. And that, I thought, might be helpful for her developing affair.

'It is a red flag that Cory is so adamant you don't find out about any of this,' my friend warned me.

'I know,' I nodded, feeling that slight queasiness in my stomach at Brian reminding me of the big flaw in my otherwise thrilling plan.

'He's definitely hoping to steal her away from you.'

My sigh turned to vapor in the crisp February air. 'She's told Jessie she only wants to see Cory for the sex — and only because I'm supposed to be okay with her doing whatever she likes if it's with someone she's already done it with before.'

'She says it's only for the sex,' Brian said. 'But if she was as obsessed with that guy at high school — and even in college, from what Jessie told you — then those feelings aren't just going to go away. Did you ever even find out who broke up with who?'

'Huh?'

'Did Juliette dump Cory so she could go to college, or did Cory walk away from her when she went to college?'

I froze for a moment or two, wracking my memory. I couldn't think whether they'd told me. Cory had said something about it being mutual.

'I think they said it was mutual,' I said at last.

'It's never mutual. People say it can be, but that's BS. You should try to find out — if it was Cory who dropped her, that would add to the danger signs.'

I pondered the general air of regret that Cory had surrounding him early on during that reunion event. Was that the regret of a guy who had done a Good Thing by breaking up with his sweet girlfriend so she could go to college and enjoy a fresh start?

It did make me a little more nervous about Juliette embarking on a new relationship with him. If she'd never wanted to break up with him in the

first place...

Brian could sense my growing anxiety. He said, 'Your friend Jessie will tell you if she seems to be getting too hung up on him.'

'It's still a big risk, though, isn't it?' I said. 'Am I being an idiot?'

Brian could feel my pain. Despite all his failed relationships, he still felt that cuckolding fantasy burning brightly inside him, and his search for someone to explore it with him had not gone well.

'You probably don't want to take advice from a guy who lost four wives —',

'One of them passed away — that wasn't your fault,' I pointed out. I accept it felt odd to cite a dead wife as a positive.

Brian said, 'You're hooked after what happened at that reunion. I'd probably be the same if I was you.'

'And if you were me, what would you do right now?'

He shrugged. 'Probably what you're doing. I mean... if the only way she'll do it is by making it look like cheating...'

'I think it is.'

'And you could say it's not cheating because you've made it clear enough that you'll let her do it.'

'Assuming she doesn't keep it so secret, I can at least follow her progress via Jessie.'

'What does Jessie think about it all?' Brian asked.

'She thought it was insane at first. But I think she's come around to the idea.'

'She still thinks it's just a matter of you being fine with whatever Juliette does because she's already done it with Cory before?'

'Hmm... well, I think I've let the cat out of the bag a bit about... you know...'

He knew. Neither of us wanted to utter the 'c' word in the middle of a crowd.

He chuckled. 'What did she say to that?'

'You know what? When I explained it all to her, she seemed to really like the idea.'

'Once she knew it wasn't about you wanting to see other women. Or because you don't care what happens to your wife anymore.'

'When she understood... you know... it's a turn-on...'

Brian nodded. 'Women always think we have an ulterior motive, huh? Once you get past that barrier, it gets easier. When I'm on a date with someone who never heard of such a thing, they're instantly suspicious.'

I nodded. 'But there are creeps out there...'

'There are. I think when you're on a Tinder date and you look like me, as far as most women are concerned, it's creep-before-proven-innocent.'

A little later, with the Mets once again performing dismally at the start of the season, I was distracted from the tepid action by an incoming FaceTime call. It was Jessie, of all people.

When I took the call, she said, 'You're a *cuckold*!'

Oh, God. I think about three thousand people heard it.

I gasped and glanced around to see if anyone was laughing at me.

Brian said quickly, 'Don't call him that. Jesus.'

There was a real distaste in his voice. It took me about two Mississippis to realize he was cleverly pretending that Jessie had called me a cuckold over the phone in a (perhaps) joking way, meaning it as just a general derogatory term.

If anyone had heard her use the word, they weren't paying any attention to us now. Brian had some brains in that noggin of his.

I shielded my mouth and said into the phone to Jessie: 'We're at a baseball game. Lots of people around. You can't use words like that...'

‘Oh, sorry. I forgot — it’s taboo, right?’ she said. The way she said it suggested that since the last time I’d seen her, she’d ‘googled the fuck’ out of my particular kink, as she’d said she would do.

‘Something like that,’ I said.

There was a beat. Brian gave me a smile, which I think was his version of an eye-roll, but Brian was too nice to roll his eyes at people.

‘Anyway, hi, Jess,’ I said more loudly and cheerfully to her. I was pleased that she’d called — Jessie didn’t call me. Not like this, out of the blue. ‘How can I help you?’

She said, ‘You’re a...’

And I thought she was about to shout out the ‘c’ word all over again right in front of the family audience around us. She stopped herself.

‘I’ve been reading about people like you,’ she said.

I said, ‘You want me to call you when the game’s over?’

She said, ‘You *are*, though, aren’t you? One of those — ?’

‘I’m hanging up for now, Jess...’

I could tell she was desperate to grill me about cuckolding. She must have done some serious research.

In the face of me threatening to imminently end our call, she said definitively, ‘You *are*.’

She was going to assume I was confirming her allegation by not explicitly denying it.

Then, after a split second in which she clearly took my non-denial as confirmation, she huffed, ‘Seriously. You know how seriously *unfair* that is?’

‘Goodbye, Jessie. Speak to you later!’ I said.

‘Bye, Jessie!’ Brian yelled, as though he felt it was only polite to say goodbye even though he wasn’t part of our call.

‘Oh, that’s my friend, Brian, by the way,’ I said to explain the extra farewell, turning the phone so she could see Brian.

‘Hi, Brian!’ Jessie said brightly.

But then I hung up on her.

Brian was laughing. ‘That’s Jessie?’

I grinned. ‘She’s what they used to call a ‘gossip’ back when we had tabloid newspapers instead of social media. I guess she’s finally gotten around to doing some background reading and discovered the ‘c’ word. I guess some people haven’t ever heard it before.’

Brian said, ‘I once had a colleague who had no idea what a sailboat is. I swear. We spent about half an hour trying to work out if he was pranking us — and then we had to explain that some boats have huge poles sticking up in the middle, and people attach huge pieces of cloth to them that will catch the wind, and push the boat along.’

‘How did anyone get through life without knowing what a sailboat is?’

‘People have different upbringings, they live in different circles.’ He said, ‘Why does Jessie think it’s unfair?’

‘I’m not sure, but I’m sure I’ll find out soon enough.’

I called Jessie back when we got out of the stadium as Brian and I headed toward the subway.

The first thing she said to me was, ‘You never told me it’s a thing!’

‘I never told you what is a ‘thing’?’

‘Cuckolding.’

When I heard the word come out of her mouth, I instinctively glanced around to ensure no one else was within earshot. Thankfully, it seemed like no one was close enough.

‘Well, clearly, it’s a thing,’ I said. ‘It has a name. Which you probably shouldn’t keep yelling, by the way.’

She said, ‘Sorry. I forget it’s taboo. But fuck, man. There’s a story on CNN’s website, says 58% of men have thought about it — ‘

‘I’m not sure they all want to do it.’

‘Cosmo says it’s all about watching your partner have sex with someone else.’

It sounded to me like Jessie had really been doing the homework.

‘Well, if you’re not in a position to watch...’

‘The night of the reunion — wanted to watch them, didn’t you? All along. I mean, I know you were too drunk when they got to it, but — ’

‘Hey, I didn’t know it was a thing until Juliette decided to dance with him, and...’

‘But you encouraged them to keep dancing.’

‘They didn’t need much encouragement. She seemed to be enjoying herself so much... The main thing was, it felt so good seeing her happy like that.’

‘Cosmo said it’s called *compersion*. Experiencing somebody else’s joy.’

She sounded like a professor, peering over her glasses as she cited some fascinating and important new research. Her tone made me chuckle.

‘You’ve been doing some reading, huh?’

She sighed. ‘Man, how come I didn’t know about any of this stuff? This is the hottest thing I ever heard. I mean, a husband who wants you to have sex with other guys, who wants to watch you?’

‘It doesn’t have to involve watching,’ I pointed out.

‘But you get off on it. It turns you on.’

‘Is it *bad* when a wife turns her husband on?’

‘God, no. It’s the dream, isn’t it? God, why can’t I find a husband like that? It’s so unfair.’

‘You’re just not looking in the right places,’ I chuckled.

‘Right places? More than half of guys are apparently into this. Every other guy I date should want me to fuck other guys. Where the hell are they?’

I think Brian heard that comment as we climbed the steps up to the station, he flashed me an amused grin. I guess her complaint was funny, given how difficult it was for Brian to find someone who might entertain his fantasy.

I said, 'They're all over the place — my friend Brian, here...'

'*He's* one?'

I glanced at Brian, suddenly aware I was committing something of a faux pas, potentially outing him to somebody I knew like this. But Brian gave me a shrug to say he didn't care if she knew.

'Yeah, he's been — '

'He still with you?' Jessie interrupted me.

'Yeah, we're just about to jump on the seven — '

'Can I talk to him?'

Brian seemed totally confused as I handed him the phone. I felt terrible dragging him into this, but I figured he had more experience with the fantasy than I did; maybe he could answer questions I couldn't.

He was smiling ear-to-ear practically the moment he started talking to her. Jessie's pretty funny.

At first, he was just like, 'Uh... sure... yeah. Sure...'

I wondered what she was asking him. But then she was clearly asking him about the whole humiliation aspect of cuckolding.

'I guess some guys like it, but depends what you define as humiliating,' he was saying as we reached the station platform, and started moving toward an empty area where people wouldn't overhear. 'As far as mainstream society is concerned, it's humiliating simply to have your wife sleep with somebody else. So, yeah, they might say you like being humiliated if you're a... you know.'

He didn't use the 'c' word, but we were both looking around to make sure we weren't being overheard. There were a lot of people moving out onto the platform now.

‘There *are* guys who like it when their wife tells them they’re not a real man, and, you know, degrades them, but not all guys are like that. For some, it’s just... you know... they get their kicks from a wife who likes a lot of sex — ’

Brian glanced around, blushing profusely as the word ‘sex’ fell out of his mouth. Well, I suppose it wasn’t something you just blurted out in public like that.

For a while, he was just listening to Jessie, still blushing like a Catholic schoolgirl watching Magic Mike. When he eventually handed me the phone back, the 7 train was pulling into the platform, and I couldn’t hear a thing.

I could only bellow into the phone, ‘Talk to you later, Jessie!’

And I hung up as we shuffled onto the train, a mass of people suddenly crowding around us.

When I glanced over at him, Brian looked utterly stunned.

‘What’s going on, man?’ I asked him.

He said, ‘She asked me out.’

I gave him a full eyebrow raise. ‘Jessie?’

‘We have a *date* next Friday night!’

CHAPTER 11

BRIAN SHOOK my hand and stepped off the 7 train at Court Square for the journey down to Brooklyn, while I stayed on to head into Grand Central, where I would change for the ride up to the Upper East Side.

On my lonesome, I texted Jessie:

You asked Brian out on a date? 🙄

Jessie texted me back fairly quickly:

He's cute. And he's single. 😊

Cute. The word seemed somehow demeaning. Like she was talking about a puppy. Still, it was kind of adorable that she'd asked him out on a date. I teased her:

You're only interested in him because I told you he's into cuckolding. 🙄

I've asked guys on first dates for less. 😊

He's a good guy, Jess. You will try and be nice to him?

Of course, I'm always nice! 😊

You won't mess him around. Ghost him, or whatever?

I promise. 😊

Seriously, tho. You're really attracted to him? 😏

I felt bad asking her that. I mean — I liked Brian, I enjoyed hanging out with him, but he didn't exactly have movie star looks. More like character actor looks. The quirky but likable guy you see in loads of movies playing the best friend or the sidekick.

But Jessie replied:

Are you kidding me? He's cute! 🥰

Well, he's my friend so no being mean, breaking his heart.

Aww. 😊

You looking forward to your date? When is it, Friday?

Next Friday. I'm stupidly busy until next week, so it's better to wait. It's going to be so lovely. We'll have so much to talk about, I can already tell.

And if you actually like him?

Then maybe we'll have a second date, too 😊

And if you keep seeing him... you really think you'd want to... you know... 😊

Are you asking me if I'd consider cuckolding him? 😊 Well, that's what he wants, isn't it?

Well I hope it works out for both of you just how you want

Thanks!

Nick: And if you hear anything else about Juliette and Cory, make sure you tell me!

I'll let you know as soon as 🤔

The next time Jessie texted me, Juliette and I were cuddled up on the sofa watching TV a few days later. I thought she might be letting me know she had decided not to go out on a date with Brian the following Friday after all. But that wasn't why she was texting me.

Cory's going to be in town next week, FYI.

That made me catch my breath. Juliette probably would have noticed if she hadn't been absorbed in an episode of *Bridgerton*, her favorite show.

He is? How long will he be here?

He has a second interview for that job. I guess he's in town for a few days, I don't know if he'd stick around until the weekend.

I felt a mixture of delight and sheer panic dancing inside my chest at the prospect of things kicking off between Juliette and Cory. I had to act very cool and not lose my shit, since Juliette was right there snuggling up to me.

How did you find out? There wasn't anything on Facebook...

I think he's keeping it quiet. But she told me about it.

I took a breath as I read that. Even though I'd basically agreed to the whole arrangement, it still made me feel a little dead inside to know that my beloved wife was keeping things from me. I was going to have to get used to this.

Is she planning on seeing him while he's here?

Of course. She'll probably tell you she's going out with Becky and that crew, since you don't tend to go with her when she sees them.

My heart was thumping so hard, I wondered if Juliette would notice. But we were watching *Bridgerton*, so there was plenty to distract her, including that actor she liked, the one tipped to play James Bond someday.

Has she told you what they're going to get up to while he's here?

I craved more information. I desperately wanted to know if Juliette was planning on going all the way with Cory from the get-go, or if she was planning to build up to it during several dates. But there was no immediate reply from Jessie. Something must have come up.

It felt a little frustrating to be left hanging like that. But at least I had the headline news — Cory would be in town next week! Was something really going to happen between Juliette and her ex-boyfriend so soon?

My pulse was seriously racing. I was going to have to learn to keep calm when I received thrilling news like this. Juliette was going to know I knew something I shouldn't.

I tried to settle down. I amused myself at how pathetic I was. Why was I so worried about Juliette knowing I'd discovered her secret plans with Cory?

I suppose it was all about plausible deniability. If Cory asked Juliette straight out if I'd talked to her about him, or if I knew anything about their affair, Juliette would want to be able to tell him I hadn't and I didn't, without lying to him. It would be easier that way.

'What're you smiling at?'

Juliette's question snapped me out of my inner monologue.

I felt myself gently flush from embarrassment at being caught smiling at nothing in particular, like some kind of village idiot. I started to think of some excuse to explain my random merriment when she blurted out, 'Well, I know you're not going to be jealous...'

For a moment, I didn't know what she was referring to — except that her comment clearly alluded to the fact that she knew I had a cuckolding fantasy.

And from the sound of her voice, she apparently seemed to like that I did.

I happened to glance at the TV screen, since it was huge and right in front of us, and realized that while I had been texting Jessie, my wife's favorite *Bridgerton* character had peeled off his clothes for a swim in the lake.

Now I looked back at Juliette and she was smirking, like I'd caught her being naughty. I realized she thought I was amused at her responding physically to the male nudity on our screen.

I joked, 'Hey, I don't mind you looking, honey. Or anything else you want to do...'

She responded with a surprisingly sweet smile. It surprised me, igniting a sudden flash of heat in my chest. After all the grief between us since her high school reunion, this little exchange suggested that things had turned a corner.

It made me think Jessie must have sent Juliette those articles about cuckolding.

It seemed to me I could see something new in her eyes — a knowing glint, hinting that she understood me a little more now — and a genuine affection in her smile that said she adored me for it.

I gave her a little loving squeeze as, on screen, Juliette's thirst trap marched up to a woman on the lake shore and took her into his arms for a little light tonsil hockey.

Juliette let out a quiet little moan, nuzzling into me a little closer on the couch, stroking my thigh.

We'd never really done this before. Even while we'd been married, we'd never watched TV and been motivated to start fooling around on the couch. But here we were, snuggling up, and as I began to caress her thigh, my innocent wife tugged my hand up to the warmth emanating from between her legs.

Her own hand soon found the bulge in my pants.

Quietly, we watched *Bridgerton* turn into softcore pornography while groping each other through our clothing. Man. I'd never paid much attention to *Bridgerton* before, even though we always watched it together. I'd spent most of the four seasons so far on my phone.

I think this was the first time I'd actually enjoyed the show.

I leaned down to kiss Juliette gently under the ear. Then I murmured, 'You think he's hot, huh?'

Again, it was just a brief few words, but it specifically hinted at my enjoyment of her lusting after another man. So it was an apparent reference to her now knowing my secret fantasy.

The corners of her mouth curled up in a smile, and she clamped her hand over mine, pressing my hand against her smoldering pussy.

And then she was actually unbuttoning the fly on her jeans to invite my hand inside her panties. Man, she was wet already. Was that only from lusting after Mr Bridgerton? Or was she thinking about what might happen when her ex-boyfriend visited the city again next week?

I gently pushed my hand through the damp little patch of gold fur between her thighs, and dipped a finger into her warm, oily slit. She

moaned louder, her body gently writhing beside me as I touched her there.

I thought she might get up and drag me to the bedroom any moment, but to my surprise didn't. Instead, she sat up and turned to unfasten my fly and pull my chinos down so that my cock could spring free.

She kissed me as her hand worked its way around my hardness, fingers squeezing my stiff shaft. Her lips were so sweet. I probably would have been perfectly happy just making out with her for a while. But she ducked down, taking my cock in her hot mouth, as though ravenously hungry for it.

I let out a long, low moan. It felt so good.

I put a hand gently on her head as though to encourage her, to show my appreciation. But after a while, I just sat back and watched her working my cock with her mouth magnificently.

It struck me that this didn't happen all that frequently. I mean, not just that we didn't usually have sex on the couch while watching Netflix — I couldn't remember when Juliette had last given me a good old-fashioned blow job.

It was one of those things that got curtailed in our usual quickies as we impatiently rushed into full penetration mode.

Sometimes, you just had to remember to slow down and not cut corners.

Juliette lay along the couch on her front, her head bouncing in my lap like she was bobbing for apples in a competitive event. I stroked her soft, golden hair, brushed it back out of her pretty face, and enjoyed her enthusiastic endeavor.

She was moaning as she sucked on my cock.

I was pretty taken aback at how much she seemed to be enjoying it — like she wasn't doing it just to please me, just to make me feel good. She wanted my hard cock in her mouth. It was turning her on to service me.

I wondered if she was thinking about Cory while she was playing with my dick. I wouldn't have minded if she was.

In fact, the longer it went on, and the more it seemed she wasn't just doing it to get me ready for full sex, I started to get the impression that

she might be practicing her skills to warm up for seeing Cory the following week.

The way she was taking as much of my dick into her mouth as possible, really stretching her lips around it — was she preparing herself to take a much larger cock in her mouth sometime soon?

I wasn't jealous thinking of the possibility. It tickled my kink. I liked the thought that she was preparing herself for another man.

'God, that feels so good,' I moaned, encouraging her with a gentle squeeze of her gorgeous ass through her sweatpants as she sucked on me.

She smiled at my praise and pushed herself up to briefly kiss my mouth in appreciation before returning to it. She was so beautiful. The sight of my obscene phallus stretching her pretty lips had that so-wrong-it's-right kind of thrill. I even could sit back and imagine she was sucking on another man's dick, and it tickled my kink even further.

After a while, she pulled off me and gazed up at me before asking me to kneel on the sofa facing her.

I was a little confused about what she wanted, but I did as she asked, and in that position, it seemed entirely logical to direct my cock toward her mouth again.

She stretched her lips around it, put her hands around my thighs, and pulled me to her. I slid my cock into her mouth, and she gave an encouraging moan. When she held her head still, it seemed to me she wanted me to do the moving.

I gently put a hand on her head and carefully thrust my cock into her mouth. She moaned some more, encouraging me, apparently enjoying what I was doing. So I slowly began a rhythm, thrusting into her mouth.

Fucking her face.

We'd never done it like this. Was this something Cory had liked to do with her?

I had to go carefully, and she needed lots of breaks, but then I was actually working up some real steam, and she was getting a surprising amount of my cock in her mouth — and in her throat.

It seemed plain to me that she'd done this before, even if she hadn't done this with me. It really turned me on to think of other guys jamming their hard dicks into my pretty wife's throat like this.

God, I had to be careful not to come, thinking about things like that.

After a while, I got the sense that she'd had enough and pulled back without unloading in her throat. She was smiling ear-to-ear as she pulled herself up to her knees, as though she was proud of herself. I was guessing she was pleased with her progress, practicing for next week's adultery.

She knelt up and kissed me, and I tasted my own cock on her lips. Well what was I going to do, insist she go clean her teeth?

Now it was my turn to work on her pants — unfastening the tie cord around her waist, which she'd managed to tie with a knot a sailor would have been proud of — once I had that down to her knees, she turned around and leaned over the back of the sofa waiting for me to remove her white cotton thong, too.

Then she went down on all fours, presenting herself for me. Boy, she was sexy as hell. Cory was going to love it next week.

Her heart-shaped ass was just phenomenal as I knelt between her shins and lined up to slide my cock into her soaking wet pussy.

Any normal husband might have accused her of fantasizing about the *Bridgerton* actors on our TV while we fucked for the first time in a long time on the couch like that. But I could see she wasn't looking at the TV. I hoped she was thinking about what was coming, about who she would be fucking next week.

It thrilled me no end that the thought of getting to sleep with another man had got her so horny this evening she wanted my cock right here on the couch.

I gripped her hips and plunged my hard cock into her superbly wet pussy, and she moaned loudly in response. I could tell she was enjoying how hard I was. Did she imagine it was because I knew — albeit from indirect sources — that she was going to have an affair. That she was going to make my secret fantasy real?

As I powered into her from behind, her body rocking away, she occasionally turned to look at me, flashing me such a sweet, bright, affectionate smile.

After a while, though, she could only put her head down and yell as I fucked her hard — harder than I could remember doing in ages.

We got so flushed and sweaty. It felt incredible. But before I blew my load, she stopped so we could change position. She lay on her side, let me spoon against her and slide back inside her soaking pussy. That felt so good. I could reach around and stroke her breasts and her clit while I thrust into her.

She changed position again — lying on her back, missionary style, only she put her legs up over my shoulder as I fucked her, her ankles rubbing up against my head as my cock drilled deep inside her.

She had me sit on the couch so she could ride me.

We didn't usually manage more than one position during sex. This was like she was going for the record. After a while, it seemed to me like she was practicing. She was in training for a sexual marathon.

I didn't mind being her training partner, I can tell you.

Another surprise came when it was pretty clear to both of us that I was about to blow like a whale coming to the surface of the ocean. Instead of continuing so that I could finish inside her, as might typically be the case for us, she consciously dismounted.

I had a clear question on my face as she knelt down on the floor in front of me and took my cock in her hands.

She smiled at me, amused at my confusion, then said, 'I want you to come in my mouth.'

Man, that was so sexy.

My cock was dripping wet from her pussy, but she took hold of my shaft with both hands and stretched her lips around the tip, before sinking down on it. It was so hot, the way she was looking up at me.

We'd never done this before. I mean, she'd sucked my cock before plenty of times. I'd come in her mouth before. But she'd never

specifically asked me to, and she'd never knelt down to suck my cock as though the main goal was to get me to shoot my cream down her throat.

It excited me that she wanted to try new things. It excited me that she wanted to change things about how we made love.

It excited me that she wanted to practice things with me in preparation for seeing another man.

The way she attacked my cock, I didn't last long at all. Then I was shivering and groaning and jerking as my orgasm exploded, and I started pumping come into her mouth.

She was smiling so brightly as I filled her mouth with my cream — and then even purposefully took my cock out of her mouth while I was still firing, so that some of it splashed all over her face.

That had her giggling, apparently delighted.

She wiped some of it off with her fingers, then licked her fingers like she'd just dipped them in sugar.

How did I end up with such a deliciously horny wife?

CHAPTER 12

JESSIE TEXTED me Tuesday morning to let me know that Cory had just checked into the Franklin Hotel and would be staying three nights.

‘Are you all right, man? Look like you’ve seen a ghost,’ one of my colleagues asked me as I sat there at my desk, staring at my phone.

‘Uh, yeah... it’s okay,’ I blustered, preparing myself to deploy a my-mother-is-sick kind of excuse if my colleague delved further.

Feeling suddenly like I had a fever coming on, I texted Jessie back asking if she had any further information — if she knew what Juliette had planned, whether my wife would be seeing him that evening, and so on.

I knew the Franklin — it was a three-star hotel about a 15-minute walk from our apartment on the Upper East Side. It was where my parents — the in-laws, too — generally stayed when they were in town visiting Juliette and me since it was only a couple blocks from the subway and not far from Central Park.

It was also relatively affordable for a New York hotel, though it would still cost Cory a few hundred bucks a night. I couldn’t see him wanting to become a regular resident there. If he got the job, he’d want to find a place of his own fairly quickly.

Jessie texted me back to tell me Juliette had said she was planning on meeting Cory for dinner that night, but probably not much more than

that.

I doubted whether Cory would be happy with just dinner, considering how much he was paying to stay in the city. Jessie pointed out that he had his interview the next day and would be wise to get an early night.

‘Tomorrow night,’ she said, ‘after the interview — that’s when they will really party.’

All day, I was trying to temper my expectations. That meant trying not to think about it most of the time I was at work.

Juliette didn’t text me until late afternoon — I’d started thinking she had reconsidered seeing Cory at all that evening, she was so late in texting — letting me know she was going out for drinks after work.

Within our relationship, ‘drinks after work’ was shorthand for either of us meeting with work colleagues, or sometimes clients, after 5pm. If we were going out with friends, we would usually tell each other who we were seeing. In this case, Jessie’s tip-off suggested that Juliette wasn’t being entirely truthful — but if you looked at the precise words she was using, I suppose she wasn’t technically lying to me.

By the time I was on my way home, it didn’t bother me too much. She’d let me know she would be late. She had reported in with Jessie so that, indirectly, I could enjoy knowing what was really going on. And now I just had to return home and wait — hoping that perhaps she would do something more than just have dinner with Cory, even if it was something minor.

Back at the apartment, I cooked myself some food and watched TV as I would any regular evening when Juliette was having drinks after work. I definitely felt tension, which wasn’t normal for such an evening, however. Yet, while I harbored a slight queasiness in my stomach, the underlying excitement never let up.

Past 9pm, I was constantly checking the time — willing my wife to stay out longer, as long as she could get away with. I felt sure that the longer she stayed out, the more chance there would be that something significant would happen with her ex.

When the clock passed 9.30, my heart was really thumping. I was really hopeful.

Then Jessie texted me:

She's on her way home.

I let out a long sigh filled with disappointment. Ah well — I had to look to the bright side; at least she would probably be seeing him again the next night.

Did they do anything?

It took ten minutes for her to come back with an answer.

She kissed him 🤔

Well, that's something. Peck on the cheek, or NSFW?

She said he wanted her to come up to his room, but she was worried about his interview in the morning. I think she's just playing it safe, not rushing things too much.

What did she say about the kiss?

It was outside his hotel. Kind of a kiss goodbye, but then they were properly making out.

So hot 😳

She said it felt really good because she felt free but also kind of sexy and naughty at the same time.

Sweet 😊

His hands were on her butt. And she said she could feel his cock pressing against her through their clothes.

I could tell Jessie was having a lot of fun with this, being the messenger in such an arrangement. She liked passing on the news. But personally, I found it difficult to discuss the dirty details with her. It made it more awkward and less satisfying than I'd hoped. It was one thing to share intimate knowledge with your partner, something different with her friend. Perhaps Juliette found it easier to open up with her — they were the closest of friends.

He was okay with just a kiss?

He asked her again to go up to the room with him, but I guess she walked away telling him she'll see him tomorrow. I guess he knows it's probably best, he has his interview and so on.

After that, I asked Jessie whether she was looking forward to her date with Brian on Friday, and she said she hadn't stopped thinking about it since the two of them had agreed to go out.

I've never been so nervous before a date!

Aww. You're worried you won't find him attractive?

I'm worried he won't find me interesting enough.

Are you kidding?

You have to tell me some things he likes talking about so I can read up.

Jessie, you'll be fine. He's a nice guy, he can talk about anything.

Bless.

Honestly, I was a little nervous for Brian. Poor guy had had his share of dating disappointment. Had Jessie's desire to date a guy with a cuckolding fetish pushed her into meeting someone she wouldn't find attractive? I mean, as I probably said, Brian wasn't bad-looking, but he didn't seem like Jessie's usual type exactly.

Anyway. I wasn't going to stop her from seeing him. She'd seen his face during that FaceTime call, so maybe she'd been telling the truth when she said she thought he was cute.

Meanwhile, my heart was pounding painfully as I waited for Juliette to return from her date.

Just thinking about it as a date made my hard-on throb like crazy. But what else would you call it?

Then, here she was, coming through the front door, saying 'hey'. Acting like she'd just had a very run-of-the-mill few drinks with people from work.

I was trying hard not to smile for no apparent reason, but I was feeling so positive, so excited about what was going on. Juliette looked like she was trying her best to keep calm, too.

‘Did you get something to eat? There’s some rice left in the pot,’ I said, as I would typically say when she got back from a few drinks after work.

She shrugged and gave me a grateful smile. ‘We ate,’ she said.

I could see her beautiful blue eyes flickering all over my face, trying to determine if I knew what she’d been up to, and whether I was okay with it. It struck me that perhaps she had limited her contact with Cory this evening purposefully to test my response to things happening with him.

After hanging her coat on the hook, she came to sit with me on the couch — as she would normally do on an evening like this. I cuddled up with her and pulled her in for a kiss. That wasn’t necessarily normal for this stage in the evening, but it wasn’t unheard of for us.

It was a really sweet, tender kiss. Juliette just kind of melted into it. It didn’t take long before I got the impression she realized I was okay with everything.

She was all smiley when we finally parted — so happy. It was wonderful to see.

‘I just need to change out of my work stuff,’ she said, hopping up from the couch.

I was trying to act casual, honestly.

But what can I say? My wife was in the bedroom stripping off, having just met another man for dinner. Even though she was home relatively early, and my inside source had said nothing happened with the other man except a kiss, I was horny like a horny toad from Hornsville.

So I happened to need something in the kitchen and just kinda strolled on by the half-open bedroom door while Juliette was changing.

In my defense, she had left the door half-open.

She was facing away from me as she removed her black pencil skirt. Sure, the thing covered her trim legs down to her shins — but she usually wore pants to work most days, so to me, that was a hint that she’d dressed specially for her date tonight.

The lace thong she revealed under her skirt was also a clear level of sexiness above the usual workday underwear choice.

I felt myself buzzing inside as she peeled off her panties, then began unfastening the buttons on her white shirt, giving me a sustained view of her gorgeous bare ass while she did so.

Deep down, I guess I trusted my inside source that Juliette had only made out with Cory tonight. But she had to be thinking of what she might get up to with him the next night.

As I watched the shirt slip off her shoulders, and then fall to the ground, my heart was fluttering and my cock was swelling.

I almost failed to notice she hadn't been wearing a bra. Man. She must have really been teasing him with her stiff nipples pressing against her shirt all through dinner. Poor guy. Still, he'd get to have her soon.

She turned to sit on the edge of the bed to put on a bra now — I guess because she usually wore a bra most of the time around the apartment. And now I saw her full frontal, I had to stifle a gasp.

She'd shaved her pussy.

God. It was completely hairless. She sat down and I could see the top of her slit between her thighs — but not a hint of her usual small triangular patch of golden fur.

She'd never done that while I'd been with her. It was far too much of a coincidence that the first occasion she'd chosen to forego pubic hair since we'd started dating was the week she was planning on sleeping with her ex-boyfriend again.

I was astonished.

And hard as steel. She had shaved her pussy for another man to enjoy. There was something incredibly erotic about that.

Man. I mean, I'd always enjoyed her golden fuzz down there. It wasn't ever untidy, and she trimmed it back during bikini season. But this was quite something to behold. It made her look a little different, now she was naked.

I watched her putting on her bra and just stared, without even remembering to look casual so I could rely on my cover story of needing something from the kitchen if she caught me glancing through the doorway at her.

I just gawped.

With a bra on, she stood up again, somehow failing to look up, failing to see me there in front of the doorway. She turned her back toward me again as though teasing me. I suspected she already knew I was there, but hey. If a husband can't ogle his gorgeous wife...

She picked up a pair of panties from the usual drawer of her dresser and then went to sit on the bed to put them on. Pastel pink, matching her bra.

As she lifted a knee to dip her foot through one of the leg holes, she seemed to purposefully part her thighs so that I could see her completely hair-free pussy in almost all of its glory. It took my breath away.

And that was the moment she glanced up and saw me staring.

‘Uh — !’

At first, she stood up quickly, tugging up her panties the rest of the way, pretending to look mildly outraged that some dirty old man had been ogling her.

‘Are you spying on me?’ she said sharply, her brow furrowed.

But as she stood up straight and brushed her hair back over her shoulders with a hand, she was clearly flaunting herself at me — and within half a moment, a wry smile was beginning to break out on her pretty face.

‘I think it's more like peeping,’ I said, owning my transgression. ‘I mean, I don't suspect you of secretly being a Soviet citizen, if that's what you're worried about.’

She stepped toward me slowly, apparently delighted I was openly admiring her in her underwear.

‘You're a Peeping Tom?’ She put her hands on her hips, judging me and doing her best to keep from smiling.

‘I'm a peeping Nick.’

‘You're a pervert.’ She folded her arms.

I folded my arms. ‘Can a husband be called a pervert for admiring his wife's newly shaven — ’

I said that word, and I didn't need to add the 'p' word because from the feigned surprise suddenly lifting her eyebrows, I guess she knew exactly what I was referring to. She caught her breath as I uttered the word.

'What are you talking about?' she said with put-upon innocence, nevertheless.

I folded my arms. 'Take them off,' I said, my eyes flicking down to her panties.

My tone was unusually stern for me. She flashed her eyes. Usually, I wouldn't order my wife around. But this felt good. And there was a flash of something that looked uncannily like excitement in her big, blue eyes as I made my demand.

'You are a pervert,' she muttered, but her hands moved to the waistband of her panties, preparing to remove them.

'Take them off,' I said, having another go at being mildly dominant.

Pouting like a semi-rebellious teenager, she slipped the panties slowly off her hips, gradually revealing more and more of her pale flesh. Where I might have ordinarily expected her little bush to be exposed, there was only more bare, smooth skin.

'I wasn't imagining it,' I said as her panties dropped to the floor, leaving her standing there in all her glory.

'What?' she said. 'I felt like a change.'

'Lie down, let me see,' I said, sticking with my authoritarian tone.

She concealed her excitement at this newly assertive husband, and meekly did as she was told, climbing onto the bed, presenting herself. I took my time running my eyes all over her, like I was merely some professional physician examining a patient rather than a horny husband.

'You like it?' she asked me.

'I do,' I nodded, and moved onto the bed, depositing myself between her thighs as though I needed a much closer view for the purposes of science.

'You like it better like this?'

I leaned in. I could detect the scent of her arousal. She must have been at least a little turned on all through dinner with Cory. Thinking about having an affair with him.

I ran my tongue lightly along her pussy lips, from bottom to top, tasting the hint of tangy juices on her hot flesh.

‘I’m not sure about liking it better,’ I said. ‘I liked your fuzz. But it is probably easier... you know...’

I sucked on her pussy lips as though to indicate what I meant. She lay back and moaned.

‘Mmm... that’s so nice...’ she said softly, then added, ‘I used to have it this way before I graduated college...’

The subtext I got from her explanation was that this was how it had been for Cory. And now that she was going to have an affair with him, she wanted it how he liked it best.

The thought stirred my kink.

I put my hands on her inner thighs and buried my face in her hairless snatch, lapping away as she soon became wetter and wetter. I don’t know if it was easier. I didn’t have to stop to pick hairs out of my teeth. It was different. There was some thrill in that. I gazed up her divine form and got a glimpse of her that must have been more how she looked in college, and that was a hot thought.

This was how the guys at college saw her.

She laughed. I realized that I’d uttered my thought aloud.

‘I guess they did...’ she said, breaking into a broad smile.

I moaned as I devoured her a little more vigorously, as though telling her how much it turned me on to think of the guys sleeping with her at college. Her smile only broadened, and her moans deepened.

‘You don’t want me to talk about guys I fucked in college...’ she said, teasing me as I slurped on her juices.

But the way she wiggled her hips as I ate her, grinding her sex against my face, betrayed her desire to talk about exactly that.

I said, 'Sure I do.'

She grinned. 'You're so dirty.'

I slid a couple of fingers inside her slick pussy as I gently kissed her clit.

'The guys in college must've liked this,' I murmured. She seemed to like the vibration of my deep voice on her sensitive clit.

'Mmm...' she said. 'I guess so.'

'How many guys did you fuck in college?'

It was a question I'd never asked her. Of course I hadn't. But I'd formed an idea of maybe five or six, given how attractive she was — balanced with how ambitious she'd been to get good grades.

But now she said, 'I don't know, I never counted.'

'So count.'

She giggled. But then she did seem to be thinking about it. I gently massaged her G-spot deep inside her as though to motivate her.

'I guess... at least ten. Probably no more than twenty,' she said, blowing my estimate out of the water.

I sucked in my breath. 'That many?'

'I wasn't with a new guy every week, if that's what you mean.'

'Every month?'

'No!'

I did the mental calculations. Three years of college — at the lowest estimate, she was with a new guy on average every three or four months.

'Lot of broken hearts,' I said somberly. Then I added, a little more brightly, 'You must have had your pick of the hot guys?'

She pushed herself up on her elbows. 'Most husbands don't like to think about their wives banging other dudes at college,' she grinned, teasing me but gazing down at me adoringly.

'I'm not most husbands,' I said.

She urged me up, and started pulling off my clothes, saying, ‘No, you’re definitely not most husbands.’

She seemed desperate to get me naked, fighting to rid me of my clothes, rushing to get me lying down on my back, my hard cock in her hands — and then in her mouth.

I wanted to ask her more about the guys she was with in college, but she was so forceful sucking my cock — and it felt so good — I couldn’t manage to talk. I just lay there appreciating how much she suddenly seemed to enjoy giving me head.

If it had been a typical night, I would have expected her to only go down on me for a few minutes, until she knew I was hard enough for full penetrative sex. But we’d gone way past normal.

I was hard as hard could be before she’d even gotten my clothes off. And tonight, she wasn’t going to take her mouth off my cock until I was done shooting off down her throat.

The way she was moaning... she wanted to swallow my come.

Her eagerness was so hot. I knew it was ego, but it was sexy that she wanted me so badly. That she wasn’t going to slow down when she suspected I was in danger of tipping over into orgasm. She enjoyed the feel of my cock in her mouth, she rolled it around inside her cheeks, she swirled her tongue around my tip.

She worked me until she was red in the face.

Then as I moaned with the kind of warning tone I hadn’t used in a long while — the kind that urged her to climb aboard if she wanted this dick inside her before my full conclusion was reached — she just gave a little moan of delight, and kept on sucking me.

She swallowed every drop of my come, and then eagerly cleaned up any spillage on my cock once the storm had subsided.

It only struck me as I was drifting off to sleep with her that she had sucked my cock so that her pussy could have a break before her date with Cory the next night.

She’d been saving herself for another man.

CHAPTER 13

JULIETTE WAS UP EARLY that morning — so early that I awoke to an empty bed. Ah well. It was the kind of thing she did when she had a lot of work on at the moment, or if she had some sort of appointment in the evening that would prevent her from staying until her customary 7pm departure.

I stretched out and took a pleasurable deep breath, feeling sure she had gone to work early to spend more time in the evening with her ex-boyfriend.

My wife was going to cheat on me that night.

I was excited.

For a moment, I just lay there and luxuriated in the strange joy-fear cocktail of anxious feelings that seemed a constant side effect of this peculiar kink of mine. My wife was going to have sex with another man that night. She was going to cuckold me.

I was hard, but I fought the temptation to mess with it. I wanted to save myself as long as possible — I wanted to save myself for when Juliette got home after her hot date.

When I stopped moving, I heard a sound that made me realize Juliette was still there. She hadn't entirely made it out yet. I froze, trying to figure out what she was doing — I wasn't hearing her getting dressed.

She was ferreting about in the bottom of the closet. It sounded like she was trying to hunt for some shoes she hadn't worn for ages, that had gotten buried by the other countless pairs in her collection, but she was pretty conspicuously trying not to make any noise doing so.

This seemed most unlike her for a couple of reasons that sprang to mind. Firstly, Juliette was usually highly organized regarding things like getting ready for work. She invariably had her clothes hanging in precisely the right place in the closet, ready for her to slip into in the morning — including her shoes.

Secondly, why would she be sneaking around in the bottom of the closet like that? She knew I'd wake up any moment anyway so I could get to work on time. It wouldn't matter to me if she woke me up right now.

I don't know. Maybe my paranoia was latching onto something that appeared to break the routine of the typical working day because today was not a typical working day.

Today was the day my wife was going to be unfaithful.

Sure, she basically had my permission to do so, so you might not interpret it as infidelity. But it still felt pretty dramatic to me.

Anyway. I decided to pretend to be still asleep and let her do whatever she was trying to do. I guess the fact she was trying to do it in secret was what raised my suspicions the most.

I heard her rustling some kind of paper bag, trying to keep as quiet as possible but thwarted by the stiff paper of the bag. Then I heard her stand up and walk over to the dresser. I recognized the sound of her opening the catch on her purse.

Something secret she was putting in her purse.

Well, now my paranoid heart was quickening.

Once she was done, she gave a little sigh of relief that did nothing to quell my suspicions. I waited an additional moment or two and then stretched and yawned audibly, pretending that now was the usual time I would wake up for the day.

I did want to say goodbye to her before she scurried off for her big day, after all.

‘Hey,’ I said, opening my eyes sleepily and keeping up the act as I sat up. ‘Heading to work early?’

She smiled. She looked gorgeous, of course. ‘Early meeting,’ she said. ‘I have to prepare for it.’

She always looked gorgeous when she was all ready to go to work, but today, she looked extra fine. Her approaching date had given me special superpowers that made me particularly attracted to her.

‘Hate early meetings,’ I said, offering her a sympathetic smile.

She gave a little nod, then leaned over the bed to give me a little peck on the cheek in farewell, as she would often do if she really did have an early meeting and had to shoot while I was still getting up.

I didn’t push for more than a peck on the cheek, but I did enjoy inhaling her perfume as she touched her lips gently to my face.

‘Oh, and... uh... is it okay if I go dancing tonight?’ she asked nervously while she kissed me.

‘Of course,’ I said, fireworks going off inside me.

She didn’t usually ask me for permission to go dancing. Ordinarily, if she was planning on a big night out with Becky and Co., or even her friends from college, and she knew it might involve a nightclub at the end of the night, she would just tell me she was going out clubbing with her friends.

And she would tell me who she was going out with.

This morning, she didn’t tell me who she was going out with. I assumed she was trying not to lie to me.

She said, ‘Great,’ and smiled sweetly as she withdrew from me, seemingly leaving it at that.

God, she looked good. Was I really going to let her walk out of there and into someone else’s bed?

‘I love it when you go dancing,’ I said. I didn’t really mean to say it; the words just seemed to fall out of my mouth, half-expressing one of the thoughts racing around my brain.

But Juliette smiled as though what I said greatly relieved her concerns.

‘Even though I’m not taking you with me?’ she said.

It felt like we were engineering ‘dancing’ to be some kind of code to represent what was really going on tonight. It made my pulse quicken, my hard-on throb under the bedsheet.

‘You know how I am with dancing,’ I said, as though merely referring to my lack of coordination on the dance floor — and general lack of interest in swaying in time to trashy music in the middle of a sweat lodge where the drinks were three times more expensive than they should be.

But then I added, ‘But it makes me happy that you can go and enjoy it.’

Another sweet smile from my beautiful bride. It felt like she was taking the subtext of what I was saying, and it was making her feel a little giddy with excitement, along with the relief at the reassurance I was giving her that this was what I wanted.

At the same time, she was trying not to act calm and not give away her full emotions.

She said, ‘I love you. You know that?’

It might have been nothing more significant than a wife telling her husband she loved him shortly before heading off for work in the morning. But Juliette didn’t usually declare her love for me just because she was leaving for the office.

There was a real power in how she said it to me.

I said, ‘Of course. I love you, too.’

She paused, making sure I knew she heard me, and she took in what I said. Then she blew me another kiss and said, ‘I’d better run.’

Boy. It felt so monumental when she walked out that door. And yet, I knew she had a whole working day to get through before she would go out on her date with Cory.

I lay there for a long while, getting to grips with the emotions rushing through my body.

Eventually, I picked myself up — literally and figuratively. But before heading into the bathroom to get ready for my working day, I paused to take a quick look in the bottom of the closet, right about where I believe I'd heard Juliette searching for something.

There at the back, in the darkest corner, hidden by a pile of uncharacteristically disordered shoes, was a shopping bag. It was white with a logo that looked like a crystal with two points at the top. The words 'Darkest Fox' were underneath the logo.

A quick Google on my phone led me to the website of a luxurious-looking lingerie store in the Rockefeller Center.

Wow. I was shaking a little. Had Juliette bought some special lingerie to wear for her date? The bag was empty — except for a receipt. Breathless with excitement, I saw that she had spent five hundred bucks on underwear that was not in this bag anymore.

I could find the exact items she'd bought on the Darkest Fox website.

I sat there on the floor of our bedroom, gawping at an image that basically showed me what my wife would be wearing when another man peeled off her outer clothes before fucking her that night. Man, it had been a long time since I'd been this hard simply staring at a lingerie model.

Was she wearing this stuff right now, under her office attire? I figured not. From the sounds, I had heard her taking the lingerie out of this bag and slipping it into her purse. She would no doubt change into it after work.

Okay. I had to calm down. It felt like somebody was playing the kettle drums inside my chest.

It was going to be a long, long day if I didn't manage to distract myself from Juliette's approaching date.

I had a busy day at work — or maybe I made myself have a busy day at work. Ordinarily, I'm like most other workers, despite being a lawyer —

I don't want to work harder than I need to. But on this particular day, I was a machine.

Toward the end of the afternoon, my boss even wandered over and asked whether I was trying to steal his job or something.

I told him no, it was just that I needed to get out promptly at 5pm for an appointment, so I had to get what I needed done early. It was enough to explain my ridiculous productivity. Anyway. I couldn't see it becoming a frequent thing, even if Juliette started dating other guys frequently.

At 5pm, I left the building.

On the way home, I felt a strange light-headed giddiness. It was excitement, sure, but there was a tremendous amount of trepidation. No small amount of pure fear. When I'd been reading about this subject on the Internet, I guess people didn't seem to tell you how much you would second-guess yourself when you did this. Was I insane for wanting this? Had I rushed into everything without enough due diligence?

I felt oddly isolated on my way home. Though this was my usual commute, hopping on the subway up to the Upper East Side, today I felt like I was moving through some kind of parallel dimension. I'd stepped out of normal existence.

Walking back to the apartment, I felt the shadows closing around me, the night pressing in on me.

What was Juliette doing right now?

Was she with him already? Were they going to actually go out on a proper date, have dinner, go dancing — or were they just going to meet at his hotel for a night of pure carnal release?

I was trembling a little by the time I reached our apartment building. The cold night was helping the fear to get to me.

I felt slightly nauseous while riding the elevator up to our floor. Had I made a huge mistake in all this? Was I an absolute idiot to let her test out this whole fantasy by sleeping with her first-ever boyfriend? The guy she probably still had feelings for.

My desperation to explore my darkest desires had led me to take too much risk, to cut too many corners, to give up too much ground. Was I

going to lose my beautiful wife?

I couldn't help but think of my friend Brian — what he had been through.

Brian had married four women, and only one of those marriages had ended through no fault of his own.

Brian should have been more of a cautionary tale for me — but I'd taken his continued desire to find a woman to share as some kind of motivation. If he still wanted it, after everything he'd been through, it had to be an incredible thing, right? But you could say the same about heroin. Or cocaine. Or countless other addictions.

Did I have an addiction problem in the making?

Back home, I tried to keep calm and behave as I usually would when Juliette was out with her friends without me. Fixed some food, watched some TV.

I went into the bedroom to change into my PJs and stepped on something weirdly cold by the bed.

Oh, God.

It was a used condom.

What in God's name was it doing here?

Oh man, I couldn't breathe. My legs turned to jelly under me, I slumped down on the bed. My wife had cheated on me. Properly cheated on me. I had no idea when it had happened, but it must have. She'd brought him here, to our apartment. To our marital bed.

Jessie hadn't said a word about any of this to me.

I stayed on the bed for a while, just lying there, my heart pounding.

I had to get my thoughts under control; I had to tame the hormones flooding my system. I had to get a handle on these emotions rushing around.

I had wanted her to do this. I had basically told Jessie it was okay if Juliette wanted to cheat on me; I just wanted to know any information if she managed to get it from my unfaithful wife.

On this occasion, her cheating had just been so hidden that I hadn't known it had happened. It must have been the day before — perhaps Juliette had taken an extended lunch break, and had met Cory here right after his interview. Why hadn't they gone to his hotel if they wanted a quickie?

Had she done it here on purpose, to stick it to me?

God. I was still holding the condom. There was no doubt it had been used for the purpose for which it had been designed. The thing had been tied like a balloon, and there was a spoonful or so of white liquid inside. So weird. This was another man's come. This thing had been inside my wife when he had unloaded.

I just stared at it for a while, trying to cope.

It took me a few moments to realize how hard my cock was. To recognize the feelings of arousal that were buzzing around my system, obscured by the shock and revulsion.

I texted Jessie.

Did Juliette bring Cory back to our apartment yesterday at some point? I just found a used condom on the bedroom floor. Juliette and I don't use them.

I flushed the condom — despite the strange thrill from its confirmation that Juliette had recently slept with another guy, it was still making me feel a little queasy.

Once that was done, I sat on the bed and just breathed for a few moments, as though meditating.

I figured I would have to deal with strong feelings like these a lot if we kept doing this. This fantasy of mine required some risk-taking and no small amount of loss of control. I was giving up exclusivity in access to my wife's sex.

My phone buzzed, and I grabbed it, hoping Jessie would give me some reassuring news — though I wasn't sure how she could reassure me.

It wasn't Jessie, though. It was Brian asking how I was, and suggesting it might be better for my mental wellbeing on this particular evening if I wasn't on my own.

Brian: You want to go grab a beer or something? I don't mind coming over to your neighborhood if it's easier.

I felt an odd sense of relief. I probably did need somebody to talk to right now.

I met him at an Irish pub not too far away from my apartment.

'How you feeling?'

'Pretty awful,' I said, attempting a self-deprecating smile.

He nodded. 'Nervous?'

I sighed, hinting that it was more than nerves because my wife was on a date. I said, 'When I was up in our apartment just now, I found a condom on the bedroom floor.'

'Condom?' Brian raised his eyebrows. 'Still in the packet?'

'No, very much not still in the packet.'

'So I take it — ?'

Another sigh. 'She must have... I don't know... met him for lunch yesterday, after his interview. Gone back to the apartment with him.'

'If she took the whole afternoon off, would you know about it?' he asked.

I shrugged, shook my head. 'Not unless she told me about it. I mean, we work in the same company, but we're in different teams. Different places. I can't just download her schedule from the intranet.'

Brian stopped himself from continuing while two pints of beer were placed in front of us, and we both took samples — mine somewhat massive in size. Man, it tasted refreshing. I felt like I'd never needed a beer more — my body clearly crying out for something to help cushion my emotions.

‘Did Jessie say anything about any of this?’ Brian asked me when the coast was clear.

‘Nothing at all. I’ve texted her, but she hasn’t gotten back to me yet.’

Brian nodded. ‘She’s probably been busy...’

I gave him a little questioning glance at that. His tone suggested insider knowledge.

But Brian deflected with a change of subject, ‘I guess if you look at things from Juliette’s perspective... you know, all this is pretty exciting for her. She’s like an unsupervised kid trapped in a candy store. She’s probably grabbing everything she can get, as quickly as she can get it. She’s not trying to hurt you...’

‘I suppose she is under the impression I’m in favor of her cheating.’

‘Yeah. So that’s what she did. Of course, you got Jessie involved — you figured Juliette would tell her everything, since she usually does, and you’d be able to find out through Jessie.’

‘I guess she didn’t tell Jessie about this one.’

‘No,’ Brian took a contemplative sip of his beer. ‘But this little arrangement you’ve got going... Jessie has told Juliette that if she goes out with Cory, she should check in with her to make sure she’s safe.’

‘Yeah, that was the deal.’

‘But the time they were in your apartment, Juliette wasn’t going out anywhere. There was no question about her safety — she knows Cory, she trusts him, that’s one big selling point in her going with him. She may not have felt she needed to check in with Jessie because she was at her own apartment. Safe and sound.’

I frowned. ‘I feel like I’ve been lawyered. And I’m supposed to be a lawyer, too.’

Brian smiled. ‘It’s a loophole, I guess. But this is what you wanted, right? Ultimately? Your wife, enjoying herself with another guy.’

Brian spoke from experience. I could tell he knew how I felt.

I nodded glumly. 'I guess it's just... you know... the cheating thing. It feels so harsh when it happens.'

It was at this moment that my phone rang. I half-feared it would be Juliette, telling me she'd decided she wanted Cory too much after all, and now wanted a divorce.

But it was Jessie, responding to my text.

'Are you okay? God, those two.'

'Did she say anything to you — ?'

'No, she didn't tell me anything about seeing him yesterday, other than that quiet dinner in the evening...'

Hmm, now I was wondering whether Juliette had only had a quiet dinner with Cory the previous evening as she'd told Jessie. Or if they'd done something else at Cory's hotel.

'Are you at home?' Jessie said suddenly. 'You shouldn't be on your own. I'm on my way.'

Well, it felt good to be in demand, but since I was with Brian, I figured I didn't need to waste Jessie's time.

I said, 'Uh, no, Jess... 'm at the Trinity. But I'm not on my own — Brian's here, too.'

'Brian?' she said and paused for a moment. Then she yelled out, 'Hi, Brian!' to the man she would be seeing anyway the next night, on their first date.

'Hi Jessie!' Brian yelled back.

I assumed Jessie would feel suitably happy that I was not going to be on my own that evening, and decide she would head home. But Jessie said, 'You guys order me a tonic and gin, and I will be there before the sun goes down.'

'Jess, the sun went down before five.'

'Well... it'll go down again, won't it? And I'll be with you before that. Way before. Ten minutes.'

She was crazy as a bag of cats, that one. Our phone call was cut short when she hopped onto her subway train, and then fifteen minutes later, there she was, wandering into our pub with a massive smile on her face.

‘Hey, Brian,’ she said, gazing at him adoringly as she took a seat between us.

‘Hey, Jess.’

I couldn’t help but chuckle at this. ‘You guys haven’t even been on your first date yet.’

‘Brian and I have been texting,’ Jessie said in a furtive, conspiratorial tone as if the two of them had been carrying on some kind of scandalous affair.

Then she said to me, ‘You know he ran into one of his ex-wives the other day, and she has kids now?’

I looked at Brian. He gave a little shrug. ‘Katie,’ he told me. ‘Wife number two. I bumped into her in Starbucks.’

‘How many kids does she have?’

‘Two. It’s okay. I’m pleased she seemed so happy. You know, she was the one who first told me I might have a cuckolding fantasy.’

‘She did?’

‘She was telling me about this guy hitting on her at work, and instead of getting jealous about it, it kind of interested me.’ He said it as though he was aware talking about getting turned on by another woman would be a faux pas in front of the woman he was about to go on a first date with.

But Jessie said, ‘You mean it turned you on?’ as though she knew he was trying to be kind to her, and preferred to know the truth.

‘I guess wives can tell that kind of thing,’ he said.

‘That guy who was hitting on her — he was the one she ended up with?’

‘She didn’t mean to. She was very apologetic about it all, but she just wanted to see him more and more, and he didn’t want her to see me anymore, so...’

Jessie seemed to be completely fascinated by Brian. She said, ‘I can’t believe she would give up the chance to sleep with whoever she liked so she could have kids...’

Brian smiled. ‘I don’t think they were planning on having kids.’

I said, ‘What happened to your other wives? I mean, if you don’t mind telling us — ‘

Brian glanced at Jessie, who just seemed besotted with him — I was kind of surprised by her level of interest, but it was the sweetest thing I ever saw.

Then he said, ‘Well, after Katie, there was Marsha... and for a while, I didn’t tell her about my secret fantasy. She wasn’t the type, and everything. Eventually... she kind of stumbled on some video clips on my computer...’

Jessie giggled. ‘You had cuckold porn on your computer?’

Brian said, ‘Marsha and I waited until we were married to have sex, and then after we were married, it turned out she wasn’t really in favor of post-marital sex, either...’

Jessie shifted, so she sat much closer to him and said, ‘You don’t need to worry about that as far as I’m concerned.’

He laughed, ‘Sounds good...’

She said, ‘You know, I have cuckold porn on my computer. Ever since you told me about it, anyway, Bri...’

Brian’s eyes flashed. I could see in his face he couldn’t quite believe that this beautiful blonde was interested in him or his secret fantasy.

I asked him, ‘I take it Marsha didn’t support the idea of you... having this particular sexual fantasy?’

‘She ran for the hills,’ Brian said. ‘Figuratively and literally. I think she’s in Colorado these days. Aspen. I don’t know. Her family has money.’

‘What happened to wife number four?’ I asked.

‘Helena,’ he said. ‘I met her through work. I thought she was less uptight than Marsha. I don’t know. I don’t think we were right from the start.’

Eventually, I told her about my fantasy, thinking it would help rekindle things between us. She just ended up doing stuff behind my back. We didn't have any chemistry, so. I don't really blame her.'

I couldn't help but be impressed with Brian. He'd been through so much shit, and he just picked himself up and carried on. And he was still searching for Ms Right, fully hoping to share his kink with her.

Speaking of, Jessie was now snuggling up with him on the bench seat. 'I don't think we're going to have chemistry problems,' she said.

From my perspective, I had to agree with her. The air around Jessie and Brian seemed electric with chemistry, if that isn't too much metaphor-mixing.

'We probably have to test it out first,' Brian told her. He seemed to be attempting some kind of caution, though he was clearly super attracted to the pretty blonde.

'We can test it out as much as you like,' she answered him suggestively.

Brian said, 'For this to work, we have to be fairly sure... you know... that we're together... that you're mine, first and foremost...'

'Oh God, I am totally yours,' Jessie purred. 'You know what the best thing is for establishing trust in couples? Sex.'

Man, look at Brian's face. For that matter, look at Jessie's. I couldn't ever remember her being so taken with a guy before. Not like this, before they'd even had their first date.

It looked like Jessie was going to drag him away to her bed any moment — and Brian looked like he'd just won the lottery.

But before they left to get a head start on their first date, I needed his advice.

'You think I should talk to Juliette about... you know... the cheating...?'

Brian said, 'When I was with Katie... it started out okay. She told me everything. Then, you know... she would forget to tell me she was seeing him. And it would feel like I was no longer a priority to her. And then she kind of stopped telling me anything, unless I specifically asked. But I felt guilty about prying... and then... I guess it was like we weren't even married anymore.'

‘Man. I’m so sorry.’

‘It happens. I think I was wrong to let her do things behind my back.’

I nodded, took a deep breath, figuring an awkward conversation with Juliette was on the way. I said, ‘I feel like I’m some kind of time-traveler listening to you, Brian.’

‘Time-traveler?’

‘I feel like what happened to you could happen to me someday. I look at you, and... well, it’s like you’re the Ghost of Christmas Future, warning me about what could still come to pass...’

‘Hmm. You’re saying I’m *creepy*?’ he laughed, and made Jessie laugh, too. Then he added, a touch more seriously, ‘There’s still time to change your future, Nick.’

I took his message to heart. There was a moment where we all just kind of stopped and thought about it.

Then Jessie said, ‘I promise to tell you everything, Bri. If another guy so much as flirts with me, I’ll let you know. I promise.’

‘Sounds good to me,’ he said, as cheerful as I’d ever seen him.

Then Jessie was like, ‘So you think you’ll be okay, Nick...?’

I could tell what she was doing.

‘I’m sure I’ll be fine,’ I assured her.

‘Good, ’cause we’ve got chemistry to work on,’ she said, rising to her feet, pulling a somewhat dazzled Brian along with her toward the exit.

CHAPTER 14

I WAS SO happy for how much fun Brian and Jessie seemed to be having together, even when they'd only just met.

But I went home to my apartment alone, and it wasn't exactly easy waiting for Juliette.

I couldn't concentrate on anything — I couldn't watch TV, I couldn't scroll through YouTube, I sure couldn't do anything as demanding as read or work.

All I could think about was how Juliette had hidden the truth from me about seeing Cory. I was still in two minds about it all — desperately turned on by the sex itself, by her wickedness, by her promiscuity, but also sickened by the deception part of it.

I was surprised by how hard it hit me. It wasn't the fact that she was seeing him tonight, that at that very moment, she was probably fucking him. Even though she had no intention of telling me any of the details, she might slip some information on Jessie later, but I'd seen that she might just keep it all a secret.

She had to know that I wanted to know all the details. She could tell it turned me on. Why was she denying me that pleasure?

I felt manipulated. I was letting my wife cheat on me, and it was all my fault.

The worst part of it had been finding that condom. Discovering the existence of cheating, I had absolutely no clue what had taken place.

That made me feel like throwing up. I was an idiot. I shouldn't have let her get into this strange arrangement. As nice as it was to have support from Jessie, I felt such a lack of control in my own marriage.

Brian had been right. I needed to do something. I didn't need to take this.

She was out for hours. It only made my mood worse. I left the apartment, went for a walk.

I toured the neighborhood — even walked by The Franklin, wondering if I might glance up at the windows and see my pretty wife being fucked up against the glass. But — blessing or not — all the curtains in the windows were closed as far as I could see.

The fresh air helped calm me down a little. The anger didn't recede.

When I got home, I started considering calling her. Ordering her to come back.

I even picked up the phone, ready to dial.

Damn it.

Was I going to ruin everything? If I was angry with her, she'd never want to do anything like this again. Maybe she'd get angry at me, too, because I'd given her the idea I was all in favor of her infidelity, even if it took the form of secret liaisons.

I sat on the couch and debated it over and over in my head.

It started to feel like a binary choice: did I let Juliette pursue this old flame of hers, and enjoy something of the excitement that her infidelity provoked in me, or did I put my foot down and save my marriage?

I know my paranoia was fueling my fears, and the solitude didn't help.

God, why couldn't she just do as other hotwives did and go out for a simple date with her husband's blessing, then come home afterward and share all the details?

Why did she have to complicate matters by demanding all this secrecy?

Cory Fallon was the issue, I knew. He didn't want to share her. In fact, his agenda was to take her from me. I felt sure I shouldn't just give in to his demands.

Why should my wife lie to me in order to avoid lying to him?

It was 3am when she finally walked through that door.

I was livid by then. I hadn't slept a wink. My thoughts had gone completely out of control.

And yet, here she was, smartly dressed from her night out, but somewhat disheveled from obviously having had sex. The mere sight of her like that gave me the most brutal hard-on I'd ever had.

'Where've you been?'

'I'm sorry, honey...' she said, startled.

I got the feeling she'd expected me to be fast asleep by now. That she'd just sneak in, creep through into the bathroom, and take a shower before slipping into bed unnoticed. That I'd wake up in the morning, and we would continue the pretense that I didn't know she'd been fucking another guy behind my back, and neither of us would say anything to each other about it.

That seemed unacceptable to me.

'You cheated on me.'

The accusation sounded sharper, angrier than I'd meant.

Her face went ashen, her jaw dropped. I don't think she'd expected me to change my mind about all this. Perhaps she'd believed we would continue this little game for a while longer, until at least Cory was settled in the city with his own apartment.

'Honey, I went dancing...' she started to say, and I got the impression she thought I was still playing the game. That I was testing her resolve to keep the affair secret from me.

‘You don’t need to lie to me,’ I said. ‘The club you and Becky and the others go to — it closes at two.’

‘I was — ’ she said, searching for an excuse.

I said sternly, ‘Take off your dress.’

There was a moment where she hesitated, and I felt the strong sense that we were at a fork in the road, here. Things could go either way. Juliette could tell me to go to hell, she could be furious at me for treating her this way — for pussyfooting around with Jessie, making her believe she had a free pass to do whatever she wanted with Cory before changing my mind. Or she could do as I told her — and for the first time in our marriage, behave genuinely submissively toward me.

I held my breath.

She gazed into my eyes, astonished at where I had taken this.

Then she quietly peeled off her dress, exposing her very fancy bra, and the rest of her expensive lingerie, before allowing the dress to drop to the floor leaving her standing there in seriously sexy stockings and a thong that matched her bra.

‘This is how you dress to go dancing, is it?’ I asked her.

‘I wore it for you,’ she said meekly, just standing there as I stared at her.

‘I told you not to lie to me.’

She was shivering a little. It was the first time I think I ever saw her truly afraid.

I said, ‘I found a condom in here earlier. So I’m guessing you’ve slept with him more than just tonight.’

My tone was more disappointed than angry by now. But the effect seemed just as potent on her. I could see a flash of surprise and horror in her eyes when I mentioned the condom. She hadn’t wanted me to know about that particular occasion.

‘Jessie said she was sure you’d be okay with it,’ she said. ‘She said you just wanted me to have fun.’

I stepped around her, checking her out as though this was some military parade, and I was a senior officer inspecting her. God, she was beautiful. Just breathtaking. It wasn't just the sexy lingerie. Everything about her screamed out that she'd just had sex. A lot of sex. The disheveled hair, the clammy skin, her flushed cheeks and chest. The unmistakable aroma rising from her body.

'What happened tonight?' I asked her. 'You had dinner with him?'

'Yes.'

'Where?'

'The diner.'

I touched her ass. She flinched slightly but stood her ground.

'Then what, you went straight back to his hotel?'

'We bought some Champagne first, to celebrate his interview.'

'Then you fucked him?'

There was a long pause. Then, eventually, she said, 'Yes.'

Oh God, I trembled. My legs felt like jelly — but I had to stand firm.

'How many times?'

'I... I don't know...'

I leaned in to inhale that strange scent from her neck. The blend of sweat, perfume, cologne, and sex. Who knew it would be such a turn-on? I wondered if there was any truth in what they said about pheromones.

She quivered as I gave in to temptation and kissed her lightly on the neck, tasting the subtle salty flavor of her flesh.

'Tell me what you do know,' I said, trying not to sound like a pastiche of a Nazi interrogator. 'When you got to his room, what happened?'

She took a breath as though she was about to deliver a speech. I kissed her neck again, and she seemed to take it as motivation. 'He kissed me. I kissed him back. It was... it felt like it did when we were at high school.'

As I listened to her, I was moving slowly around her, touching her, leaning in to touch my nose to her soft skin, breathing in that bizarre

smell of sex and another man from her warm body.

‘He was touching you?’ I asked her.

‘He... pulled me down onto the bed,’ she said.

I examined her chest, tugging her bra gently away from her skin to peer down at her bare breasts, at her stiff little nipples. She was turned on, I could tell. Whether by my strange behavior, or because she’d just been well fucked by her ex-boyfriend.

‘What did you do?’

‘I was kissing him... I was... pulling off his clothes...’

‘What did he want you to do?’ I asked her before sucking on one of her nipples for a brief moment before covering it up again with the black lace of her bra.

‘He wanted me to go down on him.’

‘And did you?’

‘Yes.’

‘You sucked his cock?’

‘Yes.’

She looked at me with fear in her eyes as I stood looming over her. Her scent made me shiver with arousal. She smelled faintly of perfume and the mustiness of recent exercise. She smelled of alcohol and sex and a man’s cologne.

I had to force myself not to tremble with giddy desire. I focused on her mouth, though as I sucked on her lips, there seemed to be a somewhat unfamiliar flavor.

I put my hand around her, gently touching it down in the middle of her back, pulling her to me for a warm embrace as our lips came together. I kissed her mouth softly, tenderly, lovingly. It seemed to take some of the fear from her; her visibility loosened up.

‘I can taste him on you,’ I said quietly as our kiss ended. ‘Did he come in your mouth?’

‘No — not then. Later, he did.’

‘So... before that, he fucked you?’

‘He said he needed to get it out of his system. That once he’d done that, we could take things slow.’

I felt excitement rippling around my body. It was a thrill to hear my wife talk of another man having her — even if I was uncomfortable that it had happened behind my back.

‘Tell me how it was,’ I demanded.

‘He just... he had me lie on my back... he pushed up my dress... and then he just pulled my panties aside...’

I dropped down to my knees now, in front of her spectacular legs. I caressed her thighs with both hands as I gazed at the scrap of black lace that covered her hairless sex. This close, the smell of sex was powerful from her crotch.

‘It felt good when he fucked you?’

‘Oh yes,’ she said, breathing shallowly, as though afraid of what I might do next. ‘His cock was so *big*...’

I felt drawn to her adulterous sex like a fruit fly to a cider trap. I leaned in to kiss her hot flesh just beside her panties. Wow. The scent was almost overpowering. It made me feel like my blood was fizzing all over my body, it was so exciting to perceive the evidence of her sex so close-up.

She moaned gently as I grazed my face across her lace-covered pussy, inhaling that wicked fragrance, and as she continued to stand there obediently at my command, she parted her legs a little more to offer me easier access.

‘He used condoms as he fucked you?’ I asked her.

‘Yes...’ she wailed quietly as I pressed my mouth to her pussy, tasting her through the damp lace.

‘How many?’

‘I don’t know... maybe four... or five...’

It had been a long night, but I was still impressed at Cory's stamina. I teased my Juliette for a while, kissing my way around her panties, rubbing my face against her through the material.

Then I reached for the waistband of her panties and tugged them down her thighs.

Her bare pussy was flushed from recent use, and glistening with wetness. I couldn't help but touch it, sliding my hands down over her smooth mound, taking in the unfamiliar feel of it — I still wasn't used to her having no fur down there. Seeking the smoldering heat between her thighs.

She caught her breath as I first touched her there.

'You're so wet,' I breathed.

She quietly gasped as my fingers slowly explored her slick folds. Stirring her honeypot only strengthened the scent of sex in the air around us. It was exhilarating.

'Sit down on the bed,' I told her.

She did as she was told. I crouched in front of her, leaning in to kiss her stomach. She leaned back to grant me access, though I could see fresh unease in her face. She wasn't comfortable with my focused attention like this.

She still felt like I was inspecting her. That I would determine she had fucked another man and become enraged.

'You know how much it turns me on that you fucked another man?'

I said to her.

'Jessie told me...' she said. Then, 'I read something that said...'

'I can smell him on you,' I said as I zeroed in on her pussy, almost overpowered by how strong the pungent scent of raw sex was, saturating the air around her crotch.

I said, 'If you understood, why would you want to keep it a secret from me?'

She said, 'I... Cory...'

I shook my head. 'I don't care what Cory said. I don't care what Cory wants. You're my wife.'

'Yes, my love.'

'You do what I want.'

'I promise.'

She gasped as she felt my hot, possessive mouth on her sensitive pussy. My God, I was so hungry for her. That exhilarating scent, that feeling she had been well used, she had been so naughty, giving in to her base cravings for adulterous sex with a man she'd probably been thinking about for ten years.

Her makeup was almost gone, her flesh pale in places and blotchy and flushed in others, her skin dull from dried sweat, her hair messy and damp and all over the place. She was so beautiful.

She reached for a pillow to support her shoulders as she gazed down at me, feasting on her juicy, delicious sex.

I was incensed with arousal for her, for this pussy that smelled of another man, of sweat and excitement and the odd tang of someone else's condom.

'Take off your bra,' I told her, and she did so, and I enjoyed the view of her bare breasts, her hard nipples as I lapped up her sweet nectar, sucking on her pussy lips, coursing my tongue through her folds, nuzzling against her clit.

I ate her ravenously, and it was obvious how much it turned me on that she'd fucked another man earlier that night.

She relaxed a little, allowed her thighs to part as wide as she could manage, and now she pressed a foot against my back as though to encourage me.

Man, I'd never known her to be this wet. I was addicted. It was so sexy, getting right in there. Covering my face in her wetness.

Juliette seemed to be watching closely at first, as though waiting to see if I would somehow realize another guy had shoved his cock in there just before I got to her and get suddenly disgusted by the whole thing. But gradually, she seemed to trust that I really was into it, that I knew what I

was doing. She started closing her eyes as I continued sucking on her pussy, pressed my hot mouth on her clit. She tilted her head back and just seemed to give herself completely over to the feelings from my mouth working her sex.

‘You taste so good,’ I said, along with various other compliments to reassure her, to encourage her to let go.

‘I love eating you after you’ve been such a bad girl.’

The best thing was when her orgasm hit, and she got all frantic, pushing up her hips as though she wanted to fuck my mouth. I would have let her ride my face, but I wanted to feel like I was fully in control tonight.

I held her thighs tight and lapped at her soaking wet pussy as she thrashed around underneath me, crying out and shuddering as her climax hit.

Just the most beautiful thing I’d ever seen.

I could not get enough of her after she’d been with another guy. I suppose the first time it had happened, I hadn’t been able to reclaim her for myself afterward. She’d been too tired — and then, too upset. Now, though, I was obsessed with her. I think she could tell.

She wasn’t tired now, even though it was well past 3am. She was newly invigorated, responding to this unusual desire in her husband.

By then, she was practically begging me to fuck her.

I turned her over so she was lying on her front, her gorgeous butt pushed up in the air as though to entice me to slide my cock inside her. I took my time enjoying her with my mouth before I did as she wanted.

I was just buzzing with lust for her.

‘Did he fuck you like this?’ I asked her as my hard cock glided into her sopping wet pussy easier than it had ever done so before. Her pussy was well stretched tonight.

‘Uhhhh...’ she moaned in reply.

‘Did he make you come?’ I asked her.

She sighed, and then said, ‘Yes...’

I thrust into her harder, spurred on by her admission.

‘How many times?’

She said, ‘I don’t know...’

To my consternation, she sounded afraid of me. I hadn’t intended that.

I turned her over, moved up beside her, holding her gently, affectionately.

‘You know I love you?’ I said.

She nodded.

‘It turns me on so much that you fucked him,’ I said, kissing her mouth, my hand slipping over her mound, cupping her pussy as though claiming it.

She smiled, gazing into my eyes as though to gauge whether I was telling the truth. I think she believed me.

‘I thought you’d prefer not to know what I did with him,’ she said.

I put her nearest hand on my cock, and her eyes widened to feel how hard I was for her. ‘I want to know everything,’ I said. ‘I don’t like you keeping secrets from me.’

‘I’ll do whatever you want,’ she said.

‘Good.’ I felt powerful, sliding my cock back inside her. ‘I want you to date him — you’ll have fun. But tell him whatever lies you need to keep him interested. I don’t want you to keep things secret from me.’

‘You want me to sleep with him?’

‘I do. If you want to.’

I was straddling one of her thighs, fucking her with our legs kind of alternating, one up, one down.

She said, ‘I’ll do what you tell me.’

The rush of power when she said that felt so unusual. In our relationship, I’d really never told her what to do. Requested, sure. Suggested, of course. But in this, she seemed to want to take instruction.

‘How long is he in town this time?’

‘Another night.’

‘Tell him I’m out of town tomorrow. Invite him here, to our apartment. Have a nice quiet night in together.’

‘A quiet night?’ she grinned.

I laughed. ‘It doesn’t need to be that quiet.’

She climbed on top of me, positioned my cock at her pussy, then pushed herself down onto it.

‘If he asks me if I told you anything...?’

‘Tell him you told me nothing. Tell him I have no clue. Whatever he needs to hear. I don’t care if you lie to him.’

‘Okay.’ She didn’t sound very sure.

‘You don’t need to feel bad for him,’ I said. ‘As far as we’re concerned, he’s been cheating on me. He’s trying to steal you from me. I don’t have a problem with you lying to someone like that.’

‘I’m no good at lying,’ she warned.

‘If it helps, if he catches you in a lie, you can blame me. It’s my fault. I’m telling you what to do.’

She beamed. ‘I... like it when you tell me what to do.’

My God, she was so sexy. It felt like we’d stumbled on something new to try, something new and hot.

‘Did you suck his cock?’ I asked her.

‘Yes,’ she said. ‘I sucked his cock a lot.’

I kissed her mouth, reveling in the taboo nature of what I was doing in the light of what I’d just said.

Then I said, ‘Well, now you can suck my cock, too.’

She seemed delighted by my demand.

I know how cuckolds are seen in mainstream society. I could claim not to be a cuckold because I wasn't into the whole humiliation thing, but plenty of people would still call me a cuck. But when I thrust into my wife's well-fucked pussy, feeling what another guy had felt just a short while before me, my cock was so hard I had no insecurity when it came to my masculinity.

I didn't feel weak, I didn't feel less than a man.

I just happened to like that my wife was sticky with sweat from a night of fucking somebody else. That her blonde hair was all mussed, her makeup somewhat smeared. That she smelled of the man who had fucked her all night.

My cock wasn't as big as Cory's, but it was still a decent enough size. Thinking about Cory fucking my wife, though, had the strange effect of making me feel bigger.

My Juliette gasped as I slid my cock inside her.

'Honey, is that all you?'

I gazed down at her, on all fours beneath me on the bed, and watched my dick sinking into her again and again, and I focused on the fact that Cory's had done just that for hours before me.

It felt so good, fucking her after she'd been primed by another man before me.

We didn't feel the need to rush — she'd already hit various orgasms earlier that night. And we had both decided we would need to call in sick the next day.

The secrecy between us fell away when I told her I didn't like it. Now I could ask questions, and she would enjoy answering.

'You like having two different guys in one night?'

'Oh, yes.'

Did he come inside you?'

'Yes.'

'How many times?'

‘I guess... four times.’

‘Where?’

‘In my mouth. In my pussy. Across my chest.’

‘He wore a condom, though?’

‘Yeah, but he wants to do it without one when he moves here.’

I liked the thought of the other guy coming inside my wife without a condom. It just added to the tension that surrounded the whole act of Juliette sleeping with someone else. I guess they hadn’t used a condom the night of the reunion — but then we’d all been drinking so much, nobody thought of it.

I told her, ‘He’ll just have to get tested first.’

CHAPTER 15

‘HEY, THANKS FOR DOING THIS, MAN.’

He stepped into our apartment, and I shook Cory Fallon by the hand.

‘Of course. It’s no problem. I mean, we had the room.’

He smiled, glancing around as though he’d never been here before. It was important to keep up the pretense.

‘I promise I won’t be here long,’ he said. ‘Then you guys can have your office back.’

I looked over to Juliette, who gave me a sweet, innocent smile. The smile of a wife grateful to have a husband who would so readily agree to help out one of her friends in a time of need. Even if it was a friend who had a romantic history with her.

‘You take as long as you need,’ I said. ‘It’s not always easy to find a decent apartment. We can do without a home office.’

Cory gave a little nod, and his gaze briefly connected with Juliette’s. I noticed a glint in his eyes that betrayed his secret. I could tell he was already calculating the odds of whether he would get to continue his affair with my wife right here in our apartment while he was staying here.

Right under my nose.

‘Well,’ he said, his eyes returning to mine. ‘I appreciate it, man. You didn’t have to do this.’

‘Sure. Hey, why don’t you unpack? Get comfortable. Dinner’s almost ready.’

It was all a lie, of course.

Cory didn’t have to be here. He had been doing very well for himself at Walmart over the past decade working there. And now, he was going to work for a clothing retailer just off Fifth Avenue, and I knew from Juliette that his salary would be perfectly fine to accommodate a brief stay at an affordable hotel while he searched for an apartment of his own.

But Cory liked the thought of living under the same roof as Juliette for a while, of pursuing this affair of theirs right under my nose.

He believed I knew nothing of what he had been doing with my wife. He remained under the impression I’d been too drunk to know what was going on during the night of Juliette’s high school reunion, when he’d come back to our room and fucked her in front of me.

As far as he was concerned, I thought Juliette was a loyal, faithful wife with eyes only for me. As far as he was concerned, I felt so secure in our marriage that it wouldn’t be an issue to offer our spare room to her ex-boyfriend while he looked for an apartment in the city suitable for his new job here.

The truth was that I knew everything about Juliette’s affair with Cory.

The truth was that I wanted the chance to see them together. To enjoy the strange tension between them as Cory attempted to hide his desire for my wife from me. As he flirted with her behind my back. As he looked for openings, for opportunities, for mere glimpses of time in which he could touch Juliette, kiss Juliette, take her to his bed.

Juliette seemed amused by this situation.

During the days after Cory’s final job interview, she had come to fully embrace the need to keep her ex-boyfriend in the dark about my knowledge of their affair.

It turned out that she liked keeping me fully informed of their rekindling passion for each other. She enjoyed how much it turned me on.

That first night, we ate dinner together, all three of us acting like perfect innocents. We exchanged small-talk — about Cory's new job, about the work of Juliette and me at the same law firm down in Midtown; about how it would be for him to embark on a new life in New York City.

We watched TV for a short while after dinner — the new Deadpool movie, which was pretty funny to begin with but I soon lost interest as my focus was drawn by the proximity of my wife to her ex.

I got up halfway through the movie, said I needed to get an early night since I had an early meeting the next day. The others nodded. Cory said he would be heading to bed soon, too, since he needed his rest before his first day in the new job.

I left them watching TV together, enjoying that little frisson of energy between them as Cory saw the chance to spend a little one-on-one time with Juliette, and as my wife realized exactly what I was doing.

As I got ready for bed, I heard them chatting together. It was a small apartment, even if Juliette and I were both lawyers. Laughing together. Whispering together.

I didn't think anything significant would happen immediately. Cory would be cautious about doing anything risky until I was fast asleep. Juliette wouldn't want to tip him off that I knew of, and supported, her infidelity.

Cory liked to believe she really was cheating on me.

But I was a patient guy. I closed the bedroom door, settled down in bed.

Twenty minutes later, Juliette texted me:

He just me kissed me. I went to the kitchen for a drink. He followed me. Asked if I thought you were asleep yet. I said probably. I told him you were a pretty solid sleeper. Out like a light. Sleep through fire alarms. Then he pulled me in for a kiss.

I texted her back:

Good girl. Are you safe texting me?

After we kissed, I suggesting waiting just few minutes more.
He thinks I'm just playing Candy Crush.

I love the updates, but don't worry if you can't manage it.
Have some fun with him. Welcome him to the neighborhood.
I'm already hard thinking about you coming to bed when
you're done with him.

I'll try not to take too long, my love. It makes me so wet to
think of you waiting for me xx

I switched out the lights in our bedroom, and lay still, hoping I might hear something other than the low drone of late night city traffic. I heard a little quiet giggling, but then I got the sense that they were trying to keep the noise down.

Were they touching each other? Making out on the couch? I waited in the darkness, hoping they were.

Some minutes later, I heard a moan from Juliette — and felt certain she had done so loud enough so that I might hear.

In the darkness, my hard cock throbbed in anticipation of my naughty wife coming to bed immediately after sex with another man.

I could tell already we were going to have a lot of fun over the next however many days, with Cory in our midst.

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